CG STRATEGIC

Your Meal-Prep Business, Online

A step-by-step guide to the demo

Explore Northside Kitchen, a sample meal-prep business: the storefront your customers see, and the tools you'd use to run it.

Scan to open the demo

demo.cgstrategic.dev

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cgstrategic.dev
Book your call: [booking link coming soon]

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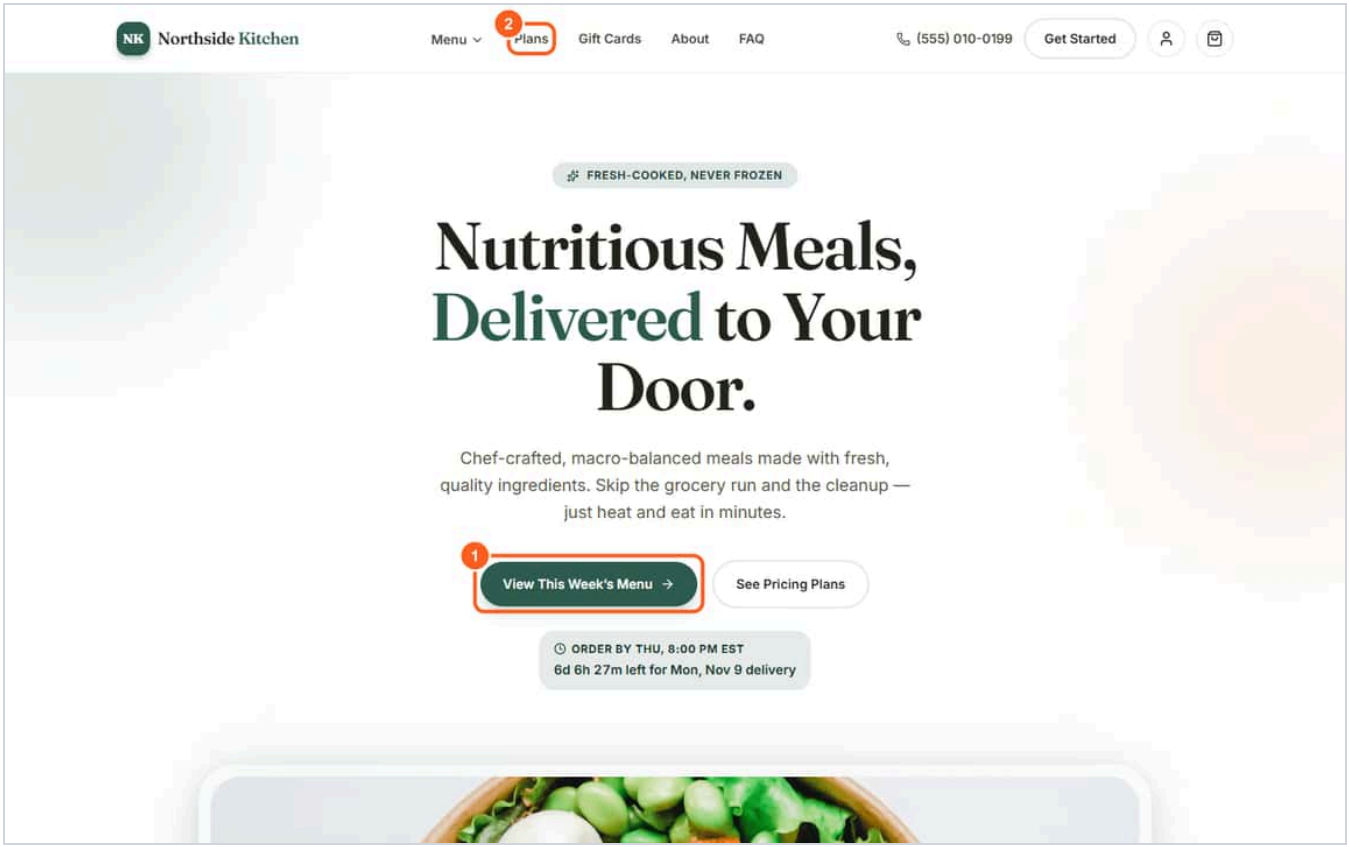
8. What happens next 64

1. WELCOME

A working sample business you can click through

The demo is a complete meal-prep business called Northside Kitchen. Everything works: the menu, weekly plans, the cart, the owner's tools. Nothing is real: no payments, no emails, no real customers. You can't break anything.

There are two sides. The storefront is what your customers see. The admin is where you, the owner, run the business.

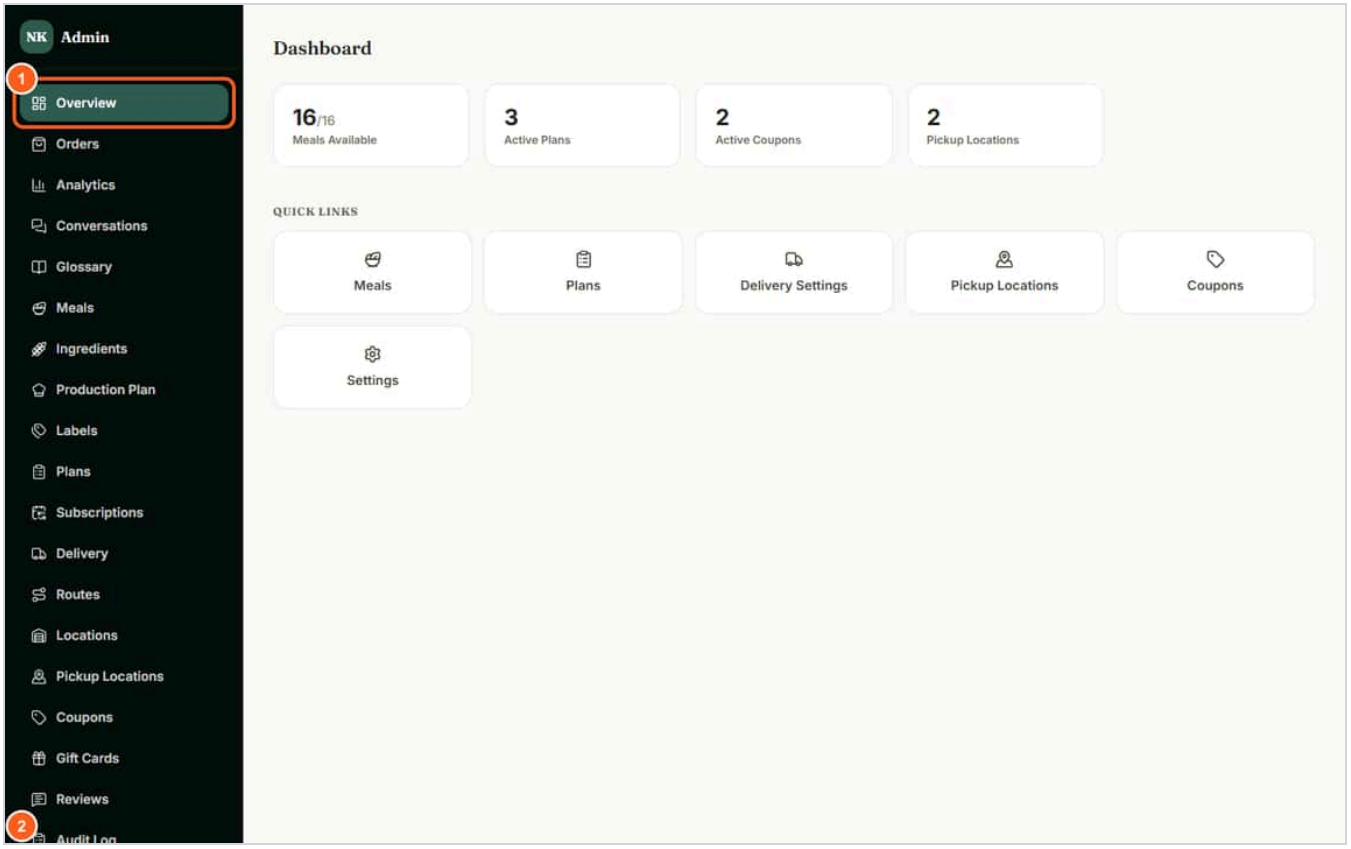


1. See this week's menu
2. Plans and pricing

The owner side: your admin

Open the admin from the link at the bottom of any storefront page (Admin Dashboard), then click Sign In. The demo fills in the sample login for you.

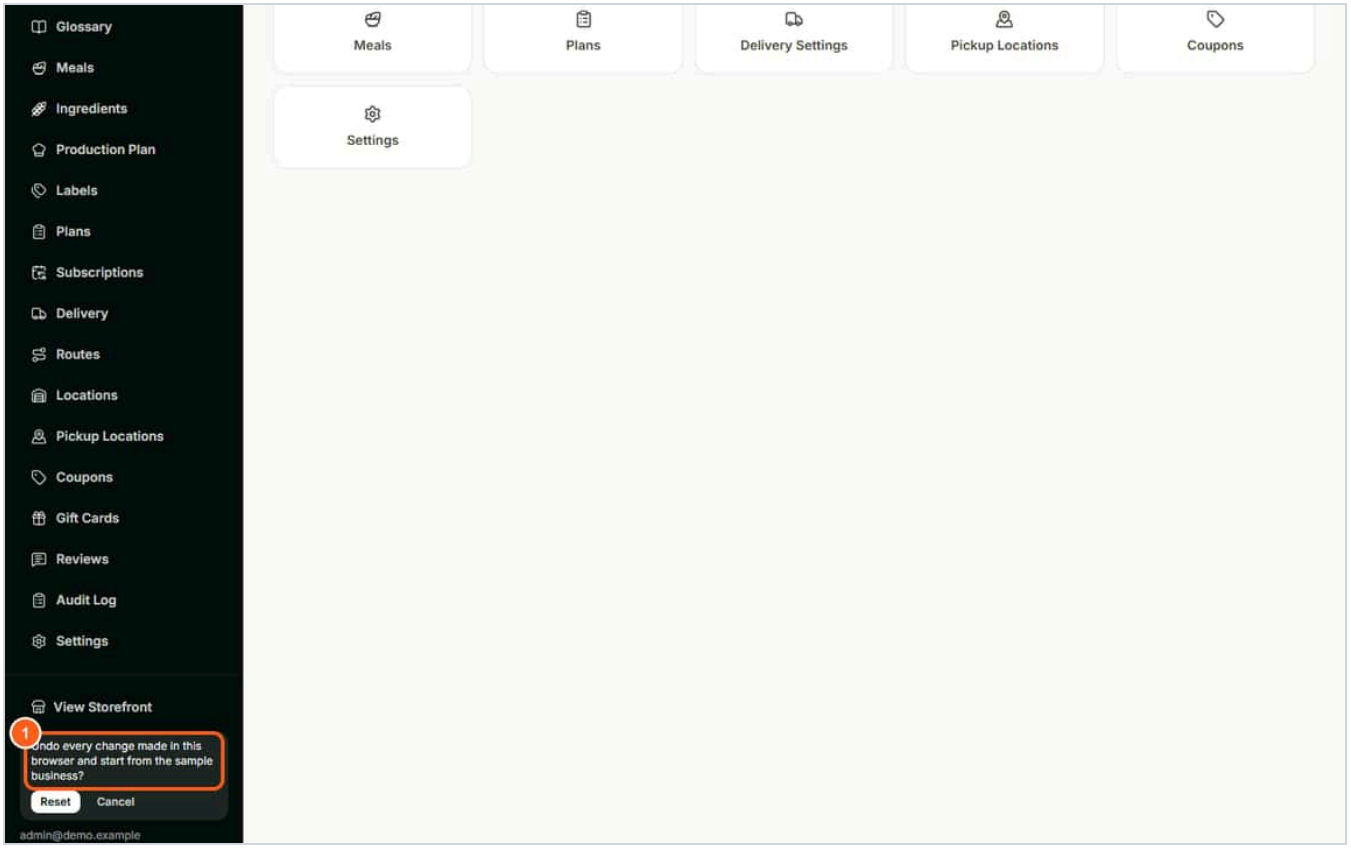
Every page of the admin is in the menu on the left. View Storefront takes you back to the customer side.



1. The admin menu
2. Back to the storefront

Start over any time with Reset demo

The demo remembers what you change in this browser, even if you close it. To go back to the original sample business, click Reset demo at the bottom of the admin menu and confirm.



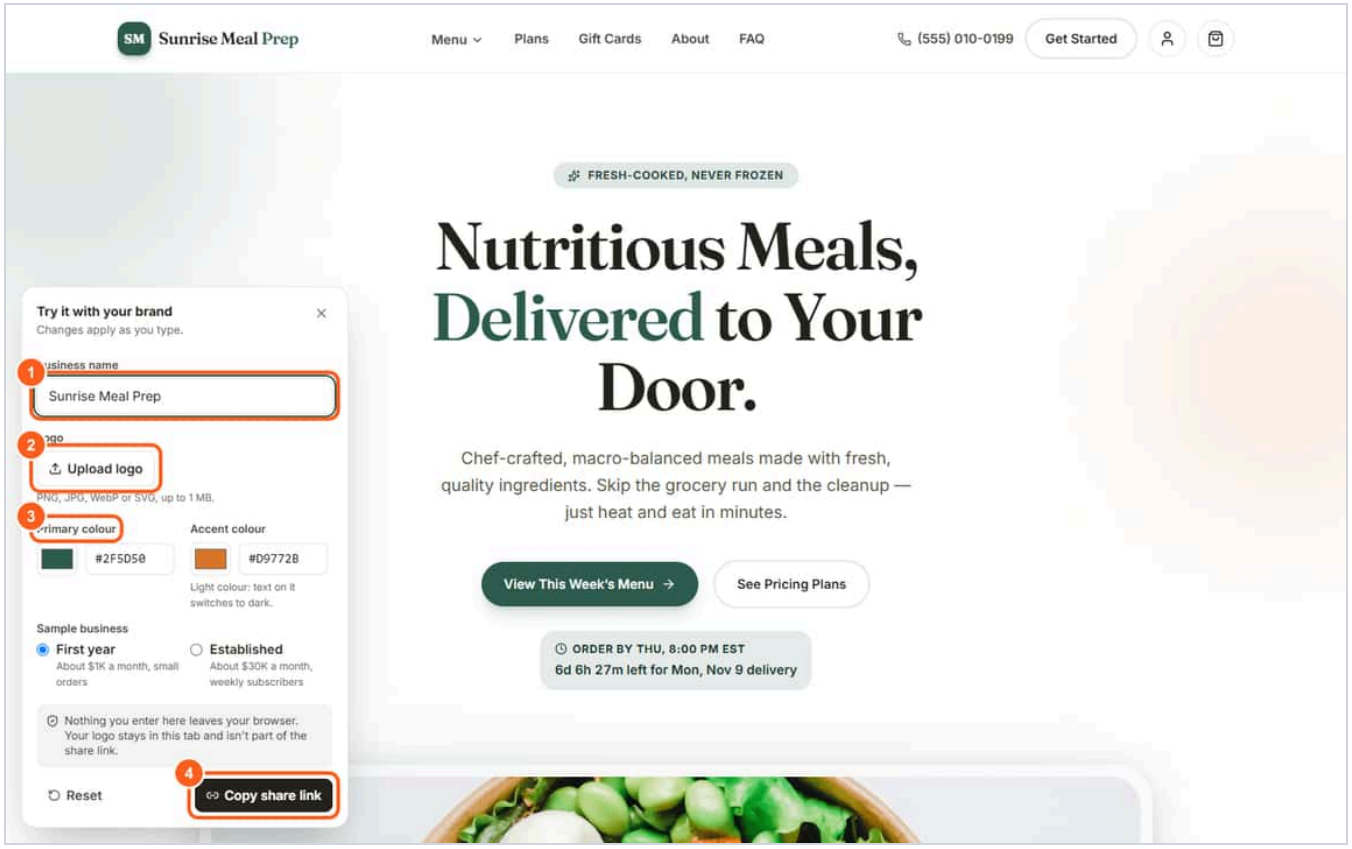
1 Confirm to start over

2. TRY IT WITH YOUR BRAND

Add your name, logo and colors

The Try it with your brand panel opens when you first visit the demo (or click it at the bottom left). Type your business name, upload your logo and pick your colors. Changes show as you type.

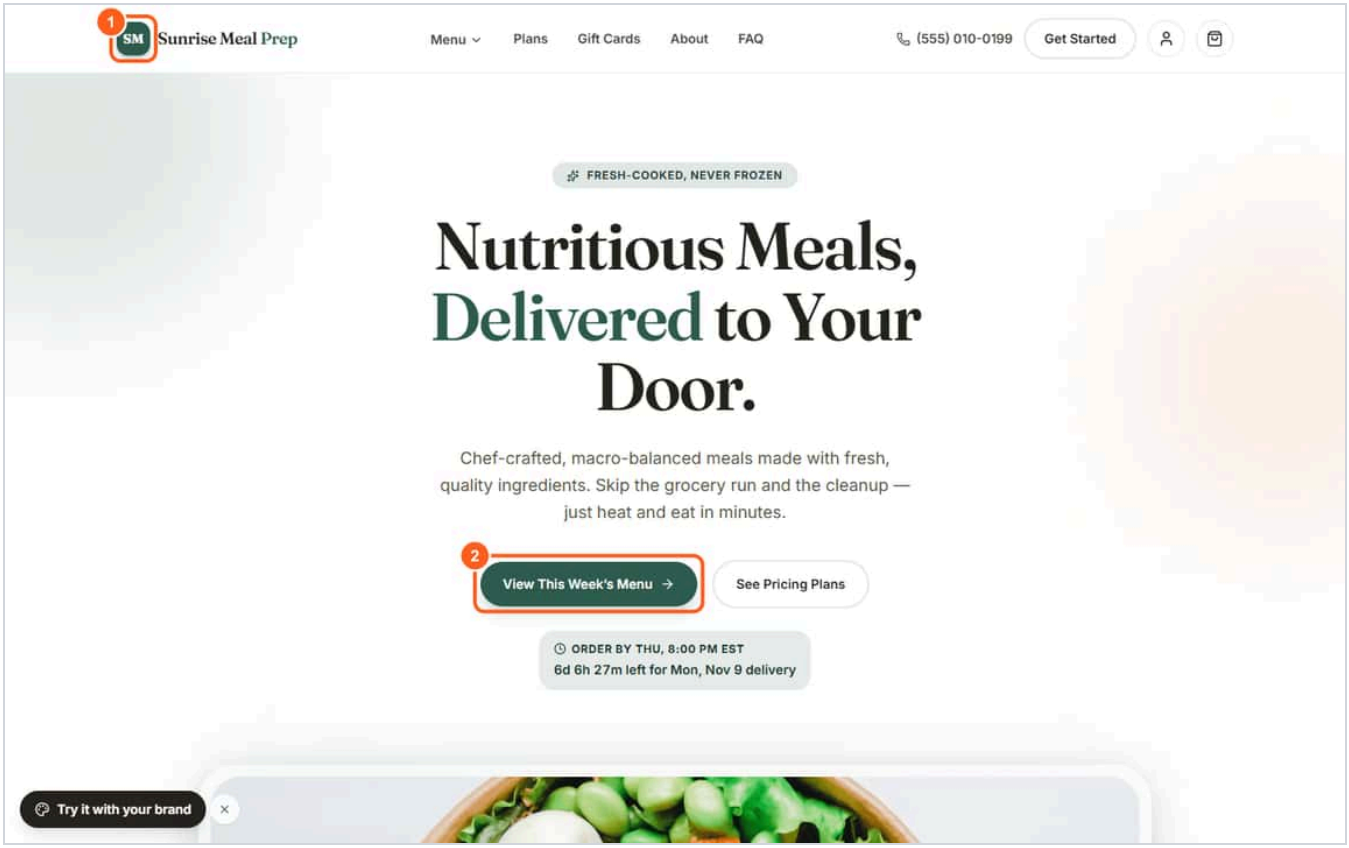
Your logo never leaves your browser. Copy share link gives you a link that opens the demo with your name and colors.



1. Your business name
2. Upload your logo
3. Your colors
4. Share it

See the whole site with your brand

Close the panel and browse: the header, buttons and pages use your name and colors. Click Reset in the panel to go back to Northside Kitchen.

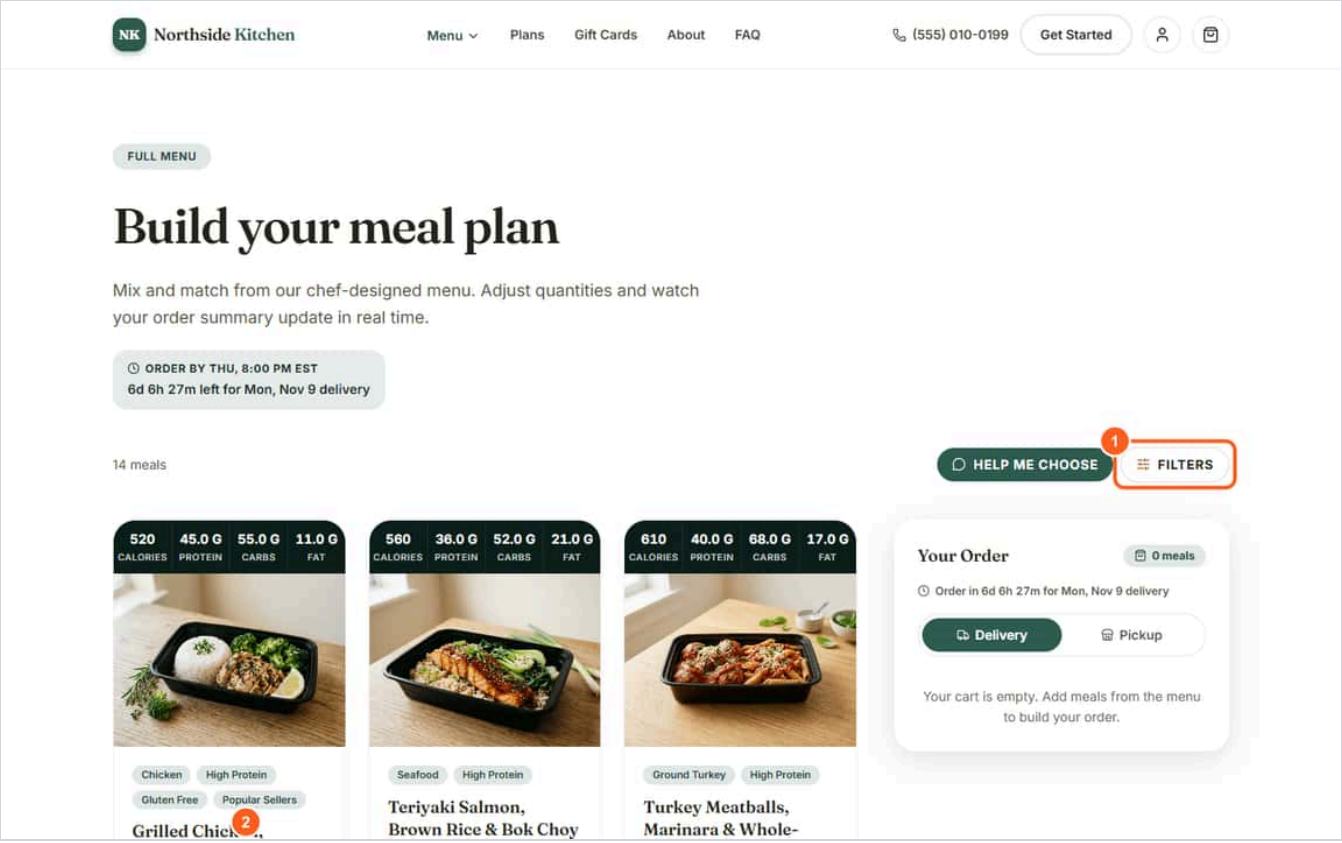


1. Your name in the header
2. Your colors on the buttons

3. THE CUSTOMER SIDE

Browse the weekly menu

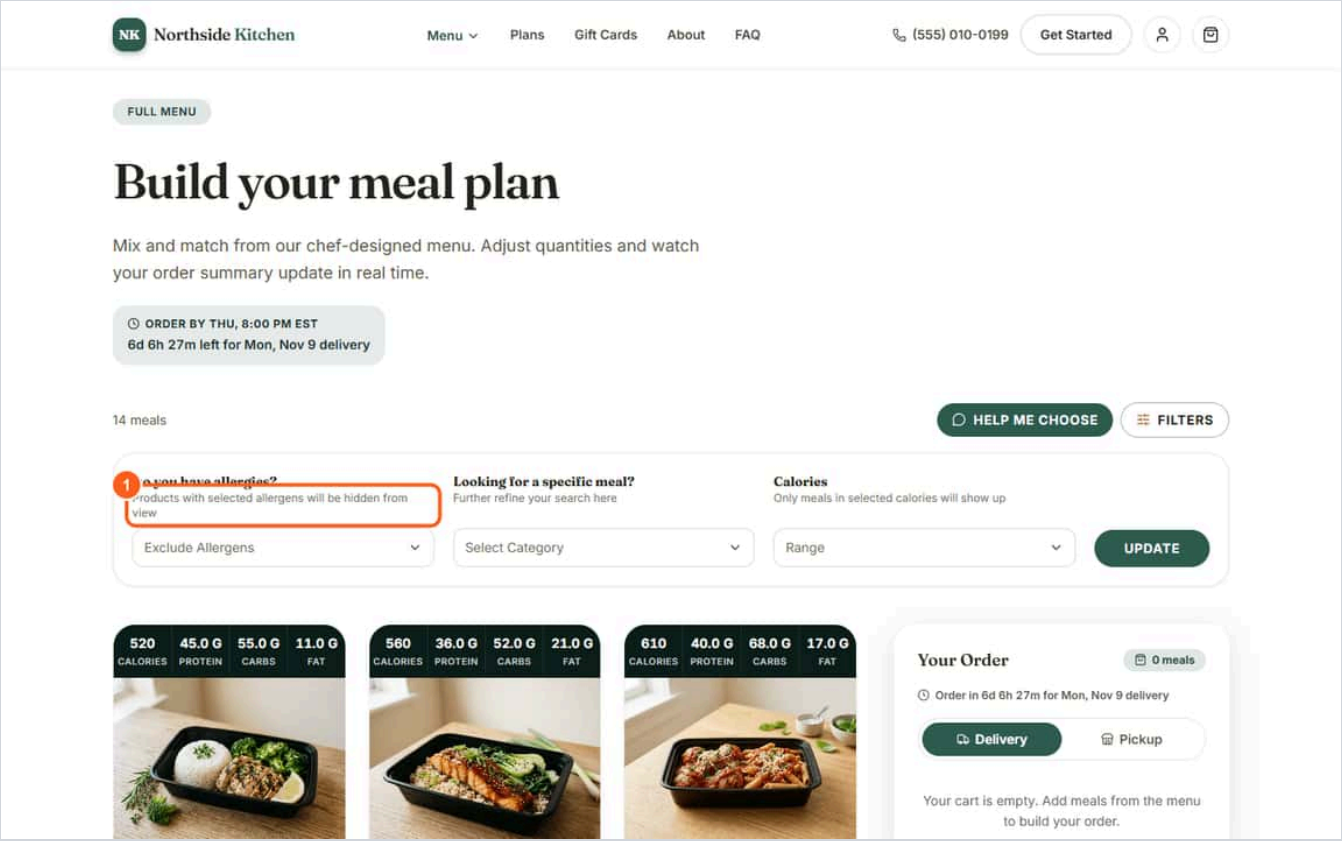
Customers see every meal with its calories and macros. They add meals straight from the menu, and their order builds up on the right.



1. Filters
2. Add a meal

Filter by allergens, category and calories

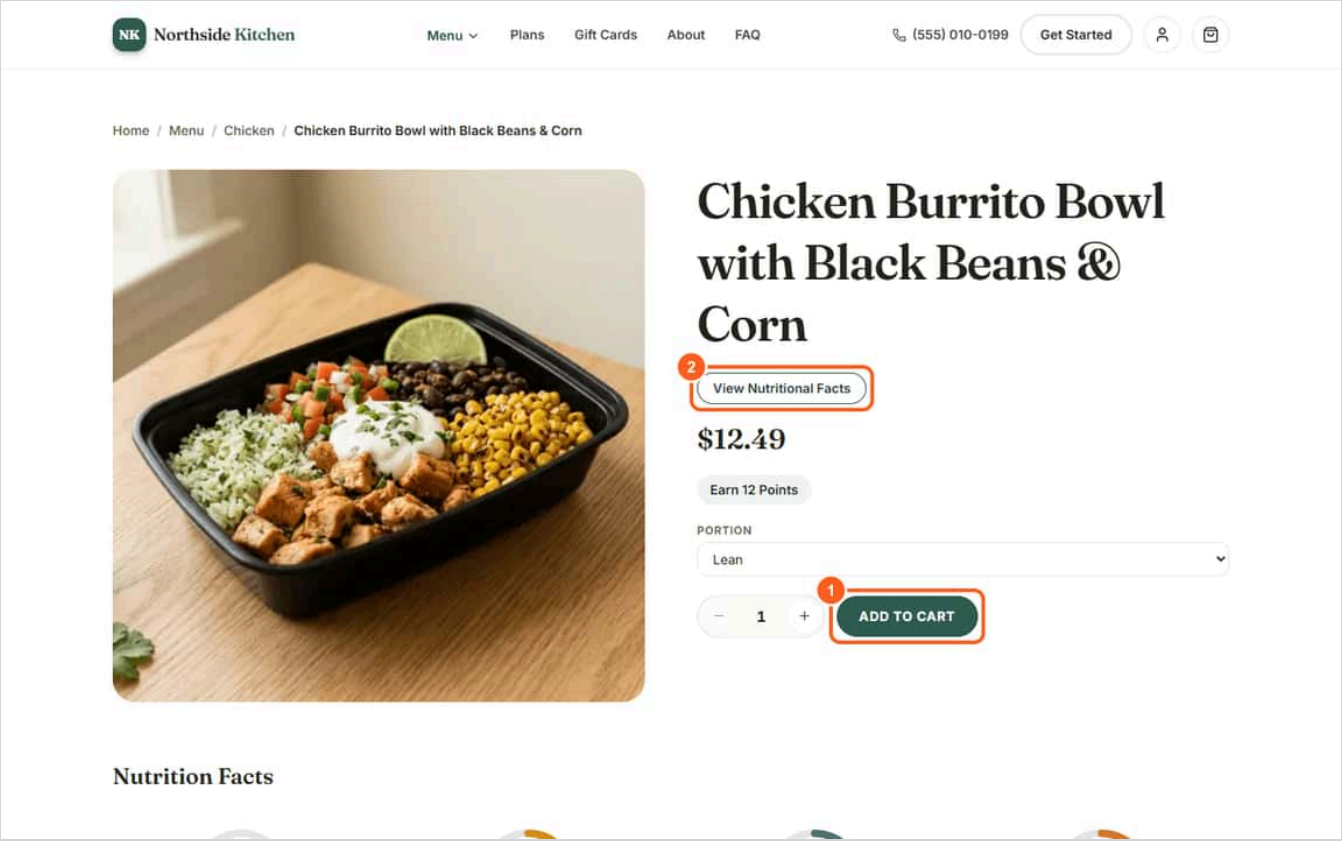
Filters let customers hide meals with their allergens, pick a category or set a calorie range.



1 Leave out allergens

Meal details

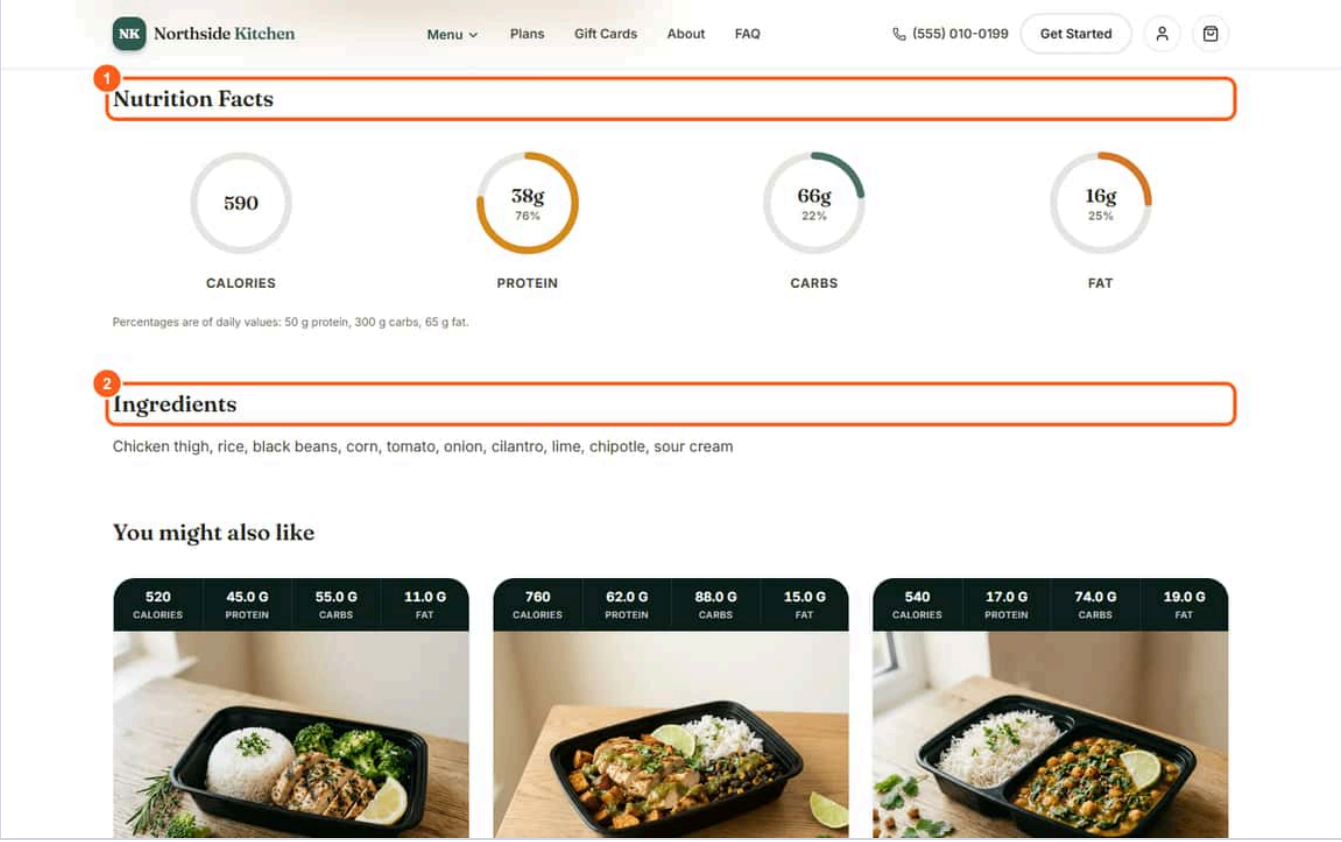
Each meal has its own page: photo, price, portion sizes and the button to add it to the cart.



1. Add to cart
2. Full nutrition facts

Nutrition and ingredients

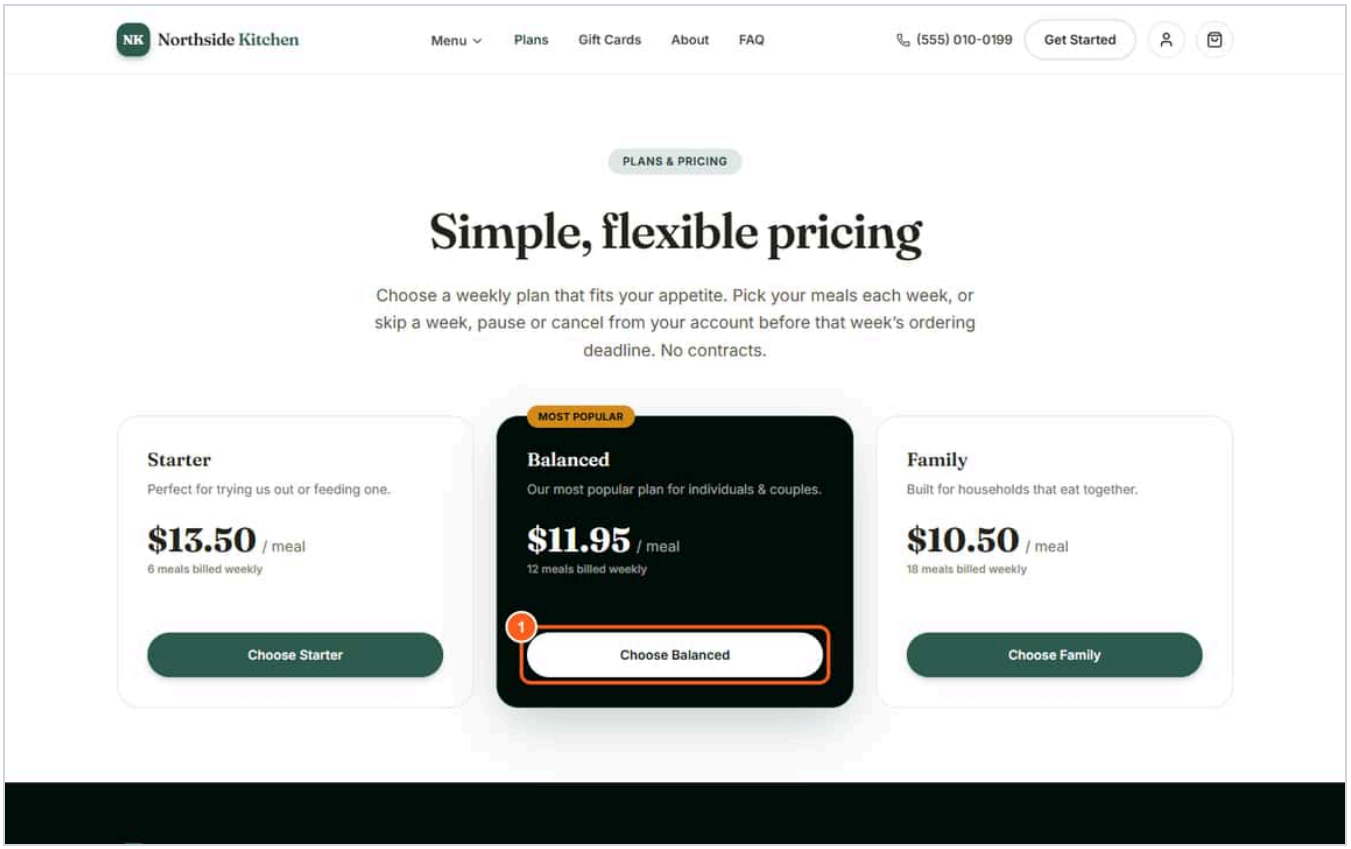
Further down: calories, protein, carbs and fat, and the full ingredient list, so customers know exactly what they're eating.



1. Nutrition facts
2. Ingredients

Weekly plans

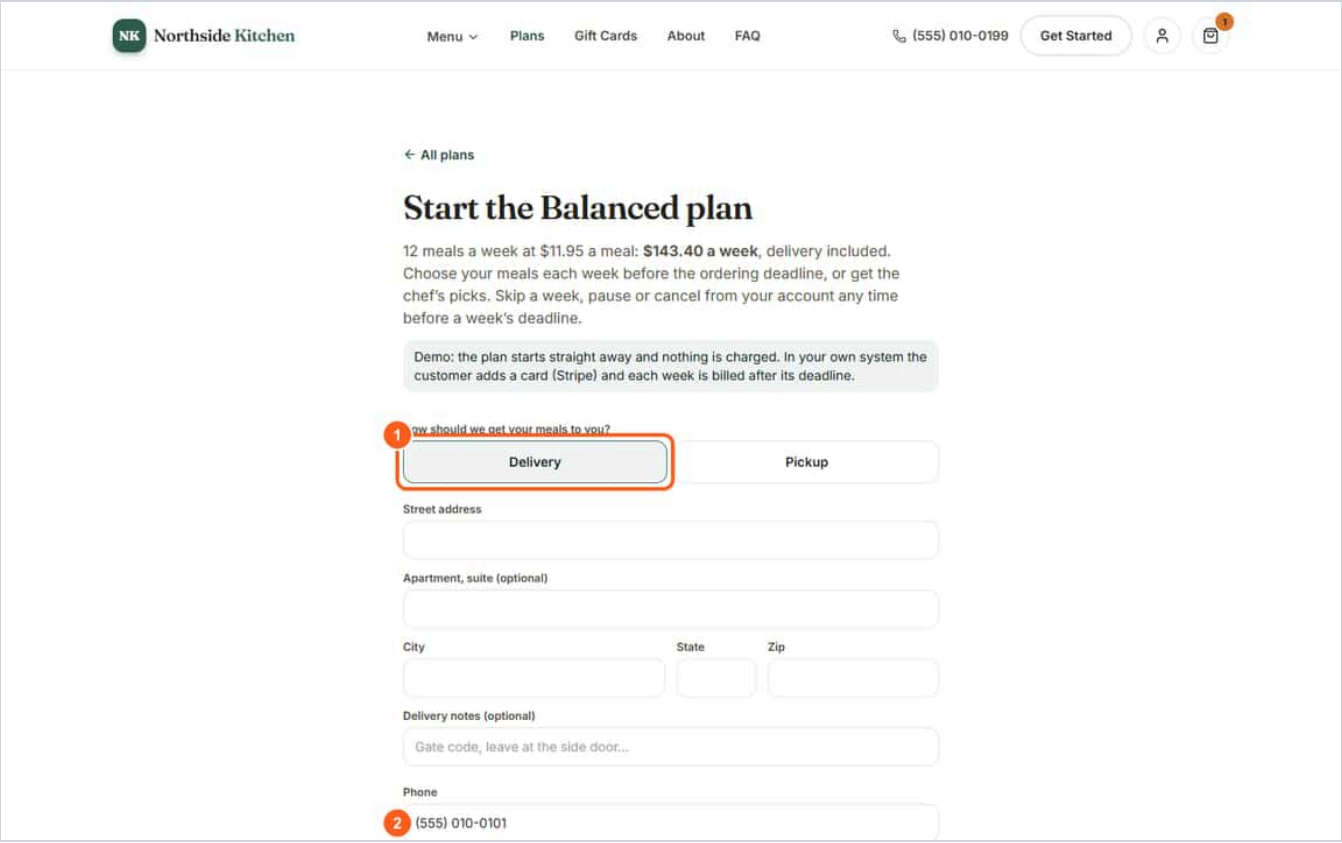
Plans deliver a set number of meals every week at a price per meal. Customers pick their meals each week, or get the chef's picks, and can skip a week, swap meals, pause or cancel from their account before that week's ordering deadline.



1 Choose a plan

Start a plan

The customer chooses delivery or pickup and confirms. In the demo the plan starts at once and nothing is charged. In your own system the customer adds a card through Stripe, on your own Stripe account, and each week is billed after its ordering deadline.

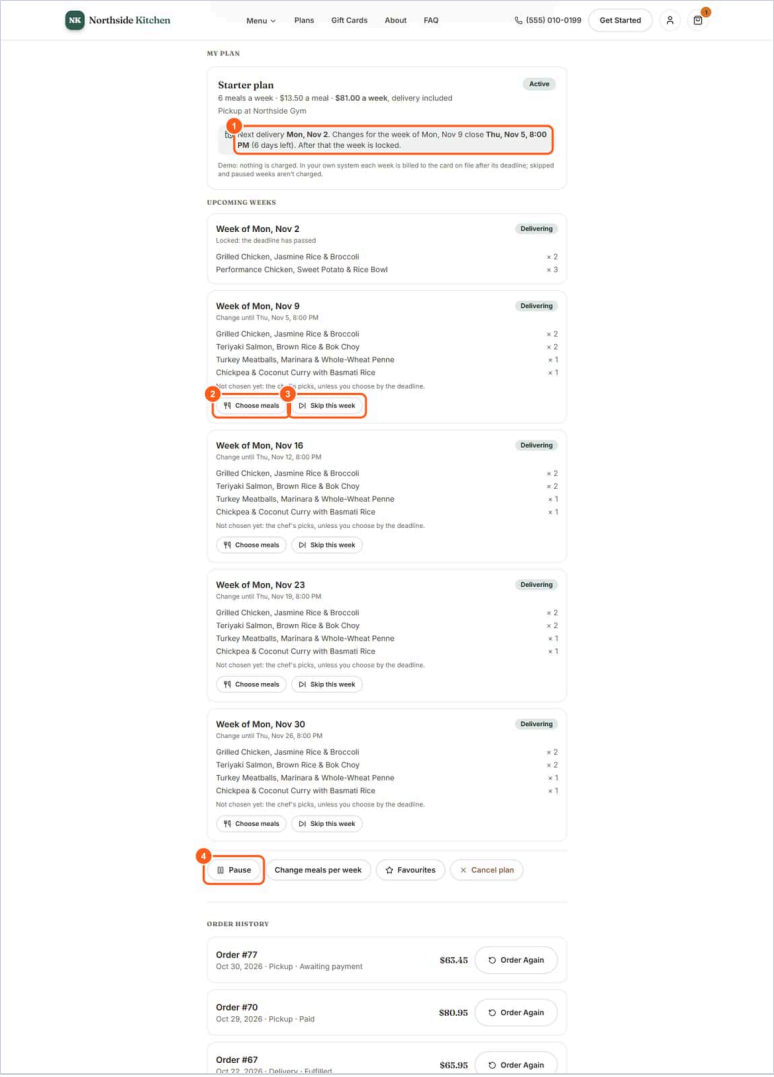


1. Delivery or pickup
2. Start the plan

My Plan: skip, pause, swap or cancel

On their account page, customers see their plan, their next delivery and the coming weeks, with the deadline for changes. Each week can be skipped (no delivery, no charge) or given different meals; the whole plan can be paused until a date, switched to more or fewer meals a week, or cancelled.

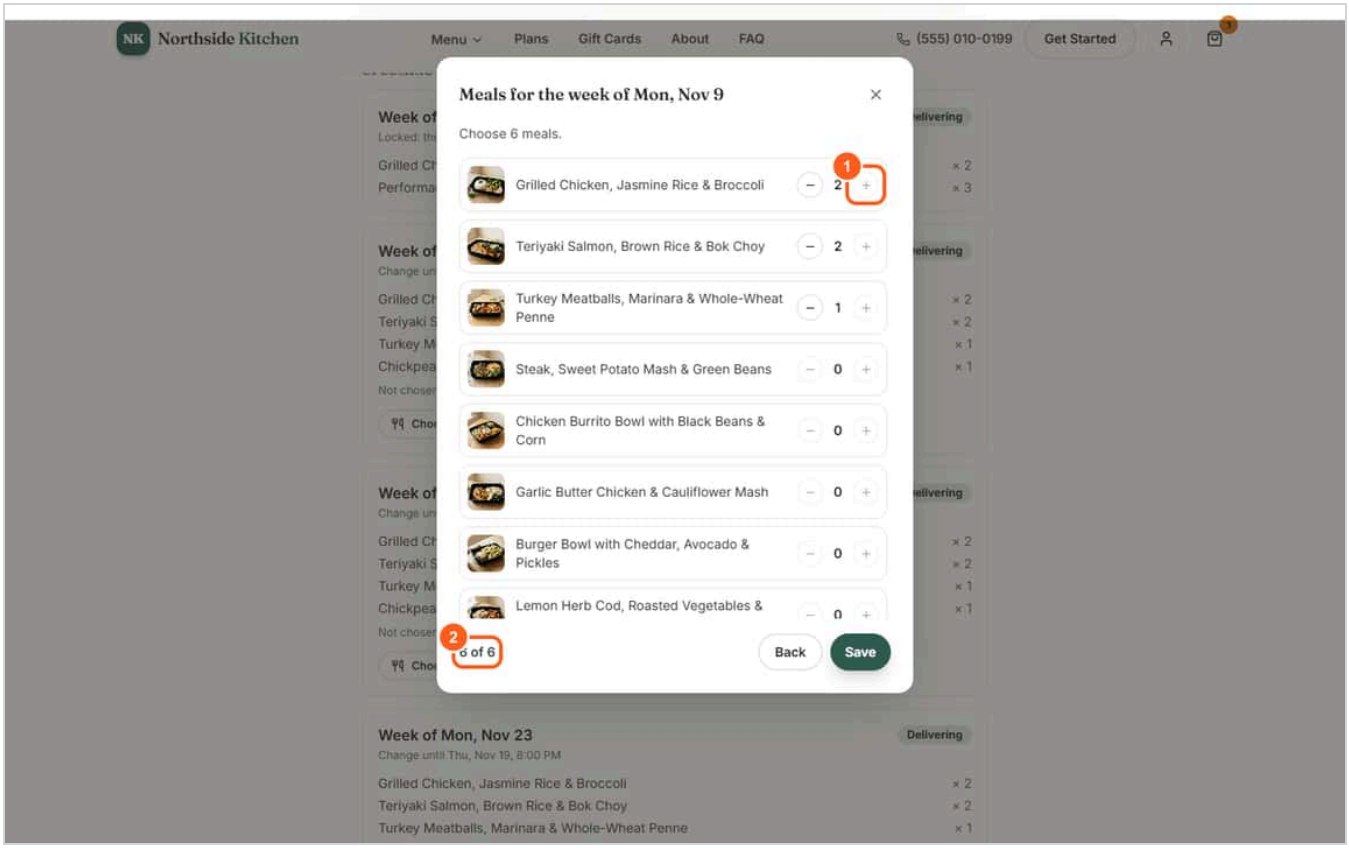
Once a week's deadline passes it's locked, and the kitchen plans around it.



1. The deadline for changes
2. Choose this week's meals
3. Skip this week
4. Pause, change or cancel the plan

Choose a week's meals

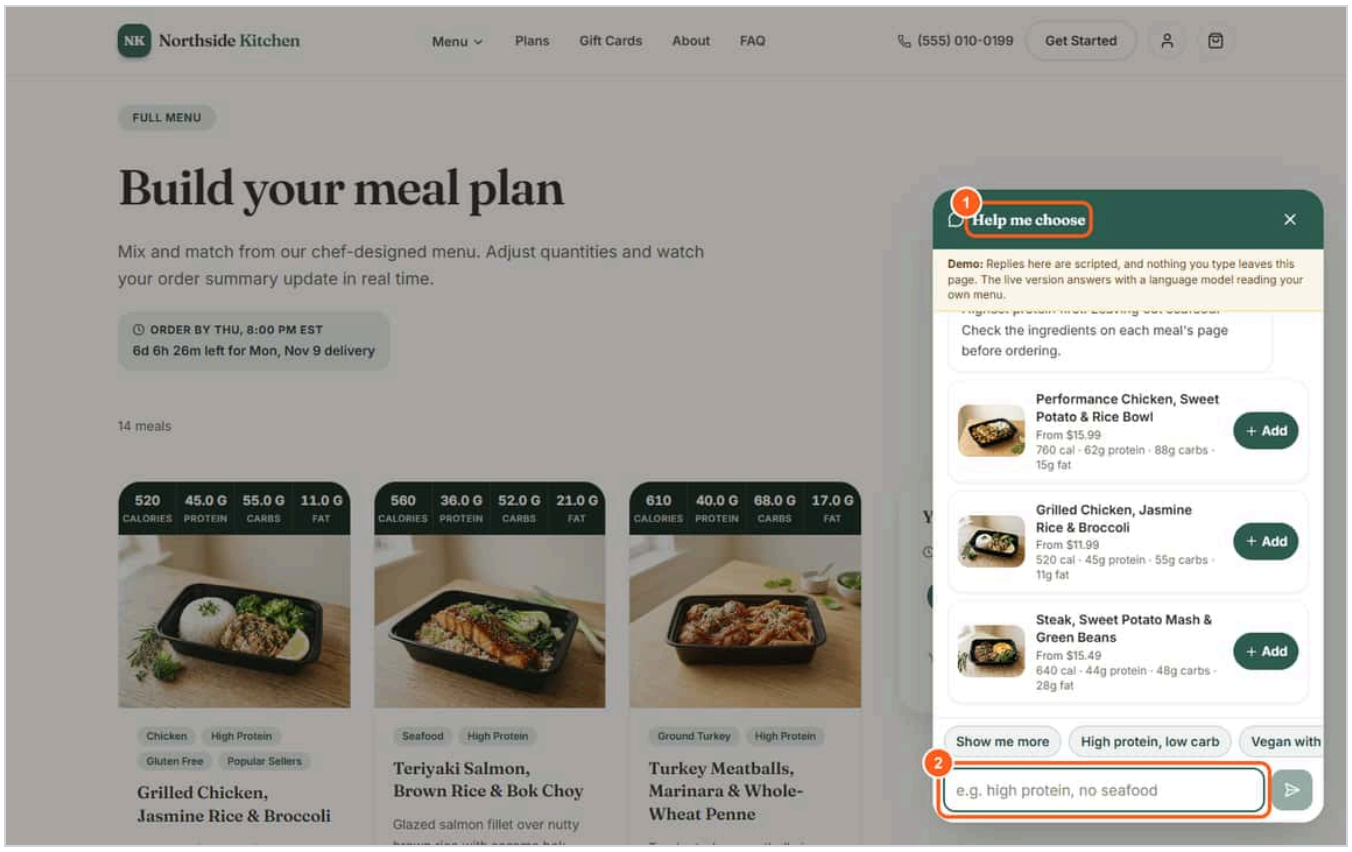
The customer picks exactly as many meals as their plan includes. A week they don't choose gets their saved favorites or the chef's picks, whichever you prefer.



1. Add or remove a meal
2. Meals chosen out of the plan's

The “Help me choose” assistant

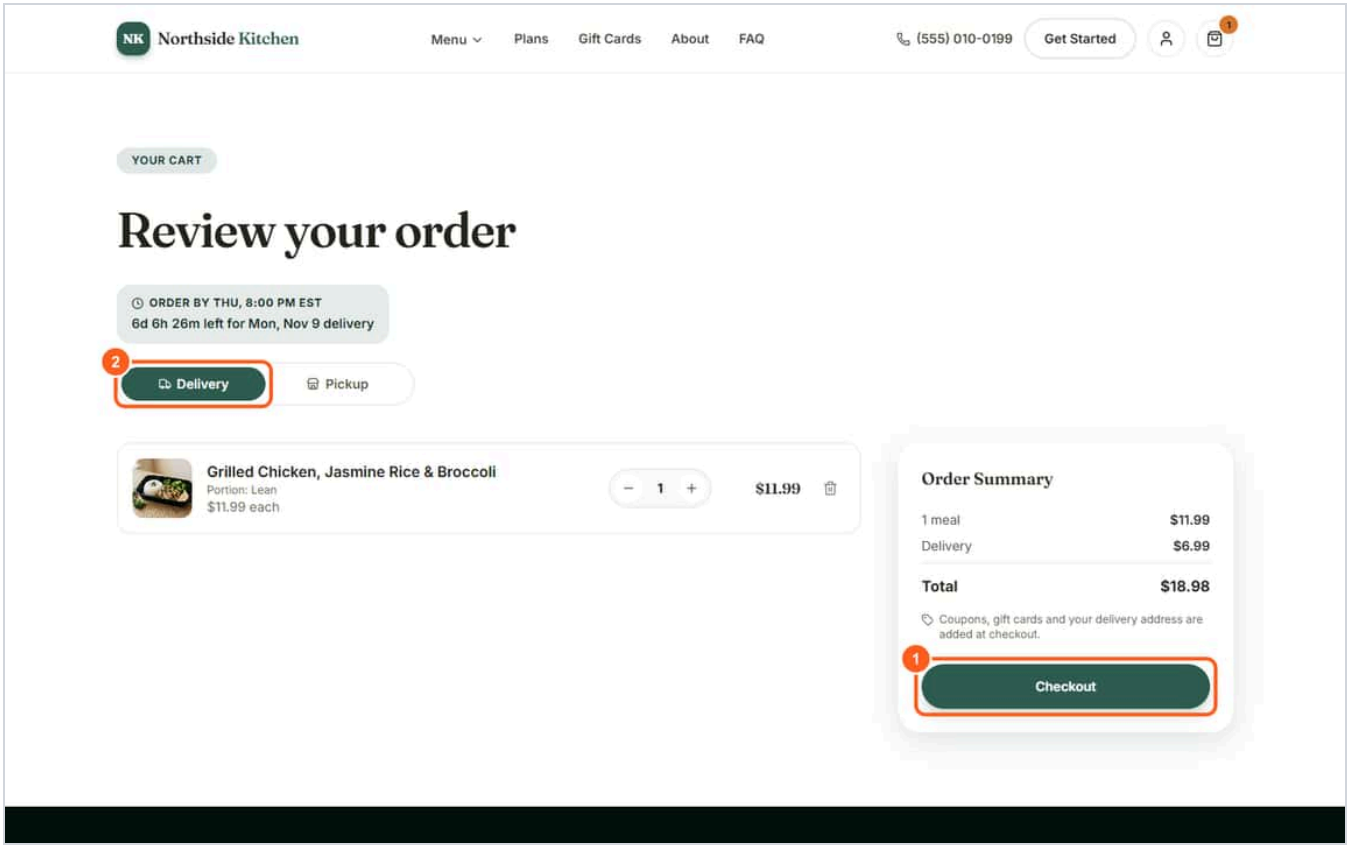
Customers type what they want (“high protein, no seafood”) and get matching meals they can add in one click. In the demo the answers come from a script; it never makes up a meal.



1. The assistant
2. Type a question

Cart

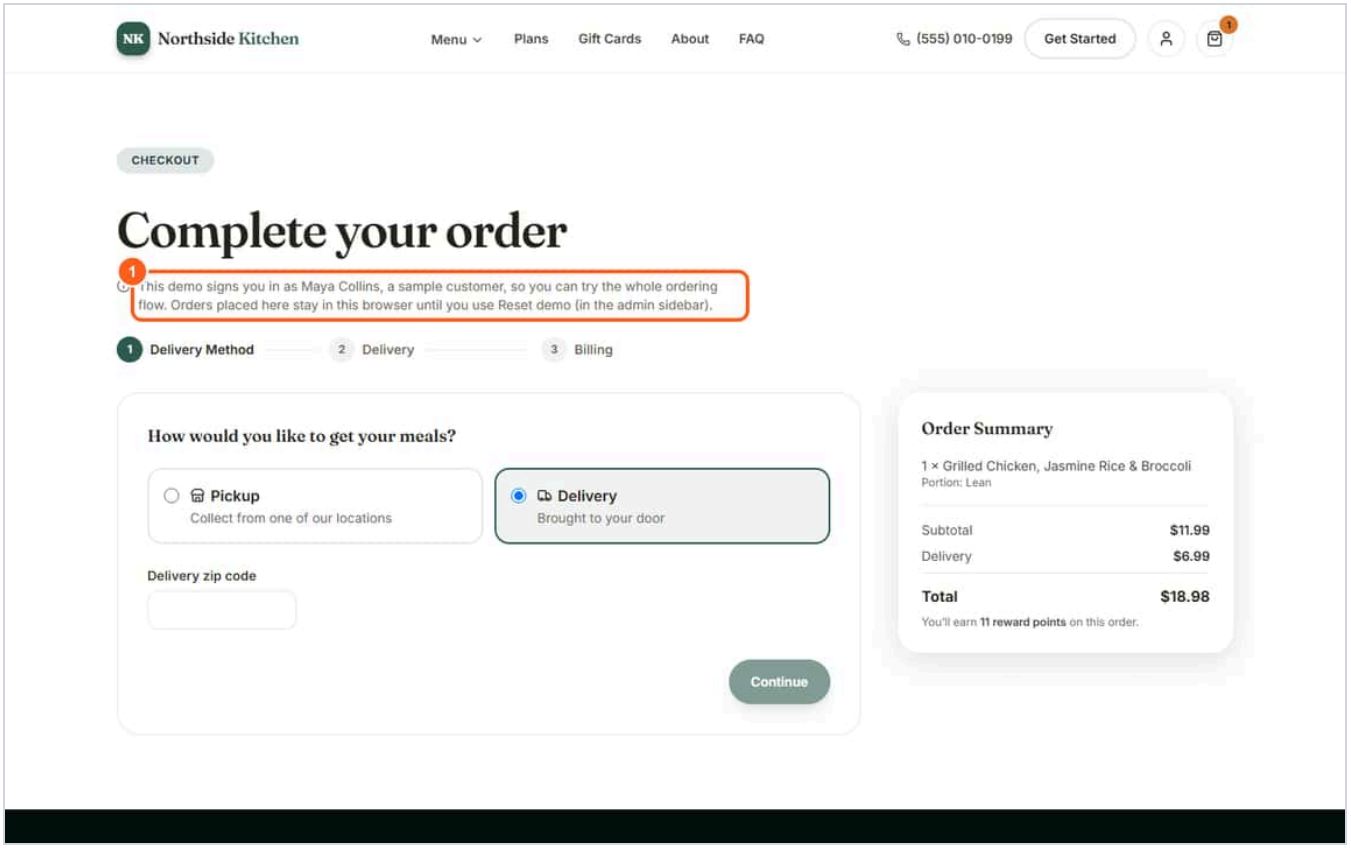
Customers review their order, choose delivery or pickup, and go to checkout.



1. Go to checkout
2. Delivery or pickup

Checkout (demo only, no real payment)

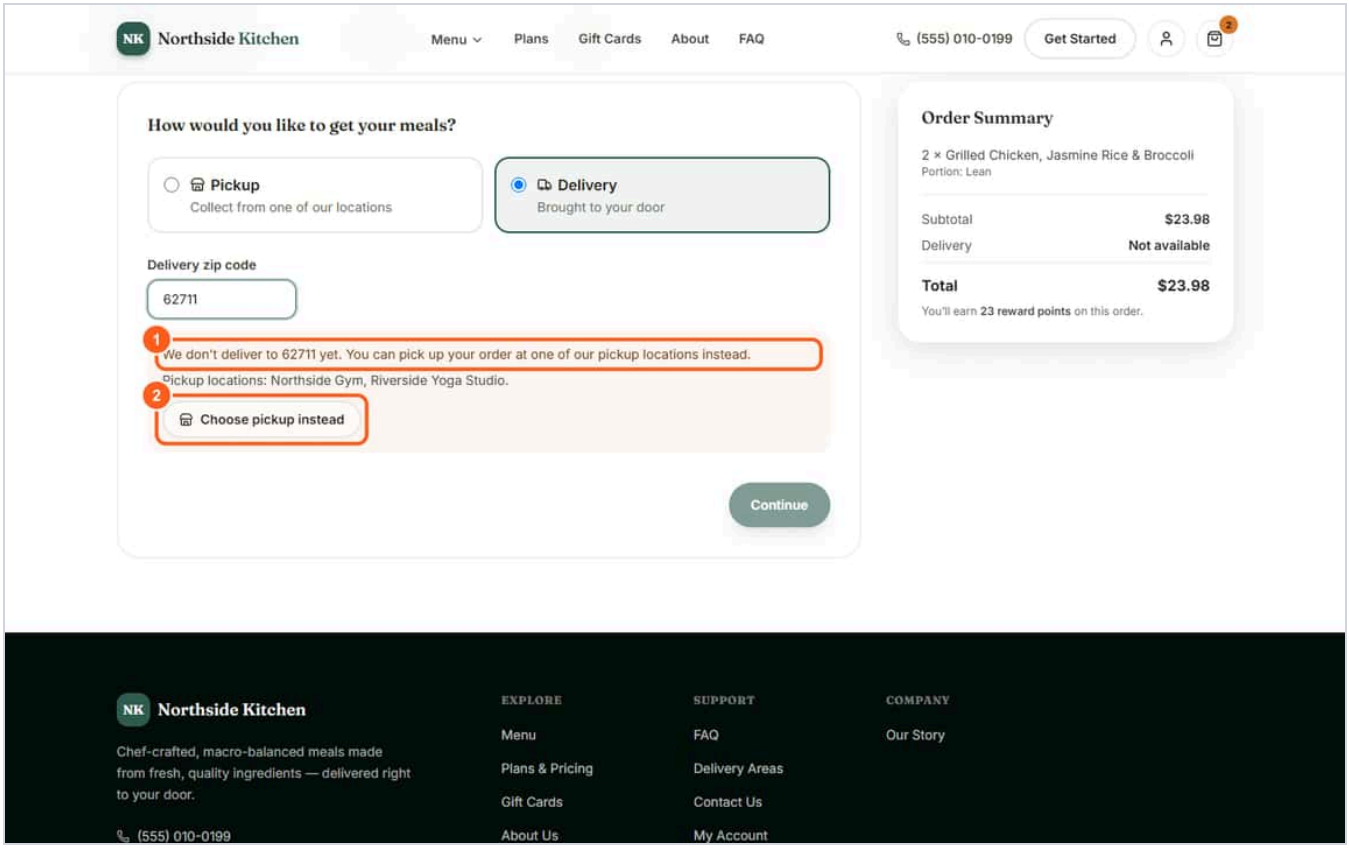
The demo signs you in as a sample customer so you can try the whole flow. No card is charged. In your own system, payments go to your own payment account.



1 This is a demo: nothing is charged

Delivery by ZIP code

At checkout the customer's ZIP code finds their delivery zone: its fee, its delivery day and its minimum order. Outside every zone, the customer is told so and offered your pickup locations instead.

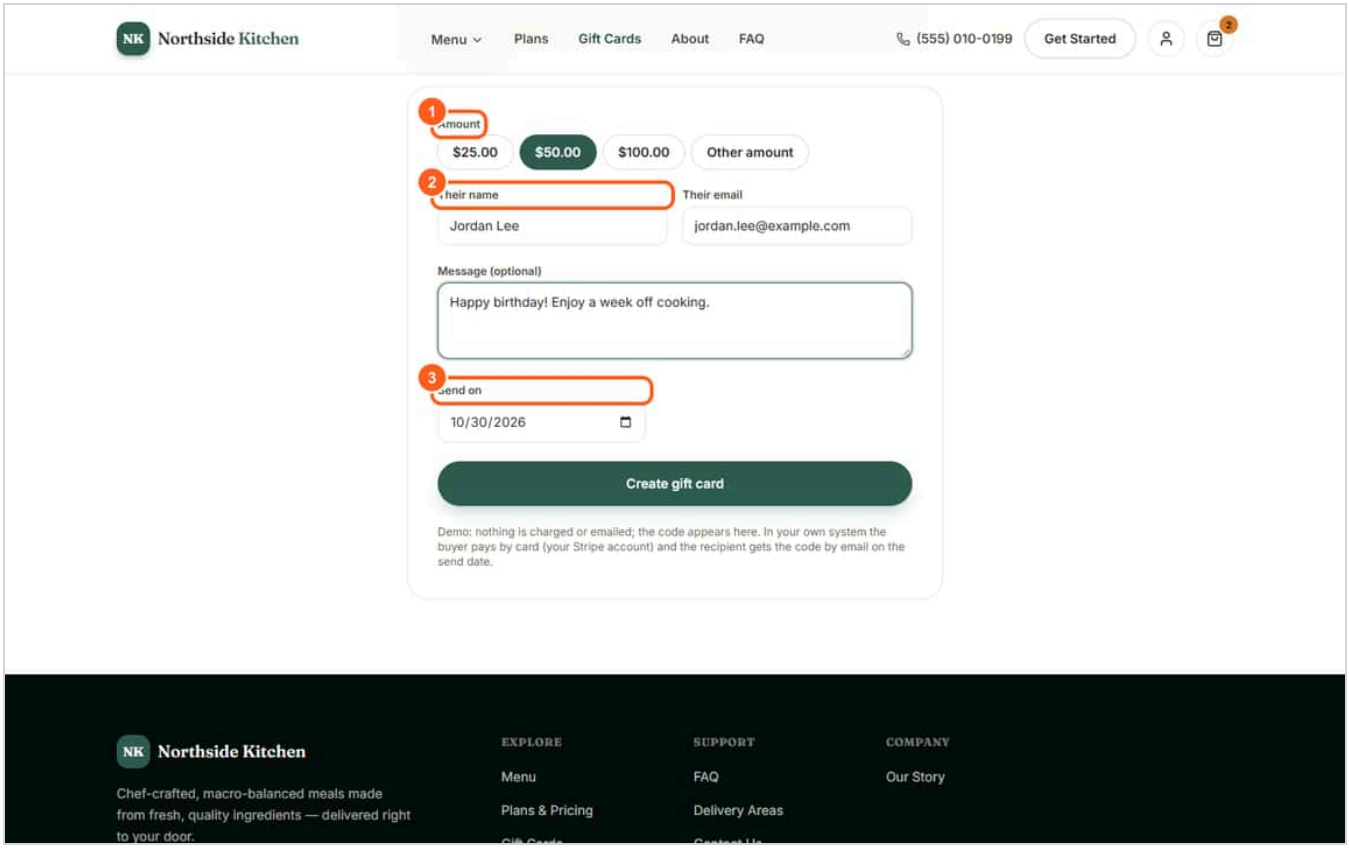


1. Outside the delivery area
2. Pickup instead

Gift cards

Customers buy a gift card for any amount, for someone else, with a message and a send date. It's redeemed at checkout, alone or with a coupon (your choice), and whatever isn't spent stays on the card.

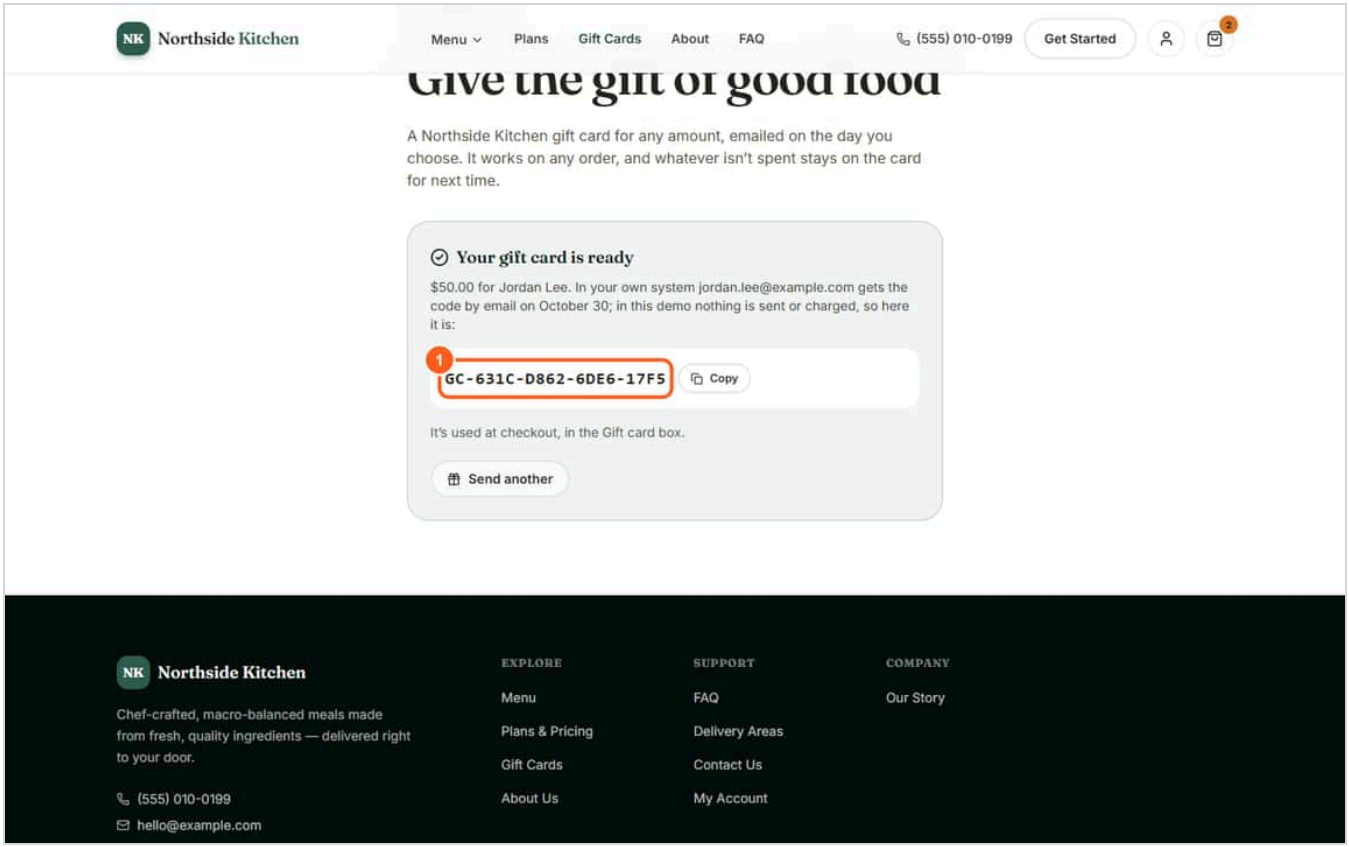
In your own system the buyer pays by card through Stripe and the recipient gets the code by email on the send date.



1. Amount
2. Who it's for
3. Send date

The gift card code (demo)

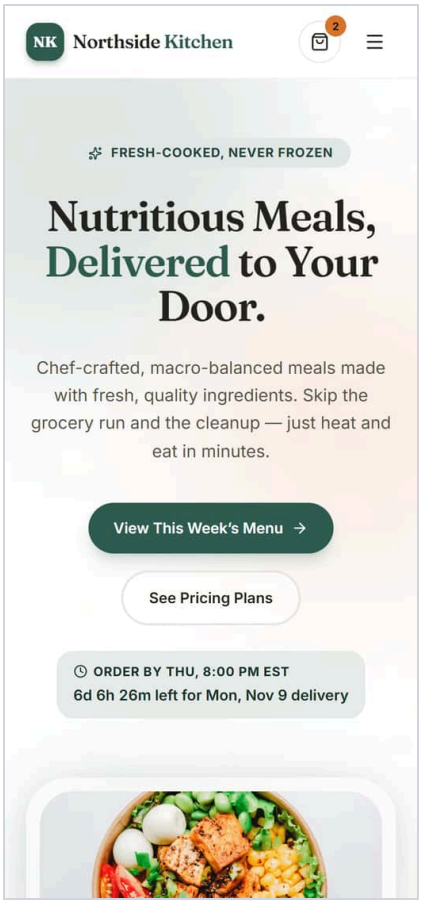
The demo sends no emails, so the code appears on screen. Try it at checkout in the Gift card box.

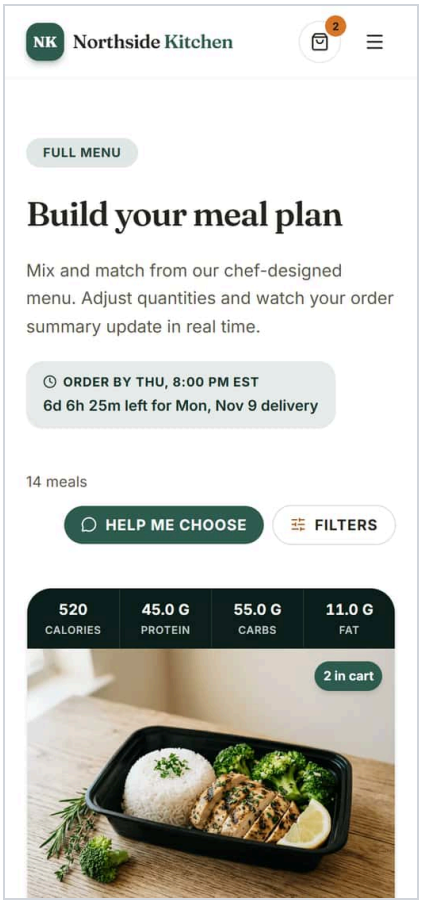


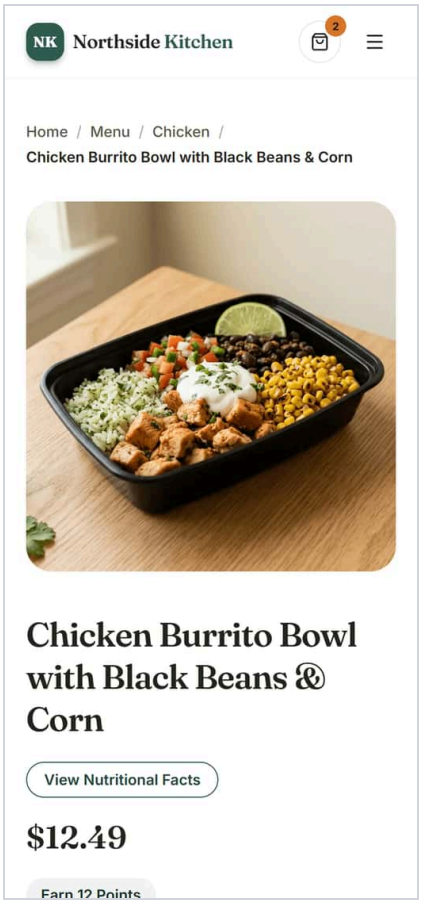
1 The code

On mobile too

Most customers order from their phone. The whole storefront is built for small screens: menu, meal pages, cart and checkout.

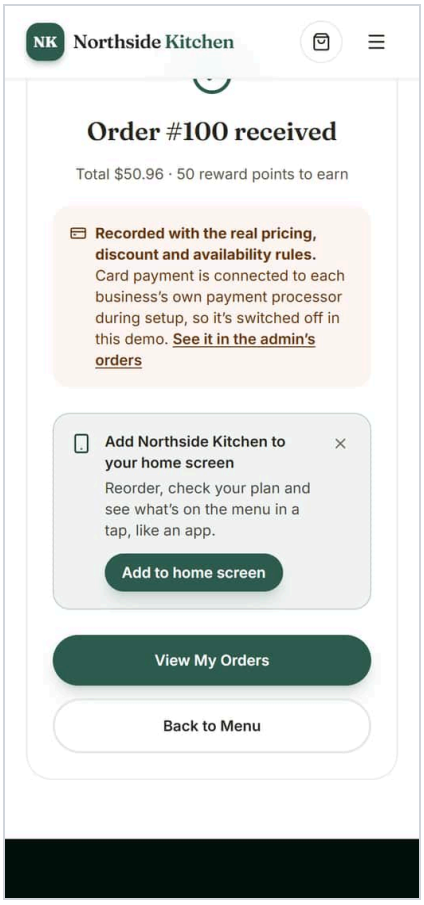


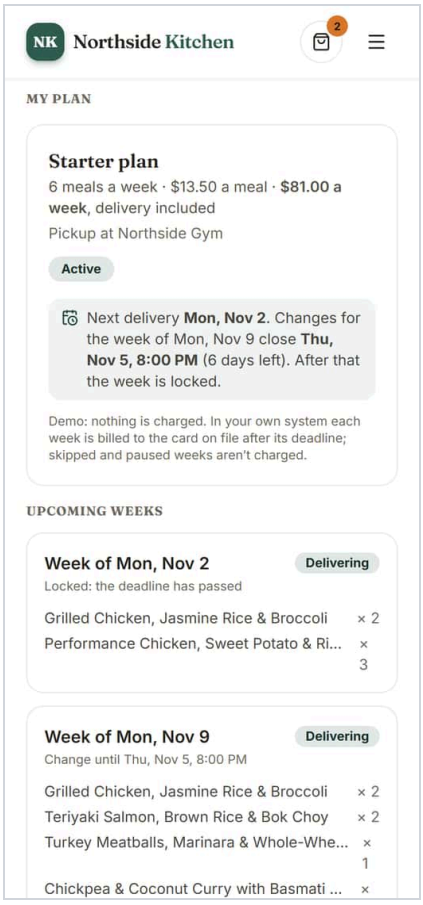




Install it like an app

After their first order, customers are offered to add your store to their home screen. It opens like an app, with your name and icon, and loads fast on repeat visits. On iPhone, the two steps are shown (Share, then Add to Home Screen), since Safari has no install button. Checkout always needs a connection.

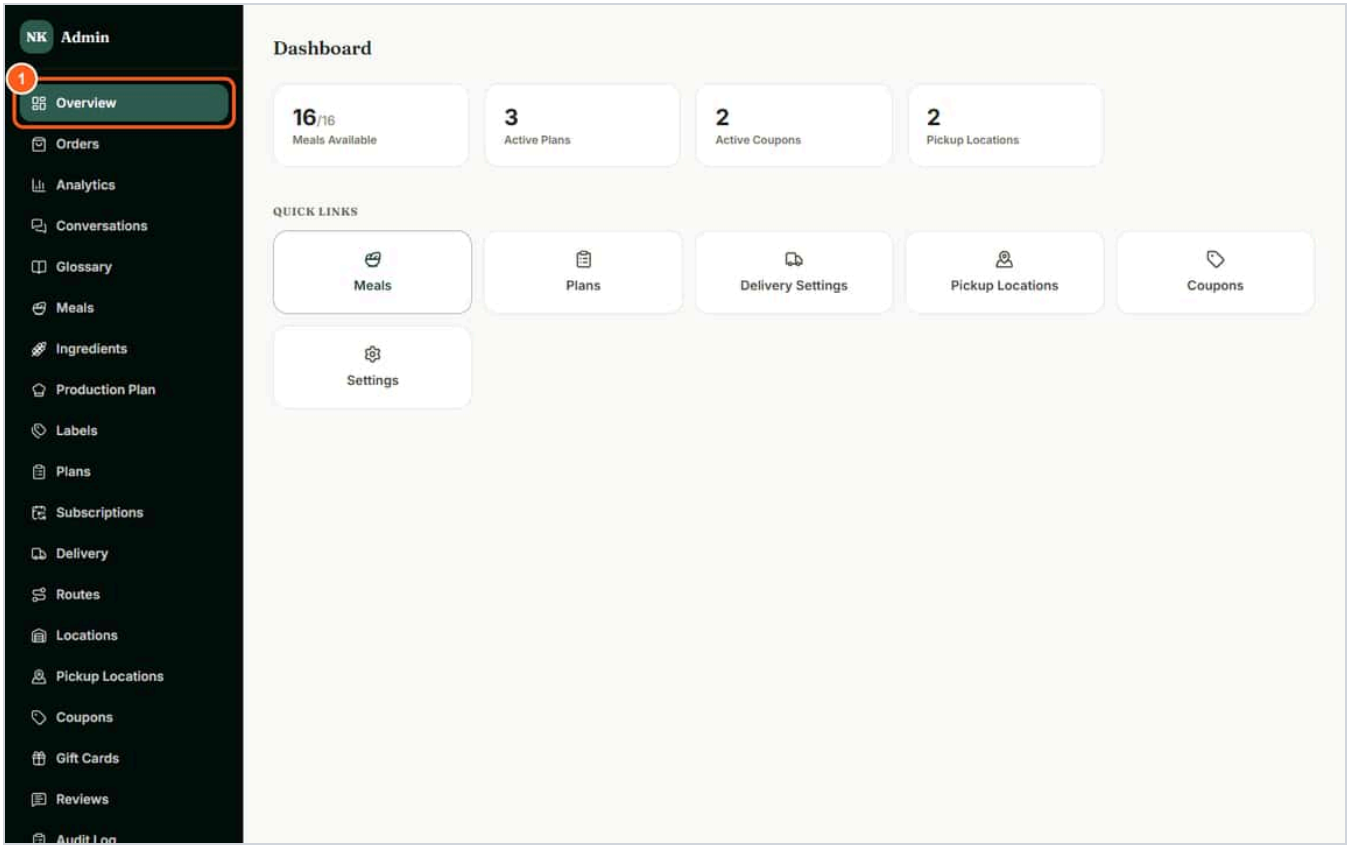




4. THE OWNER SIDE

Overview

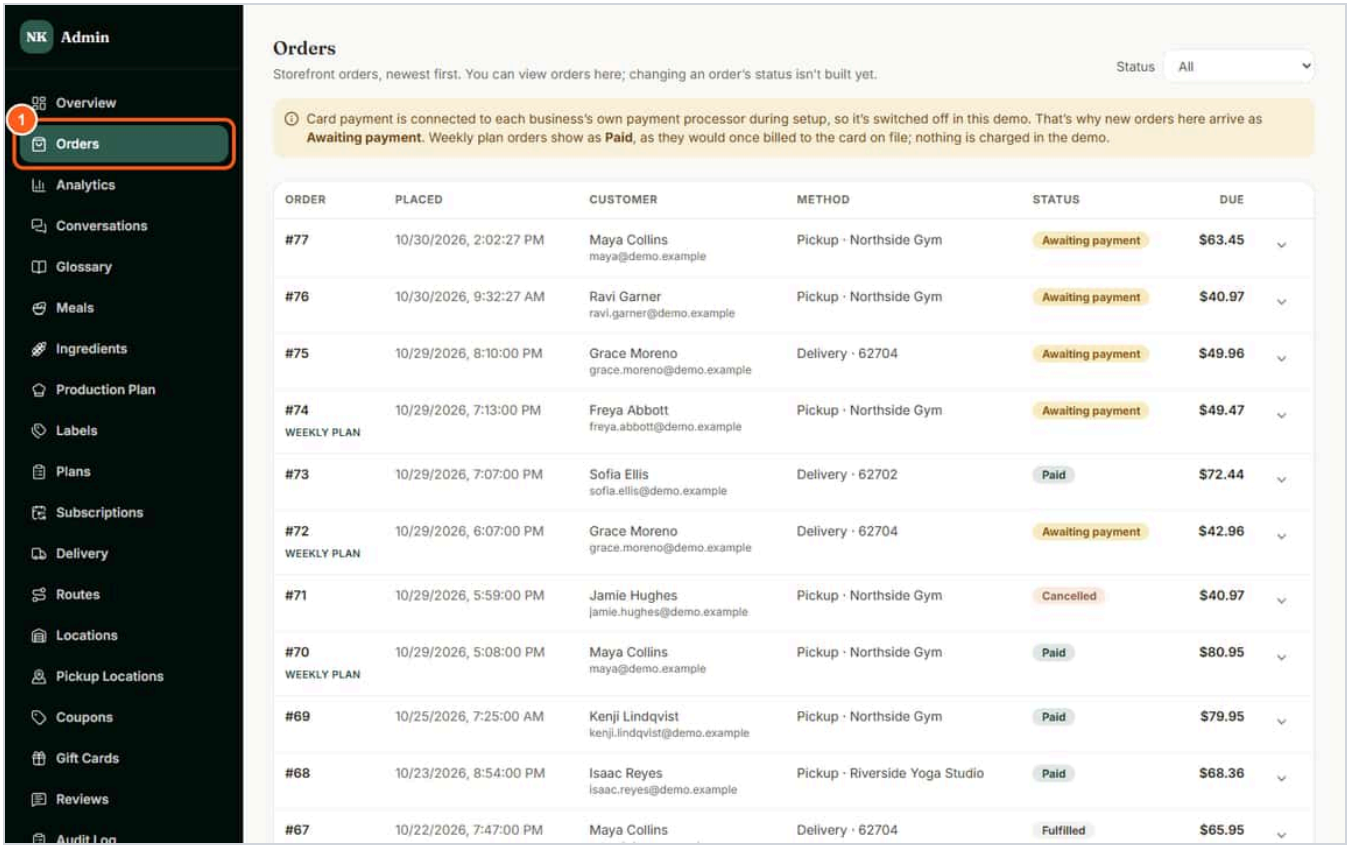
Your dashboard: meals on the menu, active plans, coupons and pickup locations, with quick links to each.



1 Overview

Orders

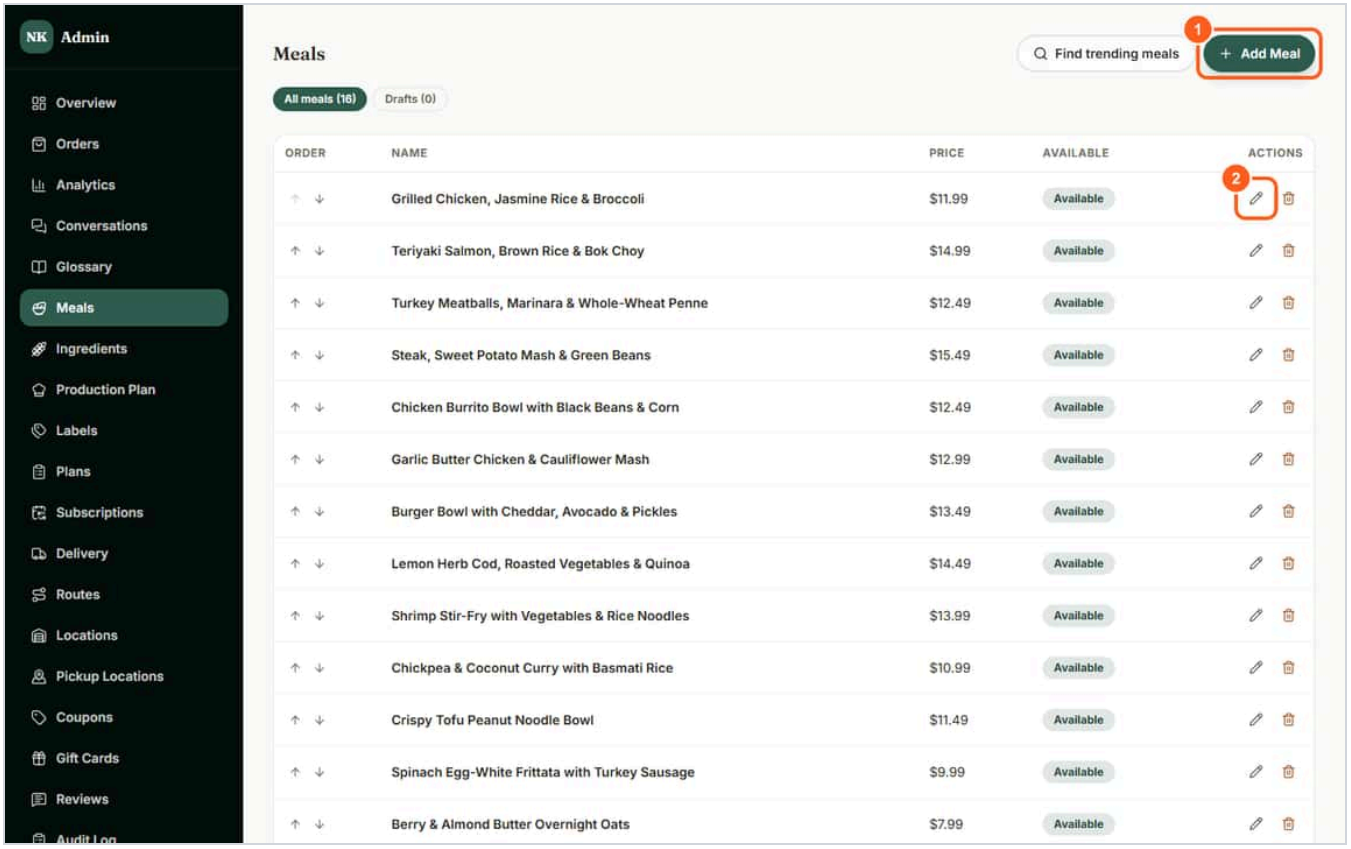
Every order, newest first: who, when, delivery or pickup, and its status. Orders from weekly plans are marked, and a failed card payment is flagged.



1 Orders

Meals

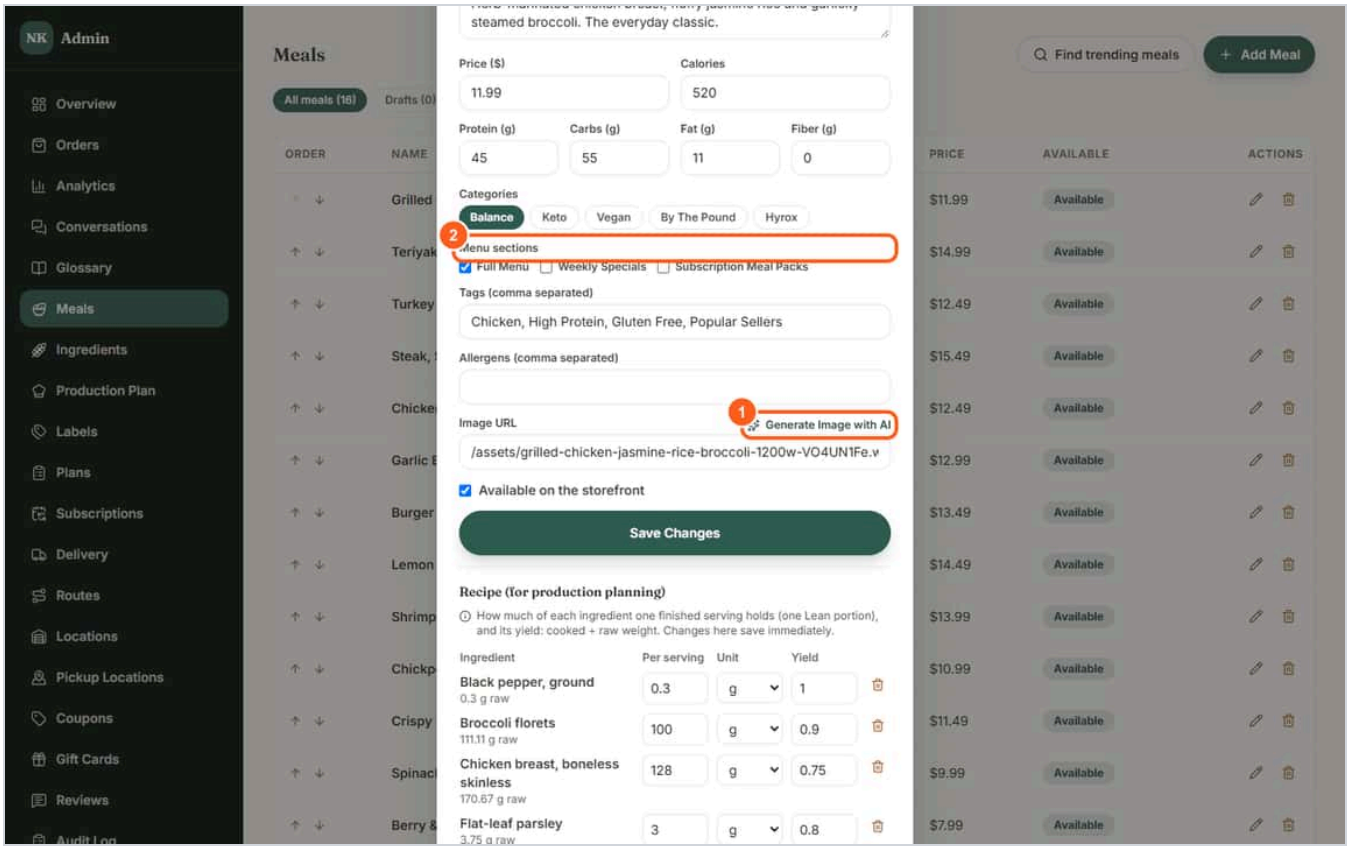
Your menu. Add a meal, edit one, change the order it appears in, or take it off the menu.



1. Add a meal
2. Edit a meal

Edit a meal and its photo

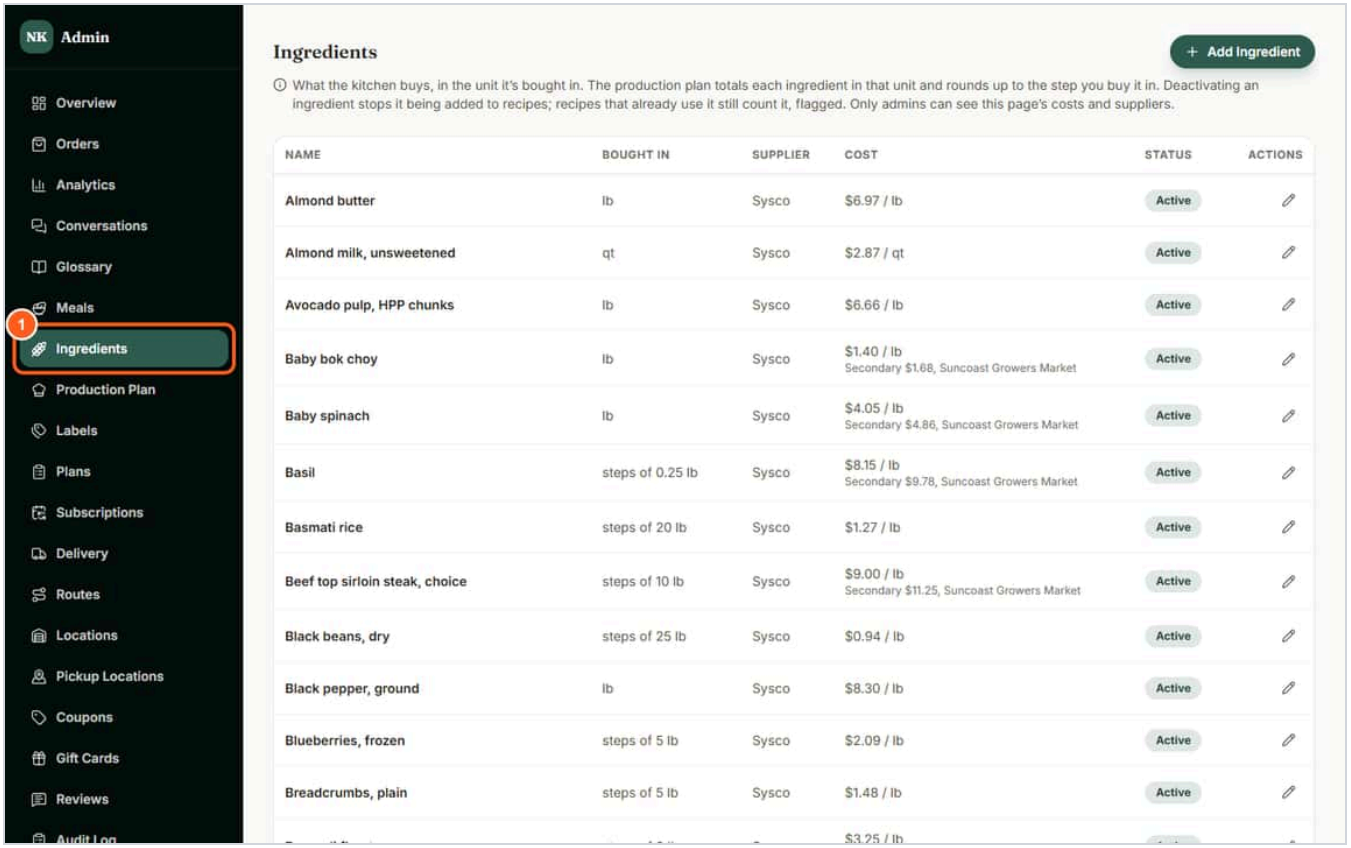
Change the name, price, nutrition, categories and which menu pages it appears on. In your own system, Generate Image with AI makes a photo of the dish in your menu's style, checks it against the dish's ingredients, and waits for your approval; in the public demo it's turned off.



1. Make a photo with AI
2. Where it appears on the menu

Ingredients

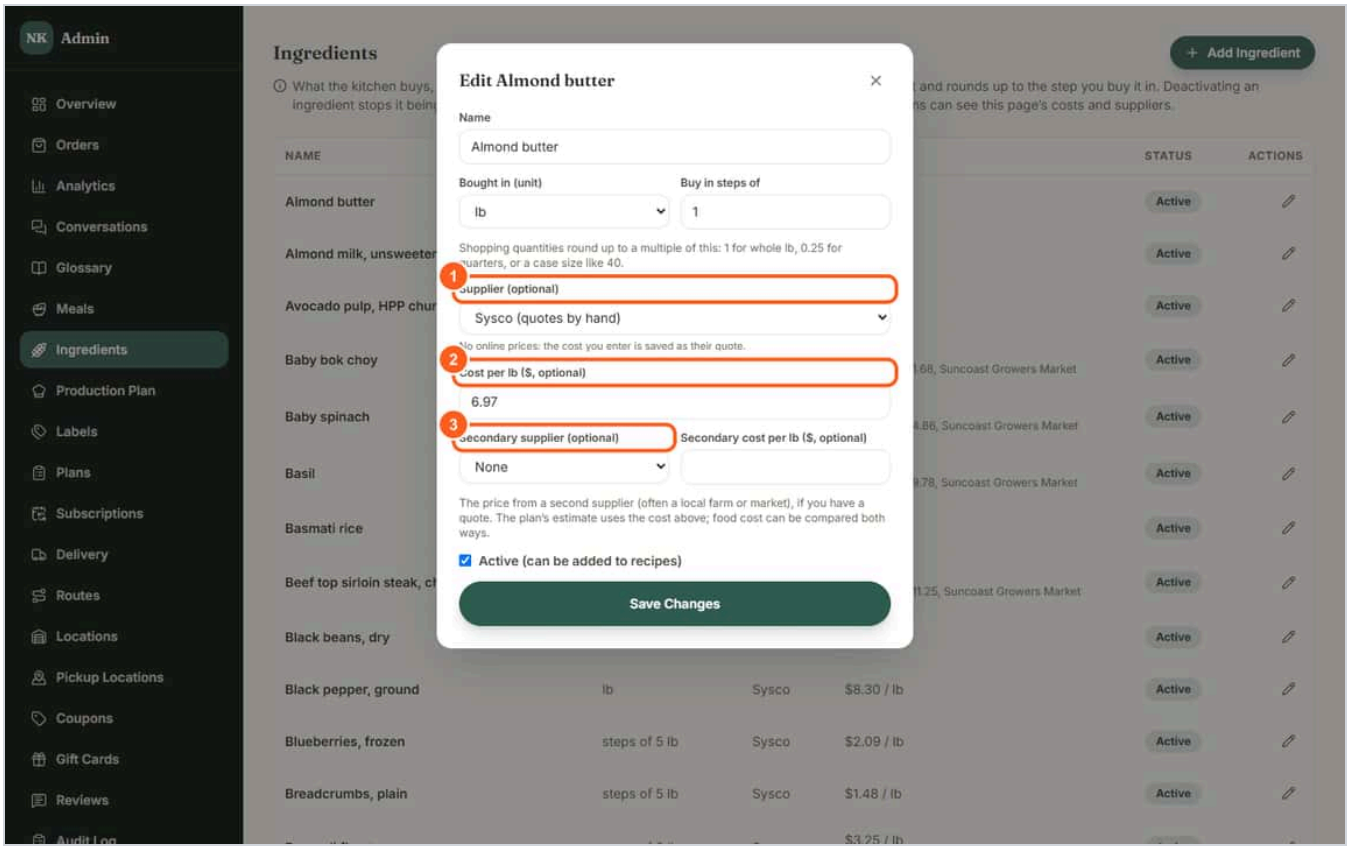
Everything you buy, how you buy it (by the pound, by the case) and what it costs. Recipes and costs are worked out from this list.



1 Ingredients

Pick a supplier for each ingredient

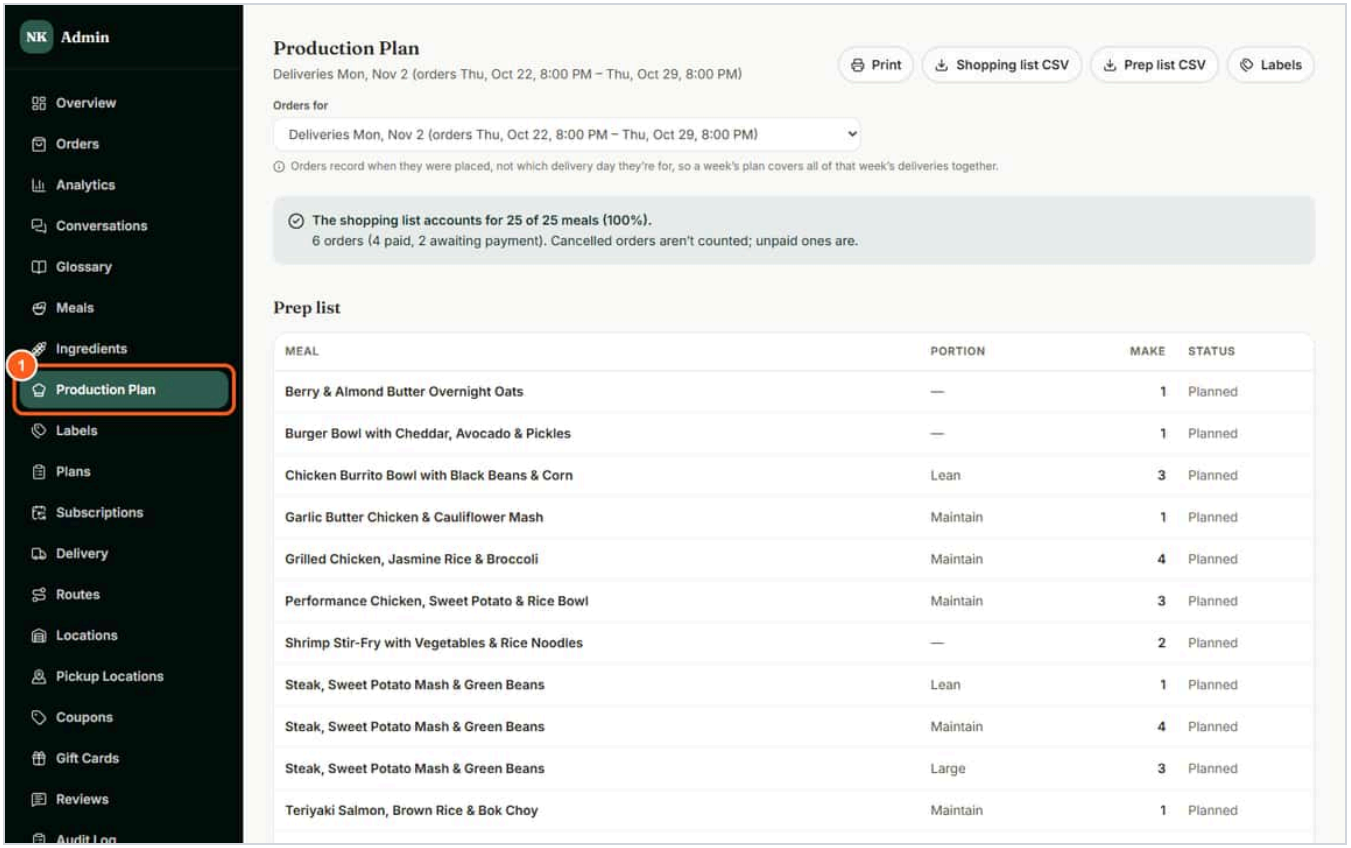
Choose the supplier from your list, grouped by type, and enter the cost. If that supplier has no prices online (like Sysco), the cost you enter is saved as their quote. You can add a second supplier and price to compare.



1. Supplier
2. Cost
3. Second supplier

Production Plan: what to cook

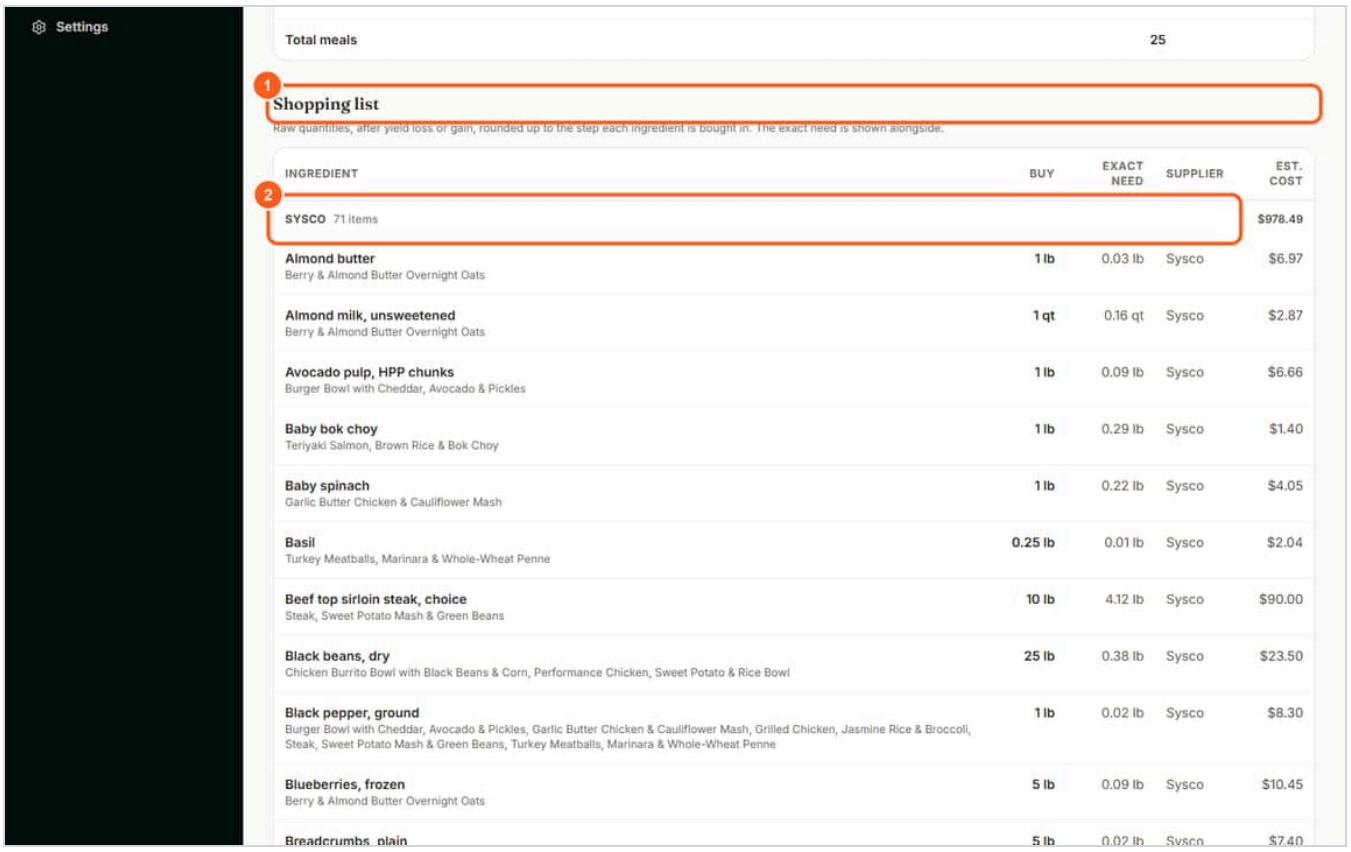
Pick a delivery week and get the prep list: how many of each meal and portion to make, from that week's orders and weekly plans. Skipped and paused weeks are left out.



1 Production Plan

Shopping lists by supplier

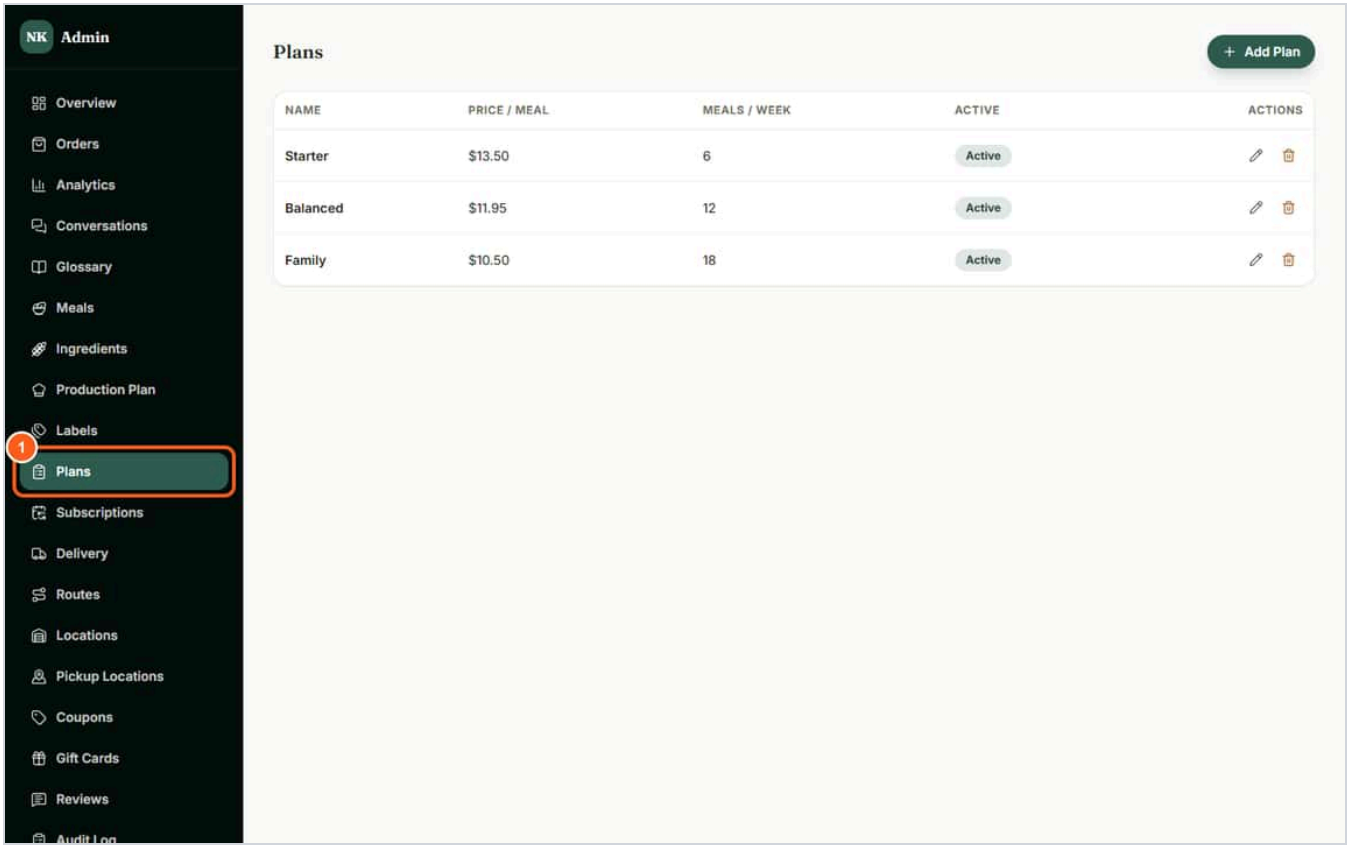
Further down: everything to buy, rounded to how you buy it, with one list per supplier and its estimated cost. Print it or download it as a spreadsheet.



1. Shopping list
2. One list per supplier

Plans

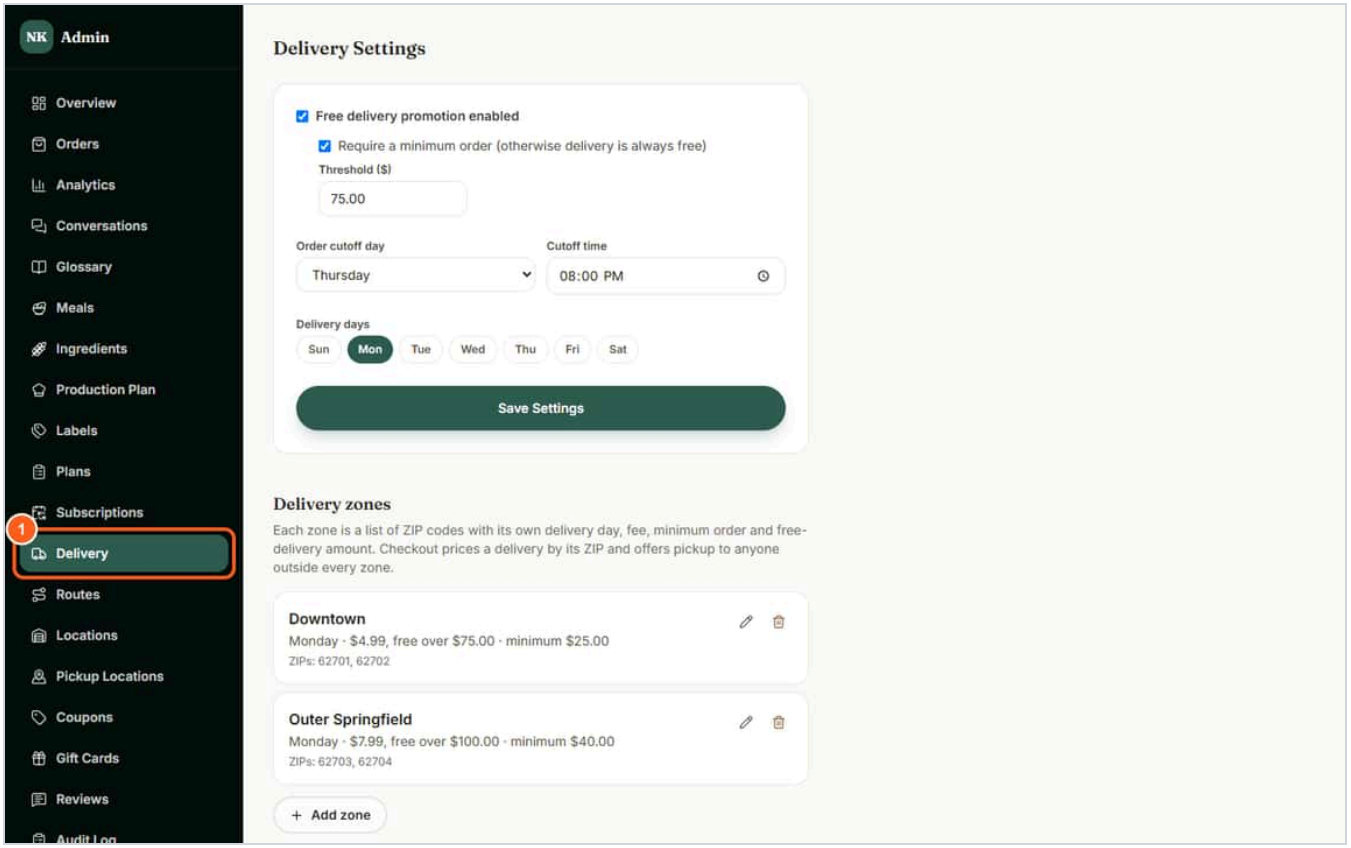
The weekly plans customers can choose: meals per week and price per meal. Who is on which plan is under Subscriptions (section 5).



1 Plans

Delivery

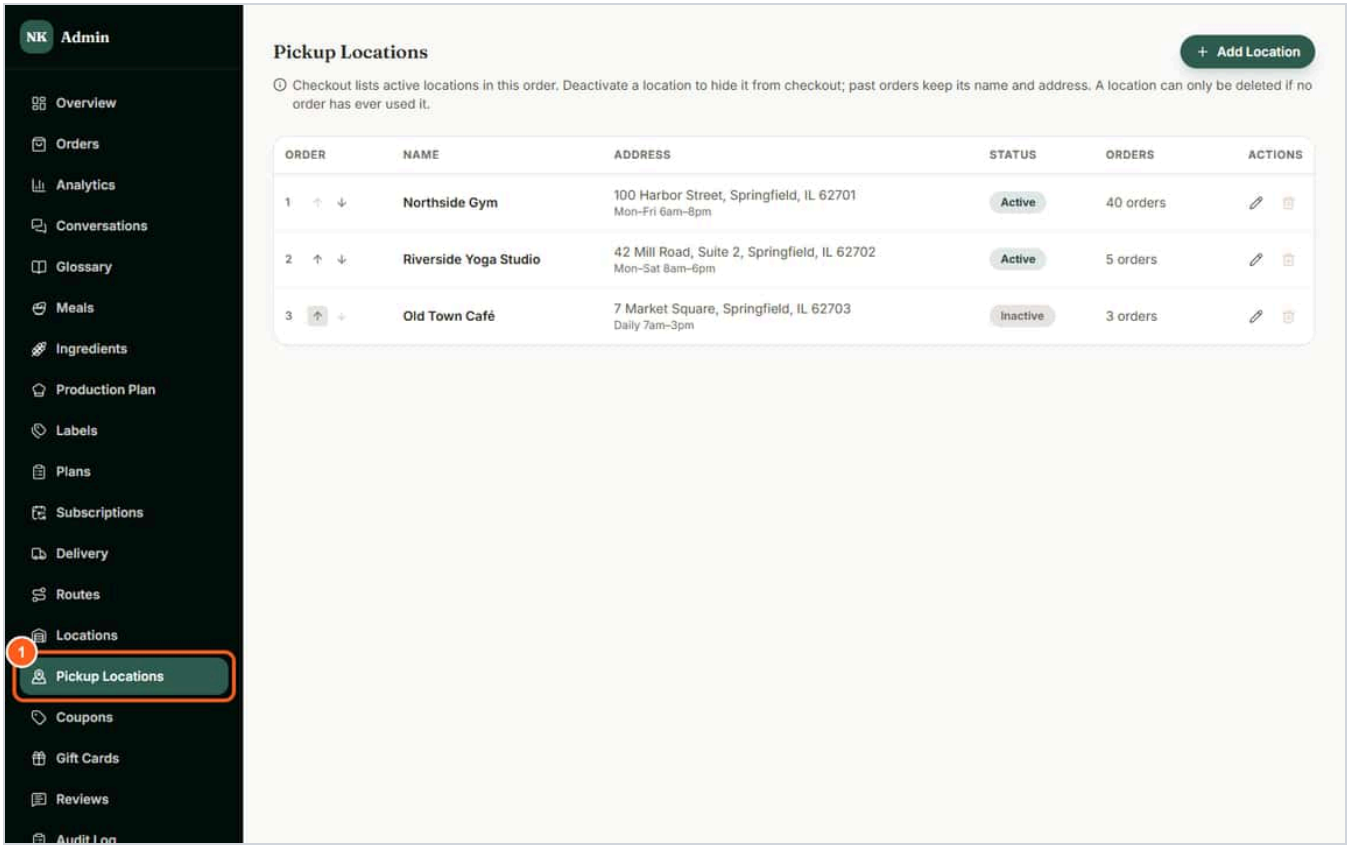
Your ordering deadline, delivery days and free-delivery threshold. Delivery zones are further down this page (section 5).



1 Delivery

Pickup locations

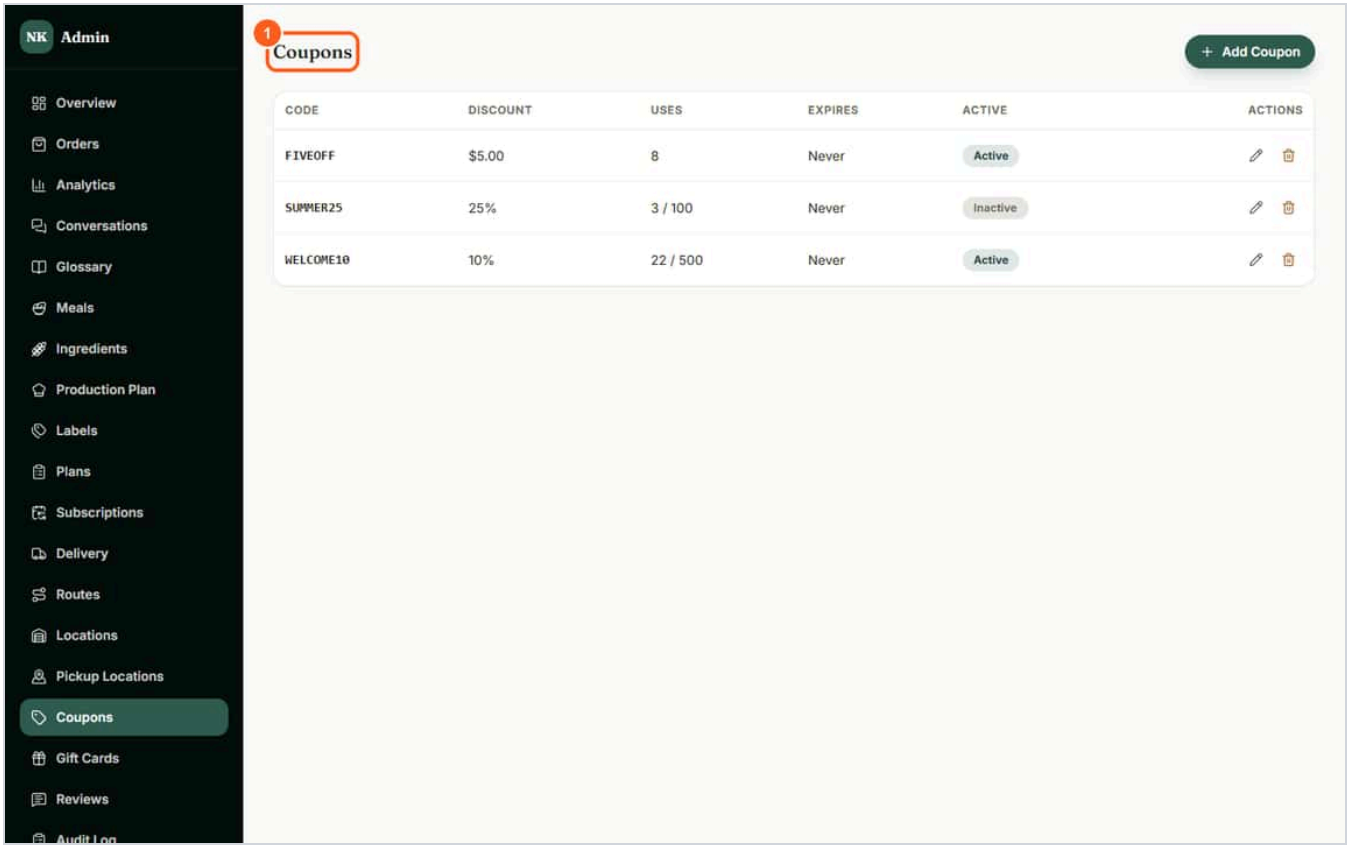
The places customers can collect their meals, like a gym or a studio. Turn one off to hide it at checkout.



1 Pickup Locations

Coupons

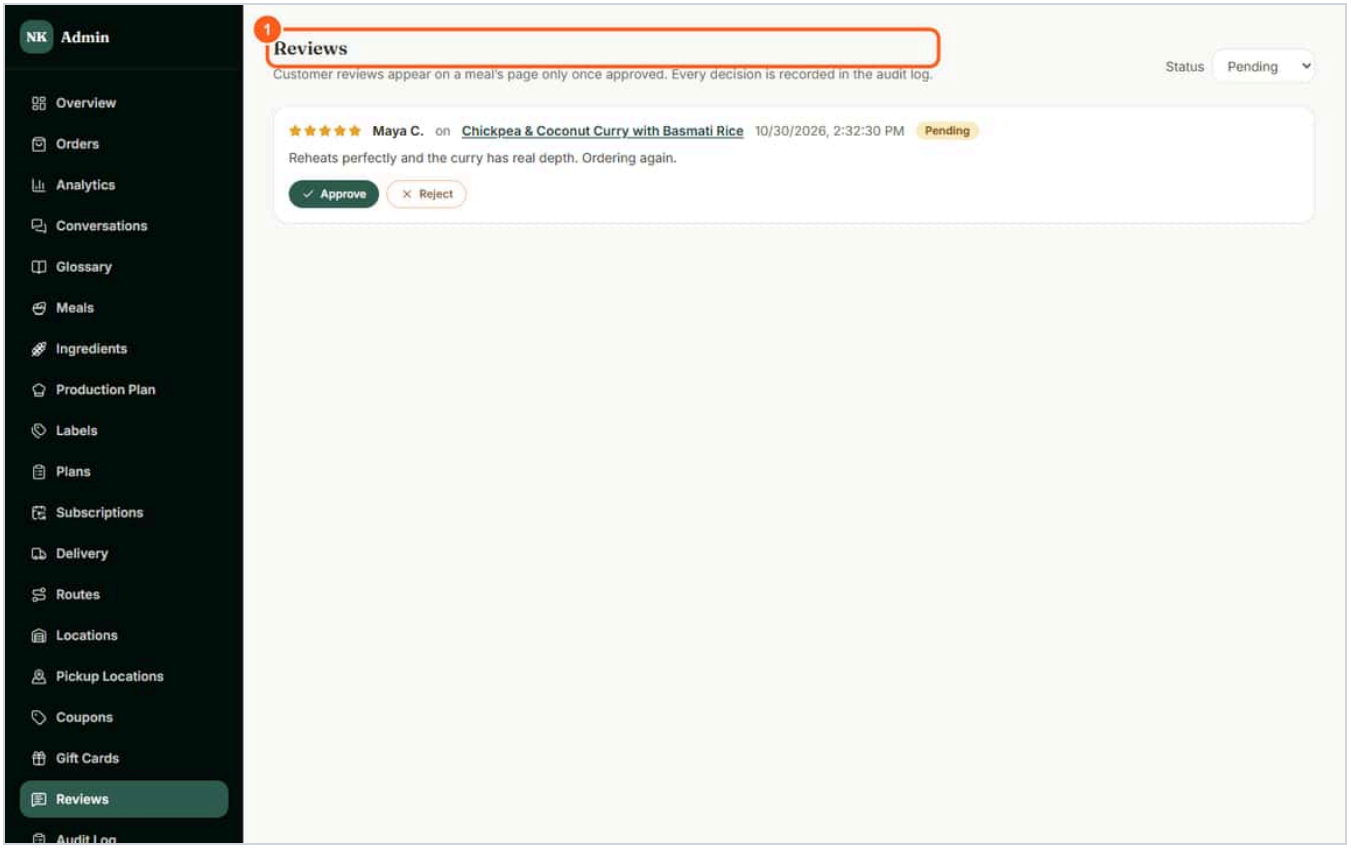
Discount codes: a percentage or an amount off, with a limit on uses and an end date.



1 Coupons

Reviews

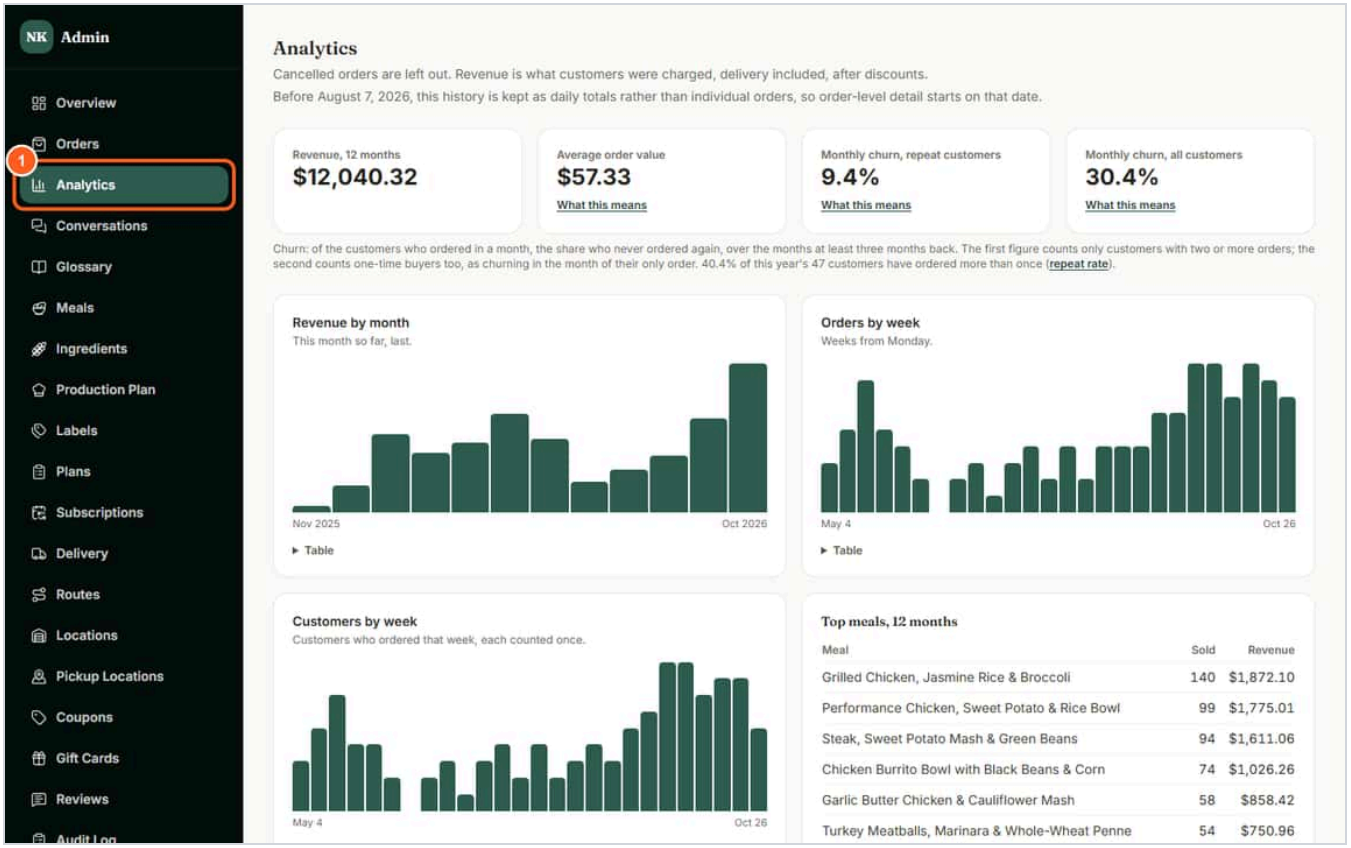
Customer reviews appear on a meal's page only after you approve them.



1 Reviews

Analytics

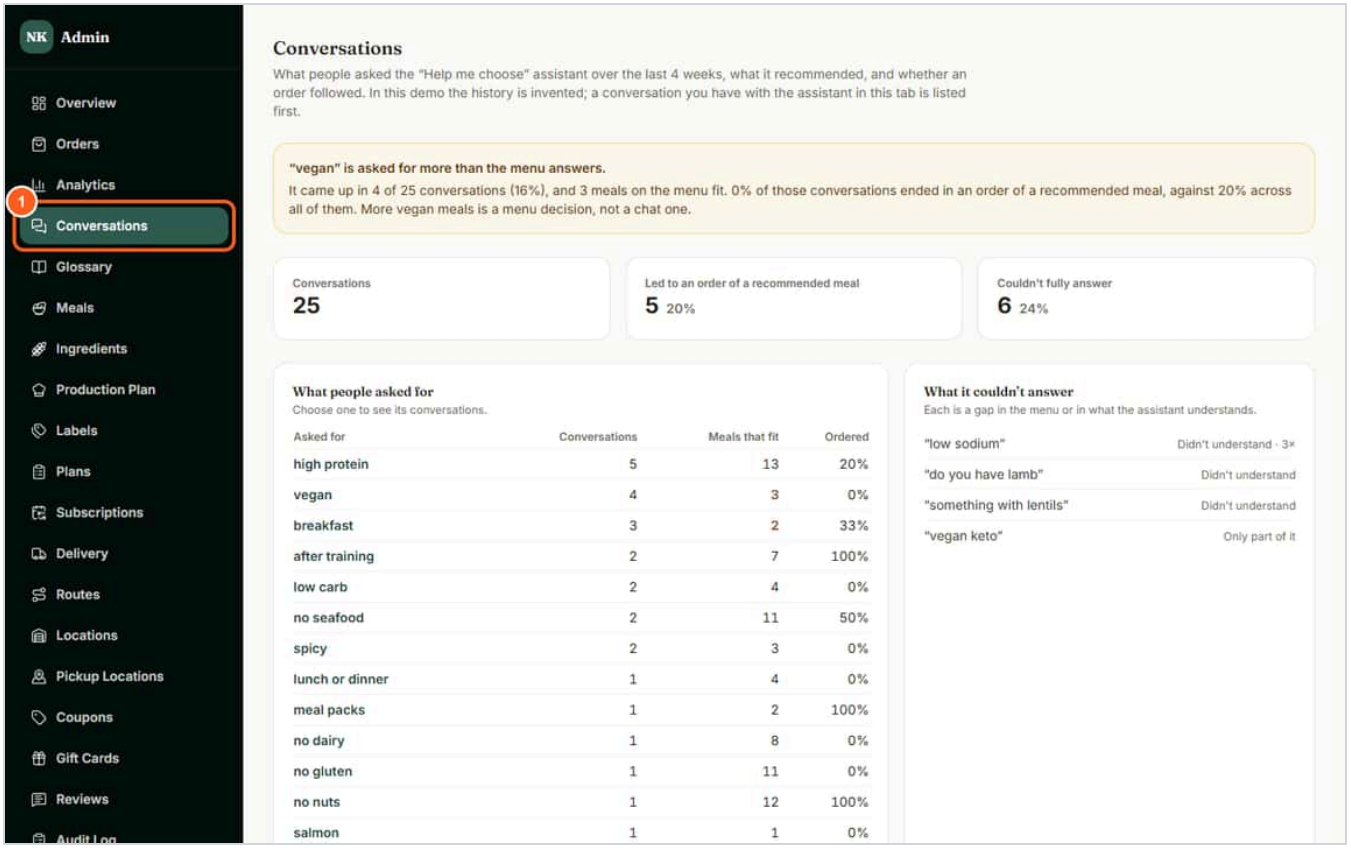
Revenue, orders, customers and your best-selling meals, week by week and month by month. Further down: weekly plan subscribers, skips, pauses and cancellations by week.



1 Analytics

Conversations

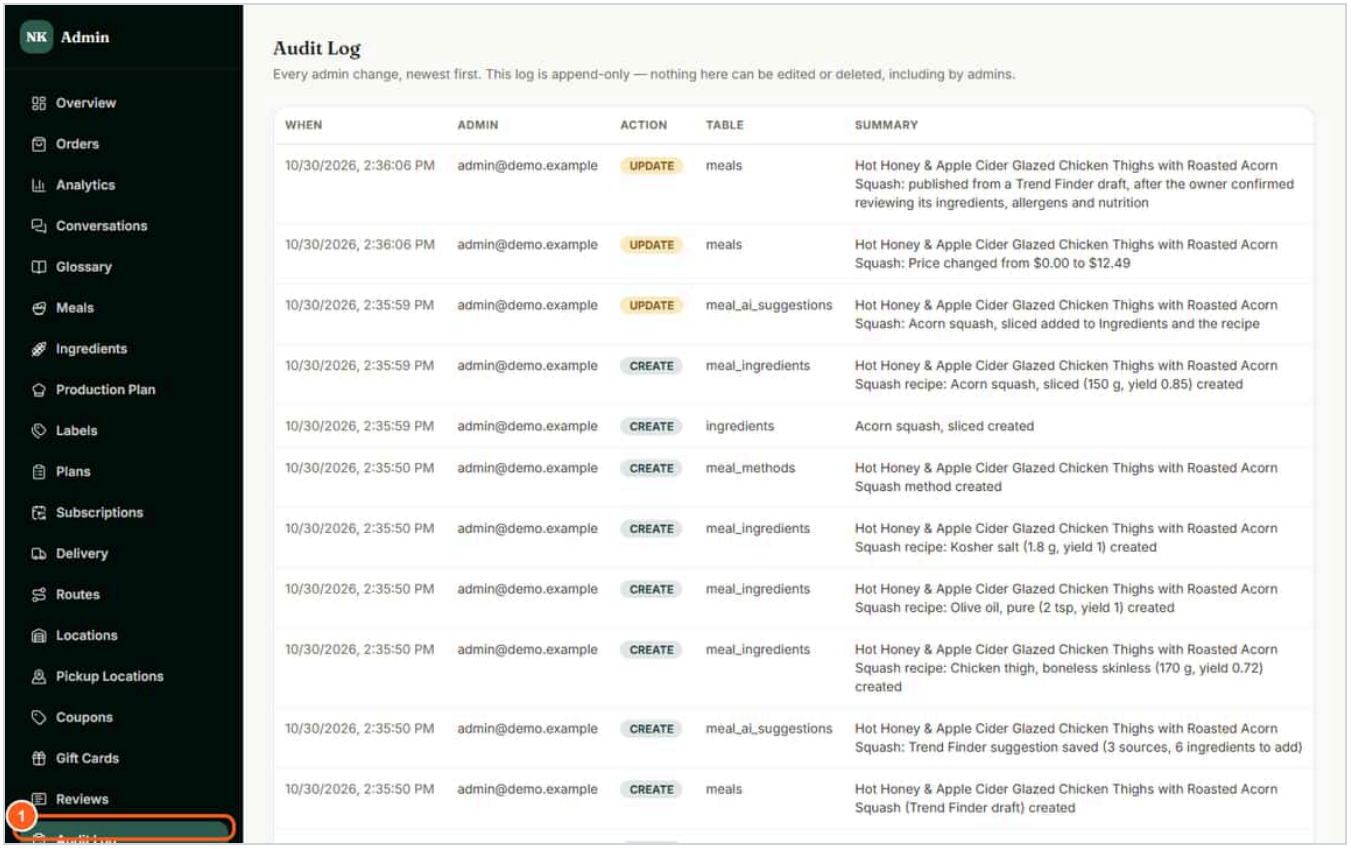
What customers ask the “Help me choose” assistant, and what it couldn't answer: a quick read on what to add to your menu.



1 Conversations

Audit Log

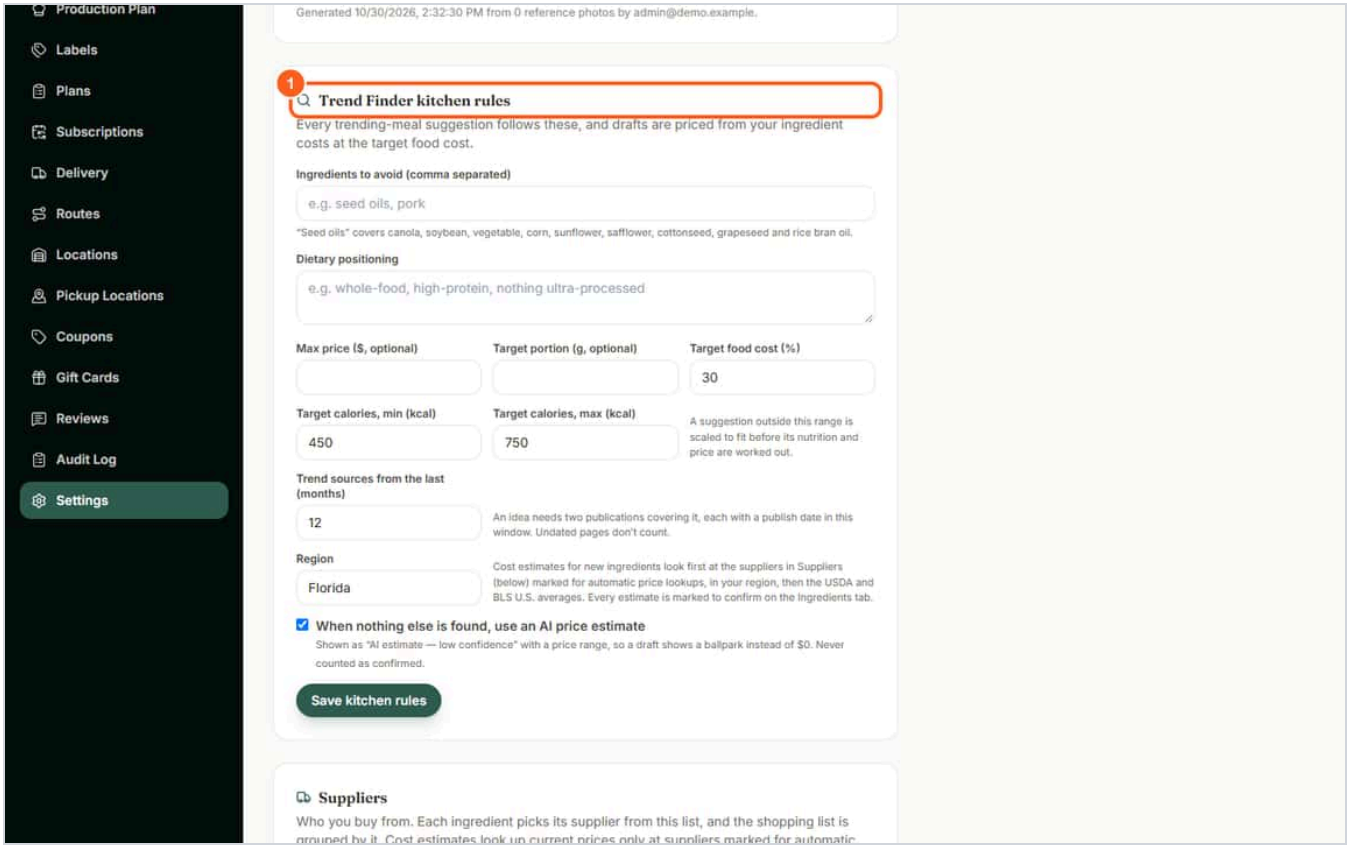
Every change made in the admin, who made it and when. Nothing here can be edited or deleted.



1 Audit Log

Settings: kitchen rules

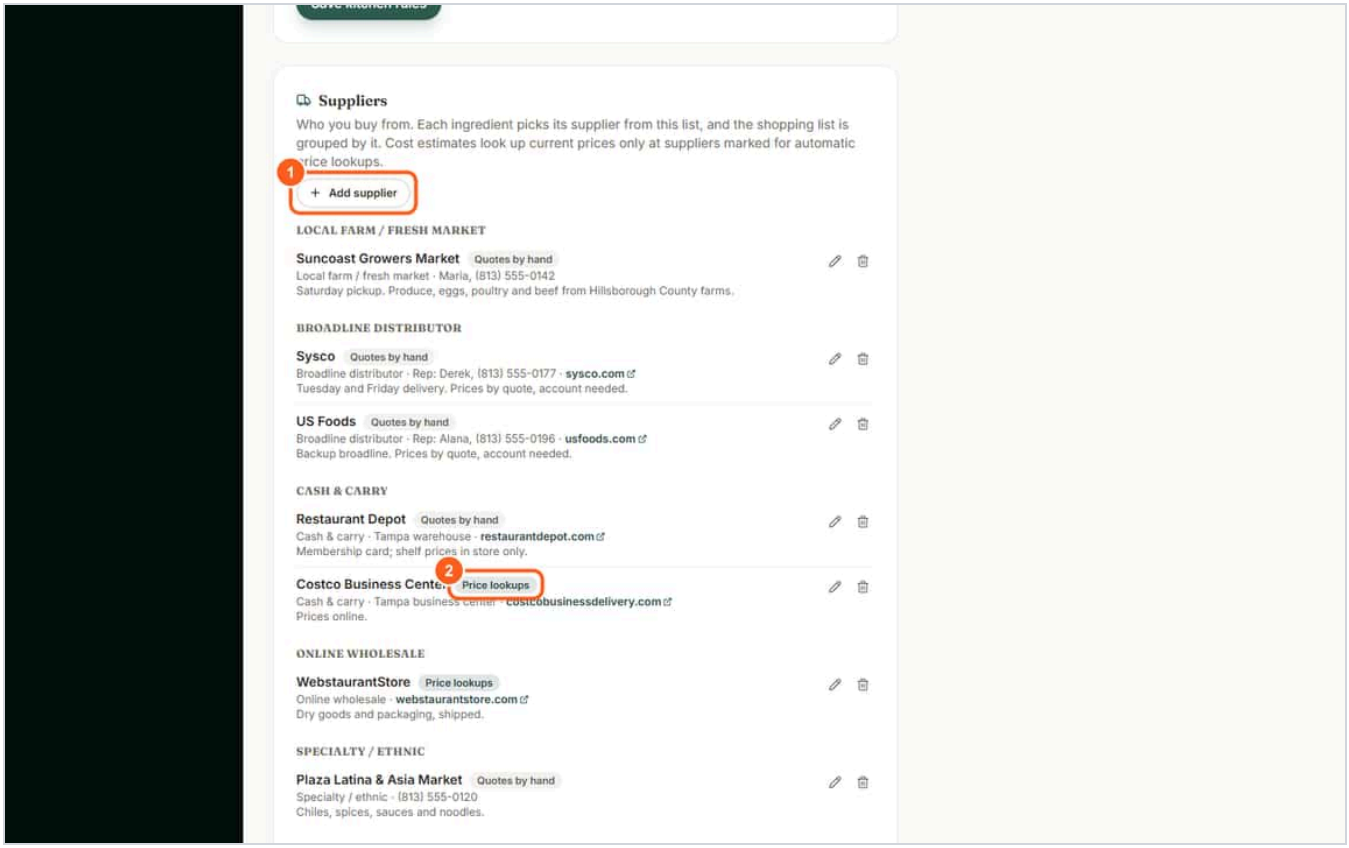
Tell Trend Finder what every new meal must follow: ingredients to avoid, your style, target price, portion, calories and food cost.



1 Kitchen rules

Settings: your suppliers

Your list of suppliers: local farms and markets, distributors, cash & carry, online and specialty stores. Mark the ones with public online prices so cost estimates can look them up.

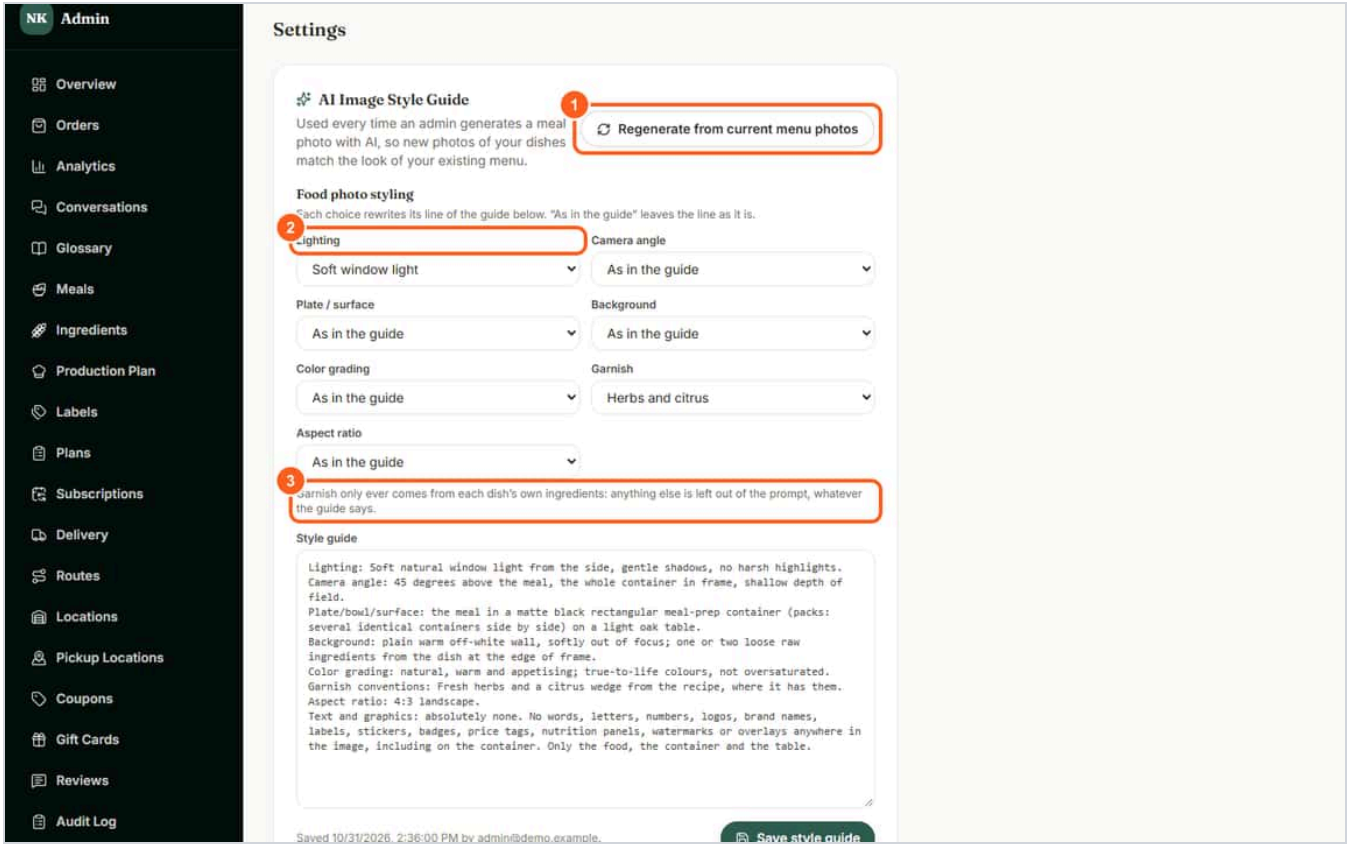


1. Add a supplier
2. Looked up for prices

Food photo styling

Styling options that make your real dishes look their best in every AI photo, matched to your existing menu photos. Start from a style guide written from your own photos, then choose the lighting, camera angle, plate or surface, background, color grading (from true to life up to natural, never oversaturated), garnish and shape.

Garnish only ever comes from each dish's own ingredients: anything else is left out before the photo is made.

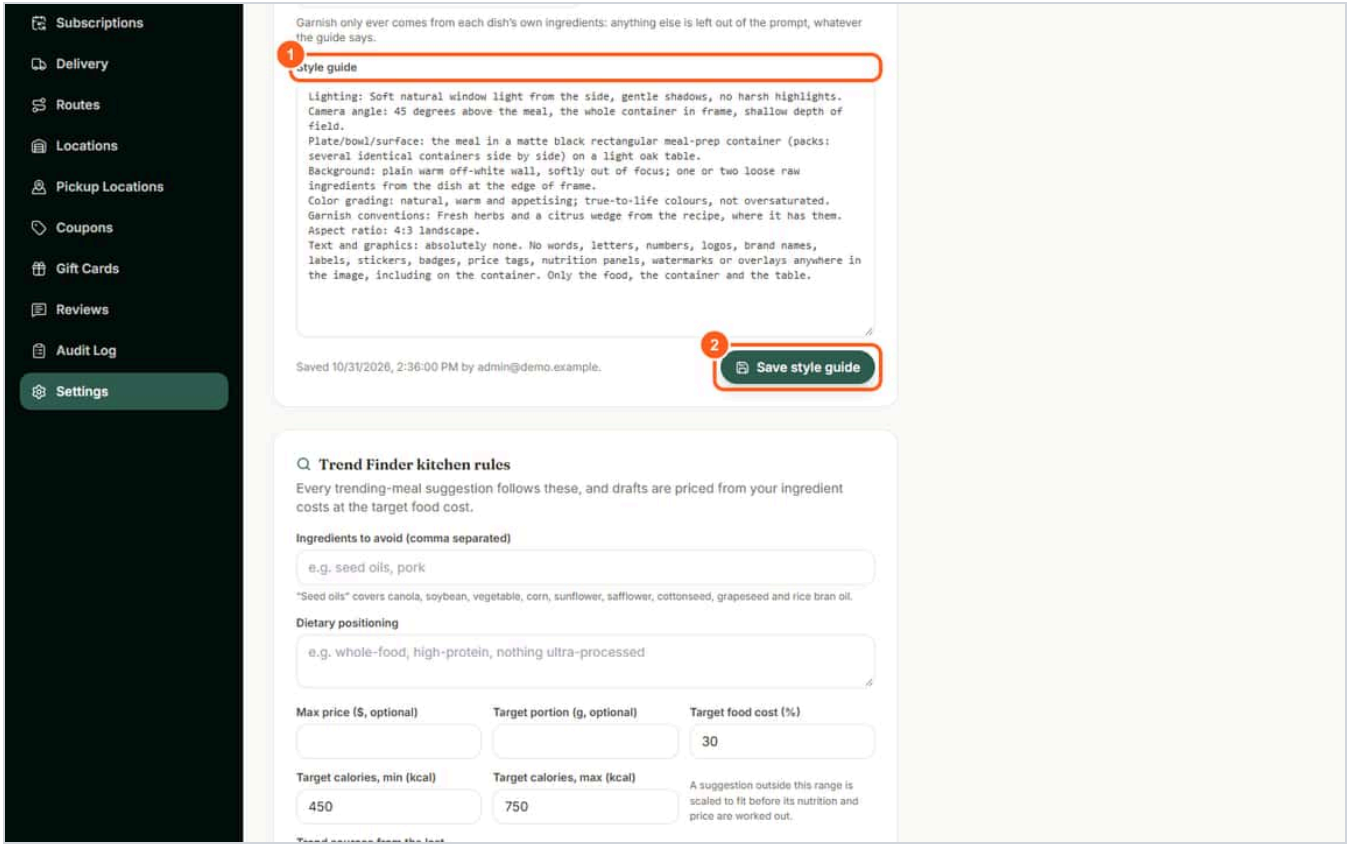


1. Start from your menu's photos
2. Styling options
3. Garnish from each dish's ingredients

Food photo styling: check and approve

Each choice rewrites its line of the style guide, and you can edit the text yourself. Saving keeps the earlier versions and records the change in the Audit Log.

Every AI photo is then checked against the dish's ingredients and allergens: a photo that shows anything that isn't in the recipe isn't used, and you see why. A photo that passes waits for your approval before it appears on your menu. The check catches visible extras only; you stay responsible for your menu and labels. In the public demo the styling options work; making photos is turned off.



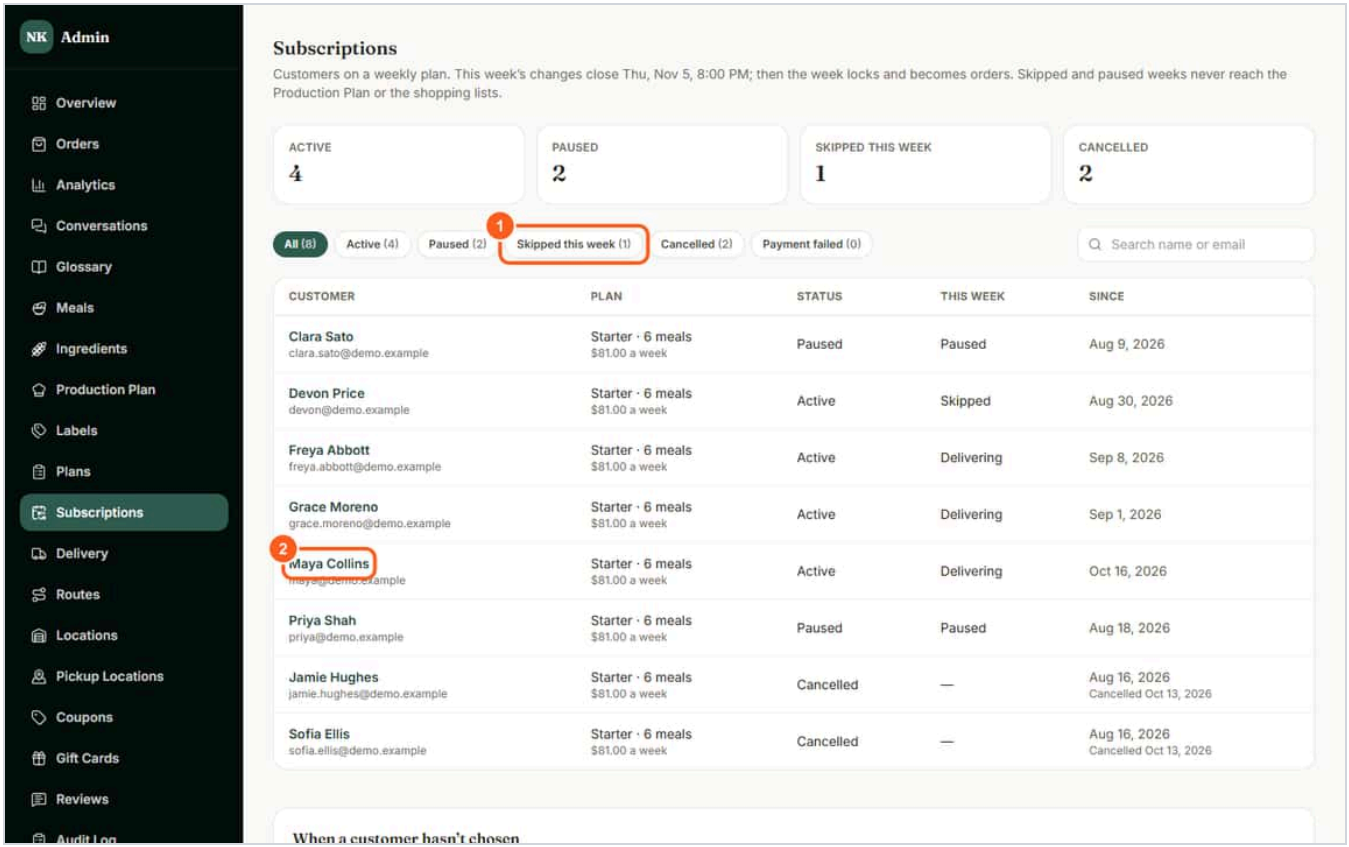
1. The style guide, editable
2. Save

5. PLANS, DELIVERY, LABELS AND LOCATIONS

Subscriptions: everyone on a weekly plan

Every subscriber, with their plan and what they're doing this week: delivering, skipping or paused. Filter by active, paused, skipping this week, cancelled or failed payment, and search by name.

Below the list you choose what a customer gets when they don't pick their meals: their favorites or your chef's picks.

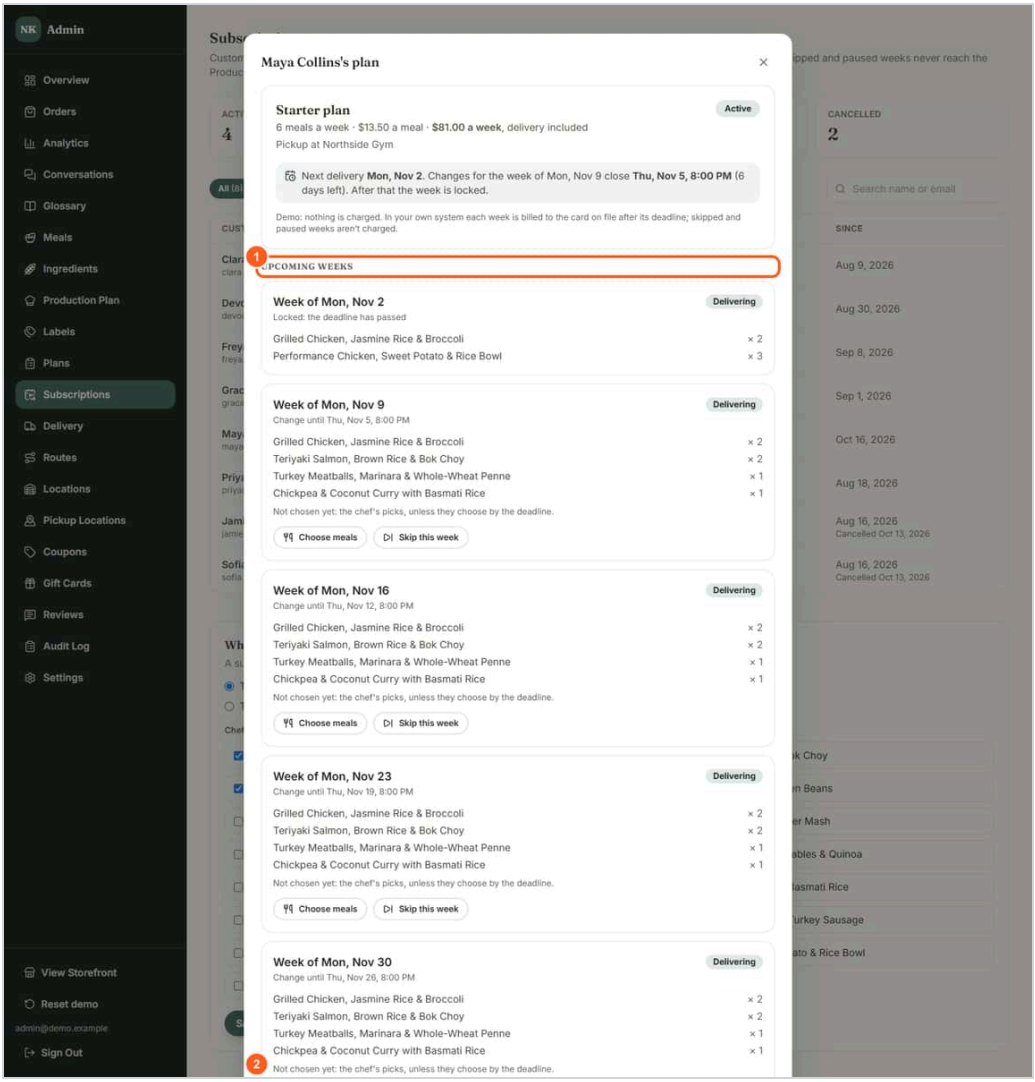


1. Filter the list
2. Open a customer's plan

Change a plan for a customer

Open a customer to see exactly what they see, and make changes for them: skip a week, choose meals, pause, change meals per week or cancel. Every change you make is in the Audit Log, and the plan keeps its own history.

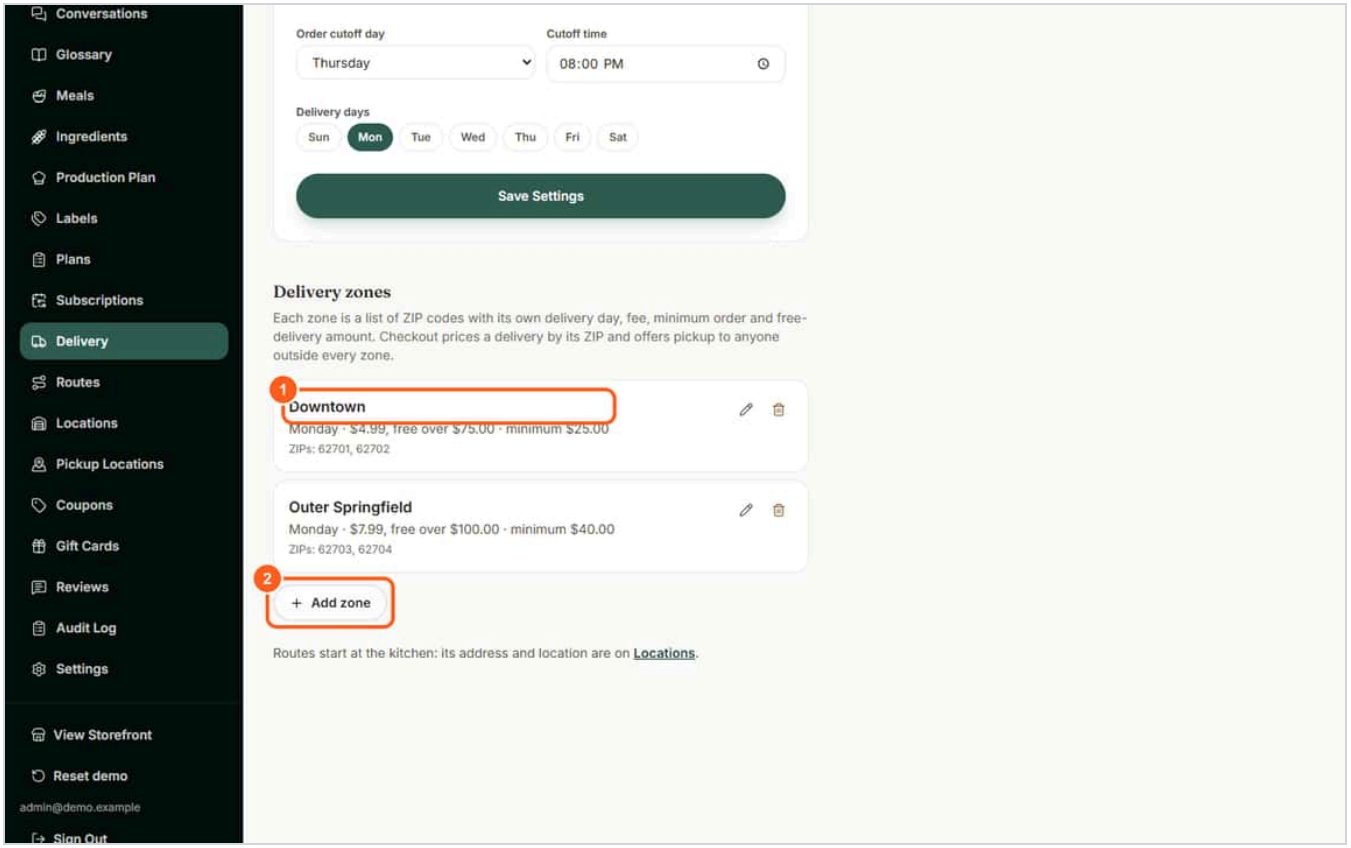
In your own system a declined weekly payment is flagged here and on Orders, and the customer is emailed a link to update their card.



1. The customer's weeks
2. The plan's history

Delivery zones

On the Delivery page, each zone is a list of ZIP codes with its own delivery day, fee, minimum order and free-delivery amount. Checkout uses them automatically.

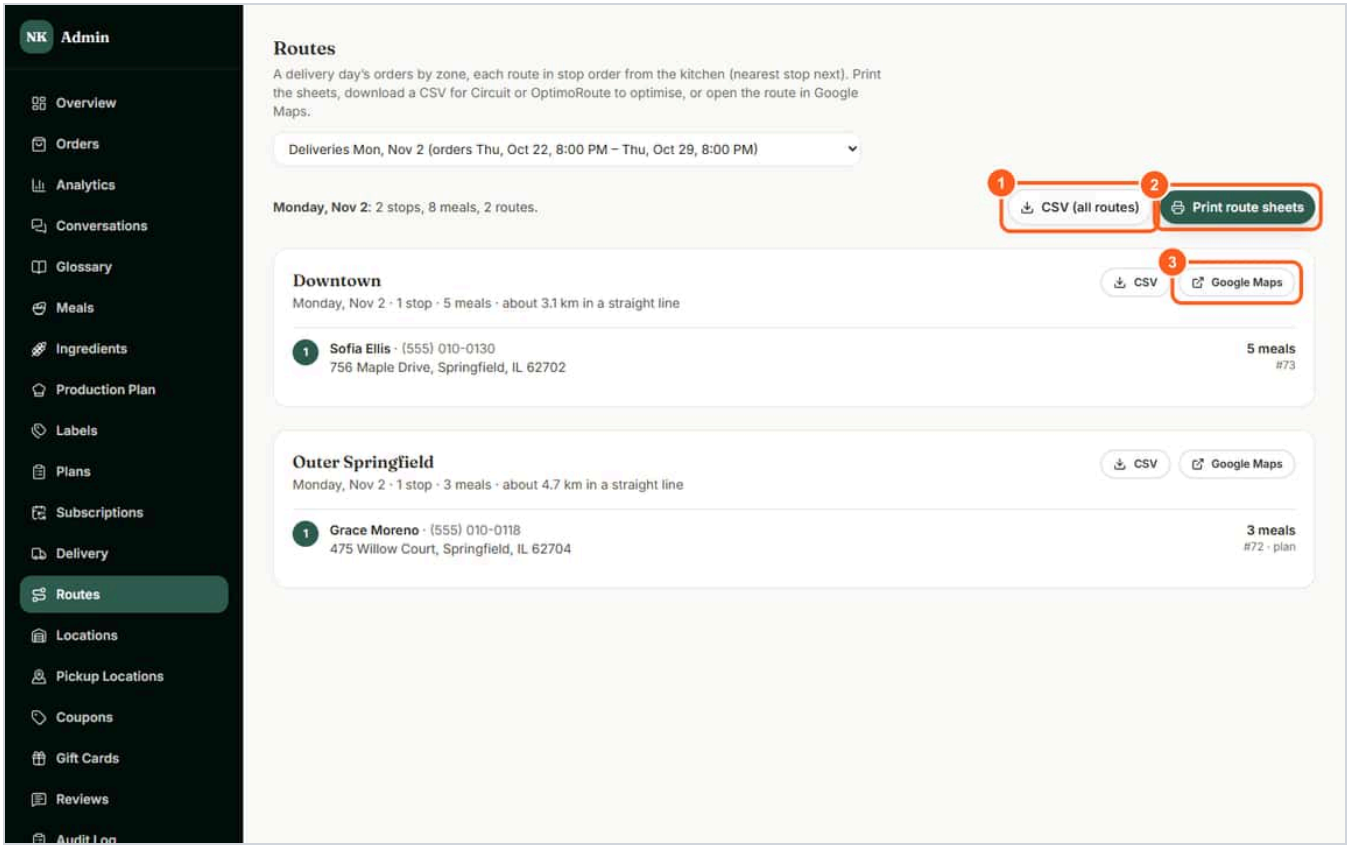


1. A zone: its day, fee and minimum
2. Add a zone

Routes: the delivery day's stops

Pick a delivery day: its orders are grouped by zone, and each route's stops are in order from your kitchen (nearest stop next), with name, phone, address, delivery notes and meal count.

Print the route sheets, download a CSV for Circuit or OptimoRoute to optimize further, or open the route in Google Maps (long routes are split into parts, as Google allows).

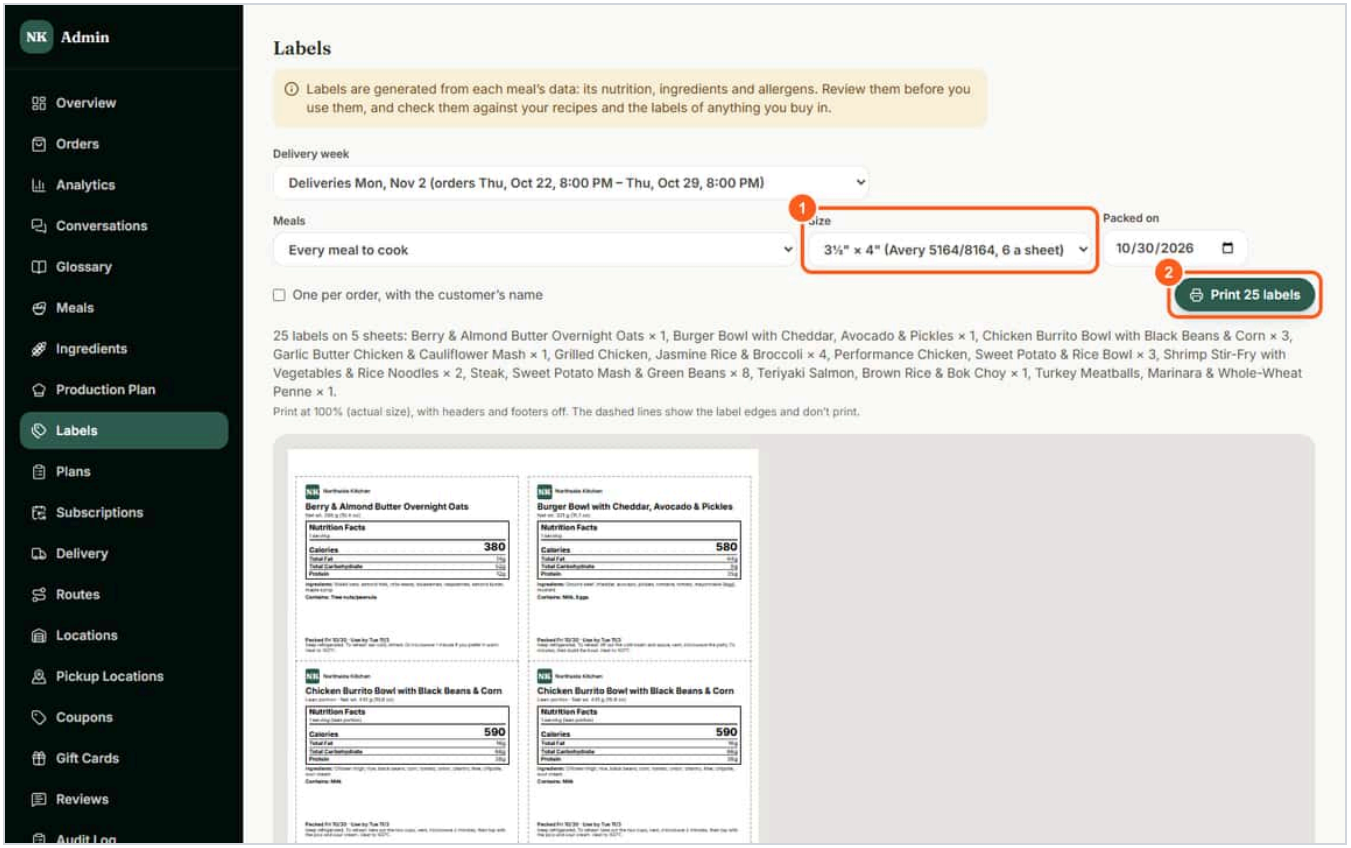


1. Download for Circuit or OptimoRoute
2. Print the route sheets
3. Open in Google Maps

Labels for every meal

From the Production Plan, print a label for every meal to cook that week, or one meal's, or one per order with the customer's name. Choose 2" × 4" or 3⅓" × 4" Avery sheets or 4" × 6" thermal labels, and see the print preview first.

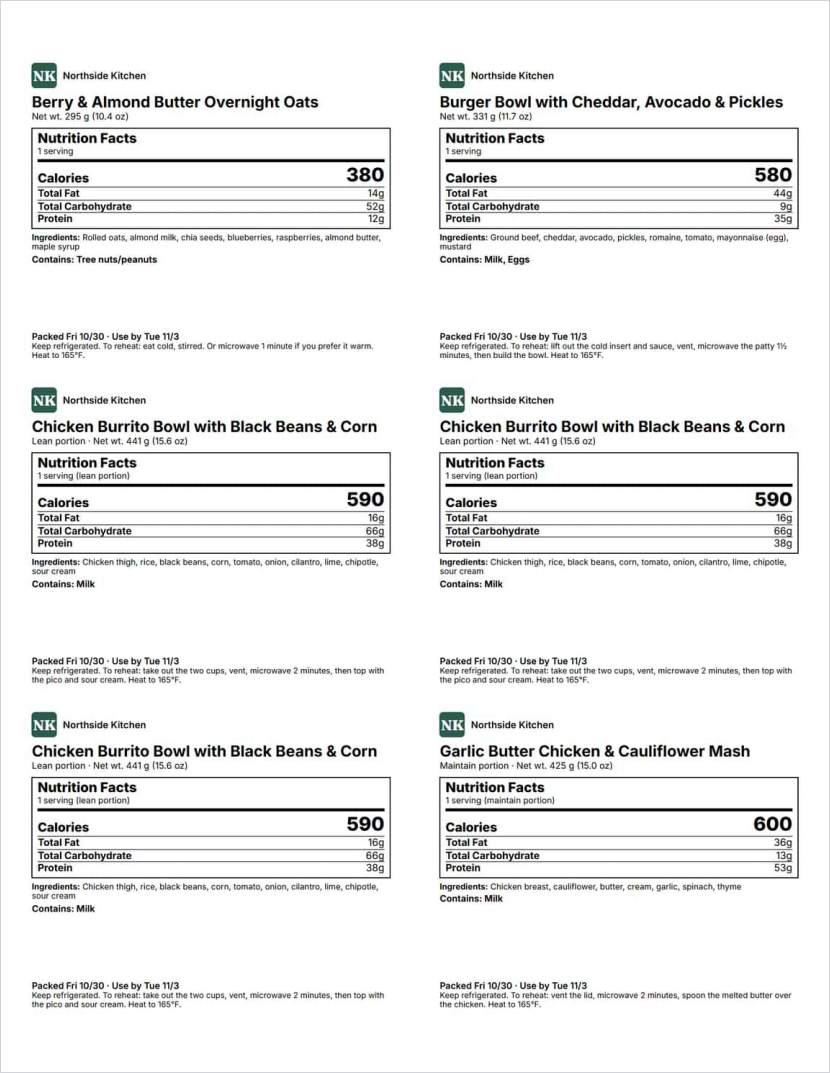
Labels are generated from each meal's data (nutrition, ingredients, allergens); review them before you use them. You set each meal's shelf life, and a footer for every label.



1. Label size
2. Print

A sample label sheet

Each label has your name and logo, the meal and portion, a nutrition panel, ingredients, a Contains line for the major allergens (and Possible lines for sauces you buy in), packed and use-by dates, and storage and reheating.



NK Northside Kitchen

Berry & Almond Butter Overnight Oats
Net wt. 295 g (10.4 oz)

Nutrition Facts
1 serving

Calories	**380**
Total Fat	14g
Total Carbohydrate	52g
Protein	12g

Ingredients: Rolled oats, almond milk, chia seeds, blueberries, raspberries, almond butter, maple syrup
Contains: Tree nuts/peanuts

Packed Fri 10/30 · Use by Tue 11/3
Keep refrigerated. To reheat: eat cold, stirred. Or microwave 1 minute if you prefer it warm. Heat to 165°F.

NK Northside Kitchen

Burger Bowl with Cheddar, Avocado & Pickles
Net wt. 331 g (11.7 oz)

Nutrition Facts
1 serving

Calories	**580**
Total Fat	44g
Total Carbohydrate	9g
Protein	35g

Ingredients: Ground beef, cheddar, avocado, pickles, romaine, tomato, mayonnaise (egg), mustard
Contains: Milk, Eggs

Packed Fri 10/30 · Use by Tue 11/3
Keep refrigerated. To reheat: lift out the cold insert and sauce, vent, microwave the patty 1½ minutes, then build the bowl. Heat to 165°F.

NK Northside Kitchen

Chicken Burrito Bowl with Black Beans & Corn
Lean portion · Net wt. 441 g (15.6 oz)

Nutrition Facts
1 serving (lean portion)

Calories	**590**
Total Fat	16g
Total Carbohydrate	66g
Protein	38g

Ingredients: Chicken thigh, rice, black beans, corn, tomato, onion, cilantro, lime, chipotle, sour cream
Contains: Milk

Packed Fri 10/30 · Use by Tue 11/3
Keep refrigerated. To reheat: take out the two cups, vent, microwave 2 minutes, then top with the pico and sour cream. Heat to 165°F.

NK Northside Kitchen

Chicken Burrito Bowl with Black Beans & Corn
Lean portion · Net wt. 441 g (15.6 oz)

Nutrition Facts
1 serving (lean portion)

Calories	**590**
Total Fat	16g
Total Carbohydrate	66g
Protein	38g

Ingredients: Chicken thigh, rice, black beans, corn, tomato, onion, cilantro, lime, chipotle, sour cream
Contains: Milk

Packed Fri 10/30 · Use by Tue 11/3
Keep refrigerated. To reheat: take out the two cups, vent, microwave 2 minutes, then top with the pico and sour cream. Heat to 165°F.

NK Northside Kitchen

Chicken Burrito Bowl with Black Beans & Corn
Lean portion · Net wt. 441 g (15.6 oz)

Nutrition Facts
1 serving (lean portion)

Calories	**590**
Total Fat	16g
Total Carbohydrate	66g
Protein	38g

Ingredients: Chicken thigh, rice, black beans, corn, tomato, onion, cilantro, lime, chipotle, sour cream
Contains: Milk

Packed Fri 10/30 · Use by Tue 11/3
Keep refrigerated. To reheat: take out the two cups, vent, microwave 2 minutes, then top with the pico and sour cream. Heat to 165°F.

NK Northside Kitchen

Garlic Butter Chicken & Cauliflower Mash
Maintain portion · Net wt. 425 g (15.0 oz)

Nutrition Facts
1 serving (maintain portion)

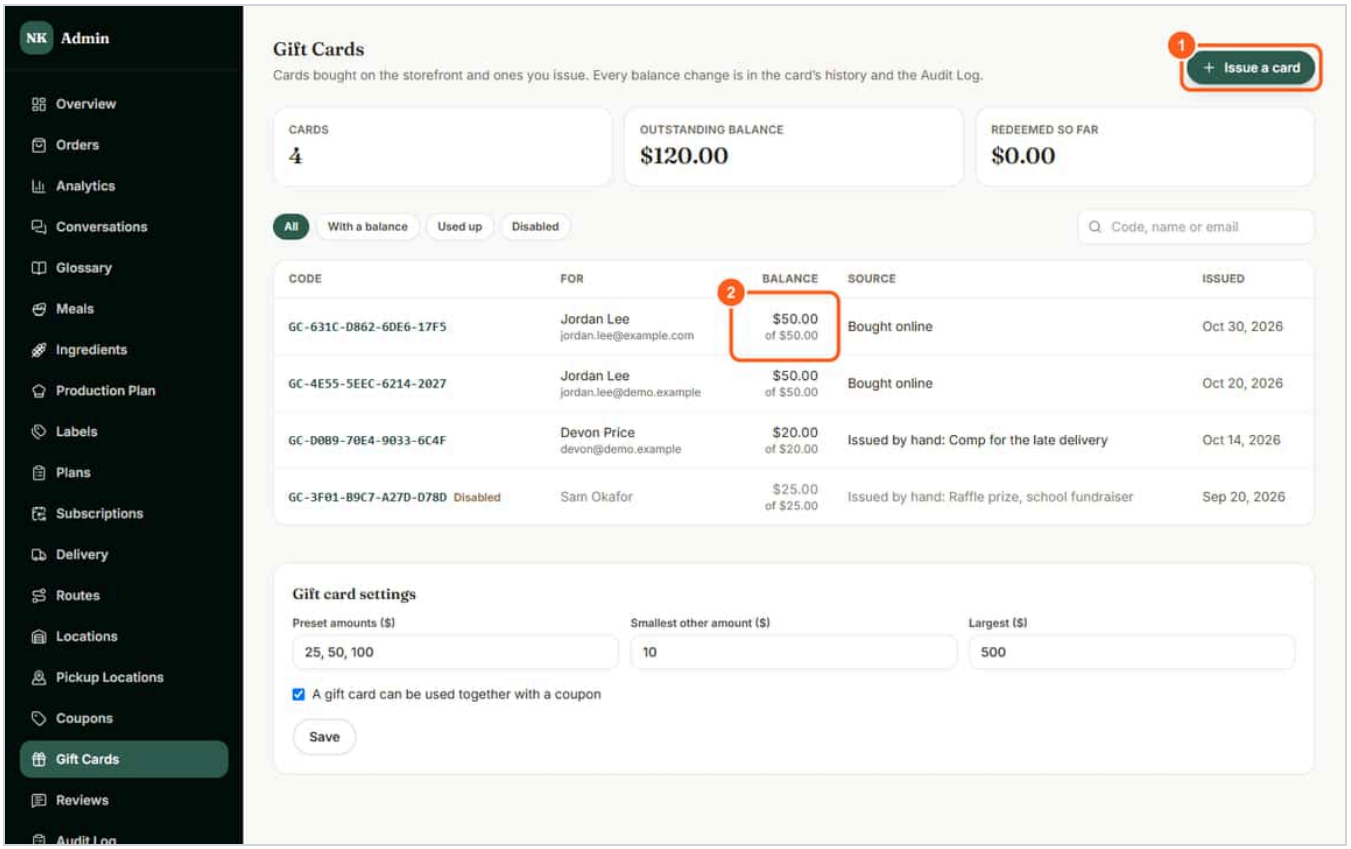
Calories	**600**
Total Fat	36g
Total Carbohydrate	13g
Protein	53g

Ingredients: Chicken breast, cauliflower, butter, cream, garlic, spinach, thyme
Contains: Milk

Packed Fri 10/30 · Use by Tue 11/3
Keep refrigerated. To reheat: vent the lid, microwave 2 minutes, spoon the melted butter over the chicken. Heat to 165°F.

Gift Cards

Every gift card: who it's for, its balance and its history (issued, each order it paid for, adjustments). Issue a card by hand (a comp, a prize), change a balance or disable a lost card, each with a note, all in the Audit Log.

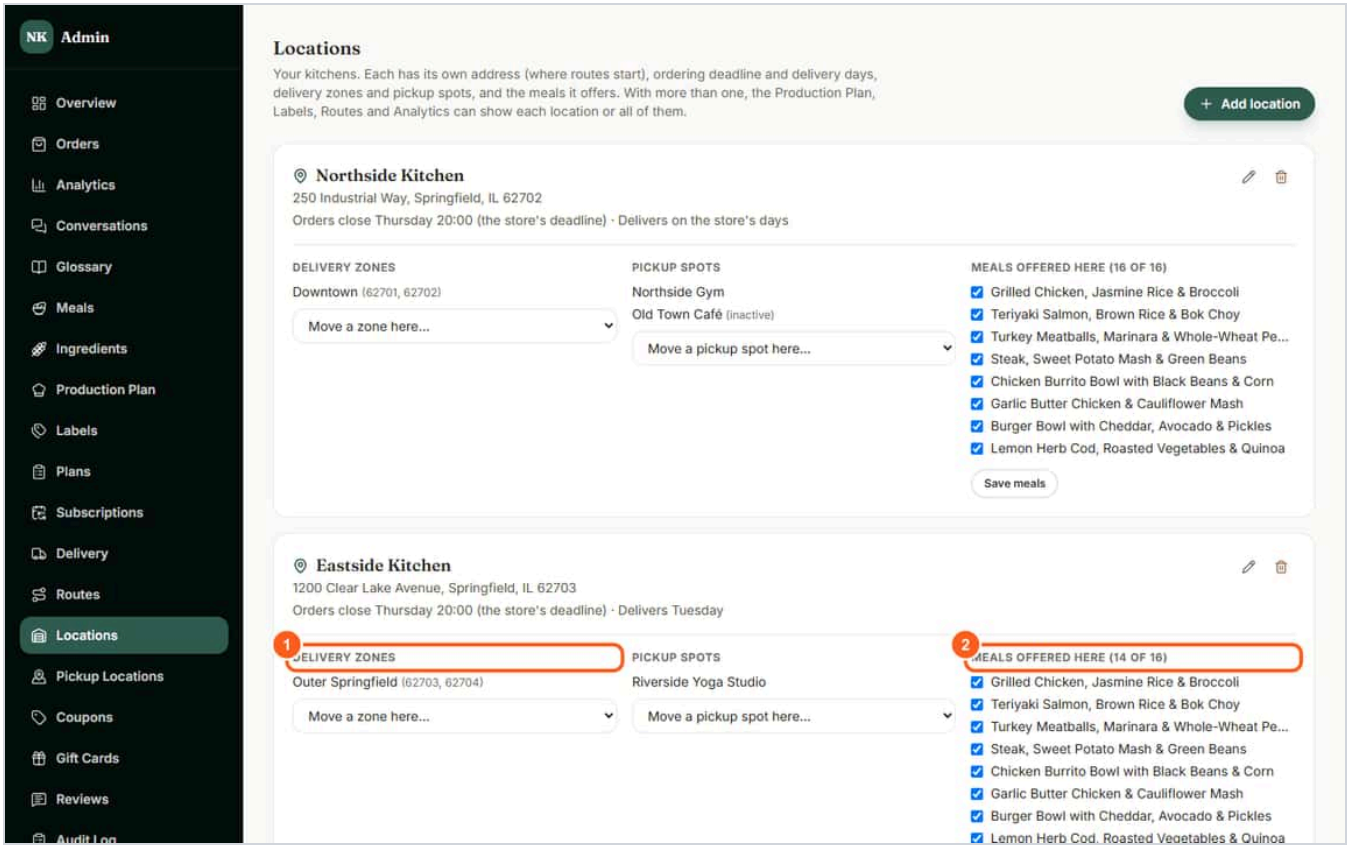


1. Issue a card
2. A card's balance

More than one kitchen: Locations

Each kitchen has its own address (where its routes start), ordering deadline and delivery days, delivery zones, pickup spots and the meals it offers. Customers are matched to a kitchen by their address or pickup spot.

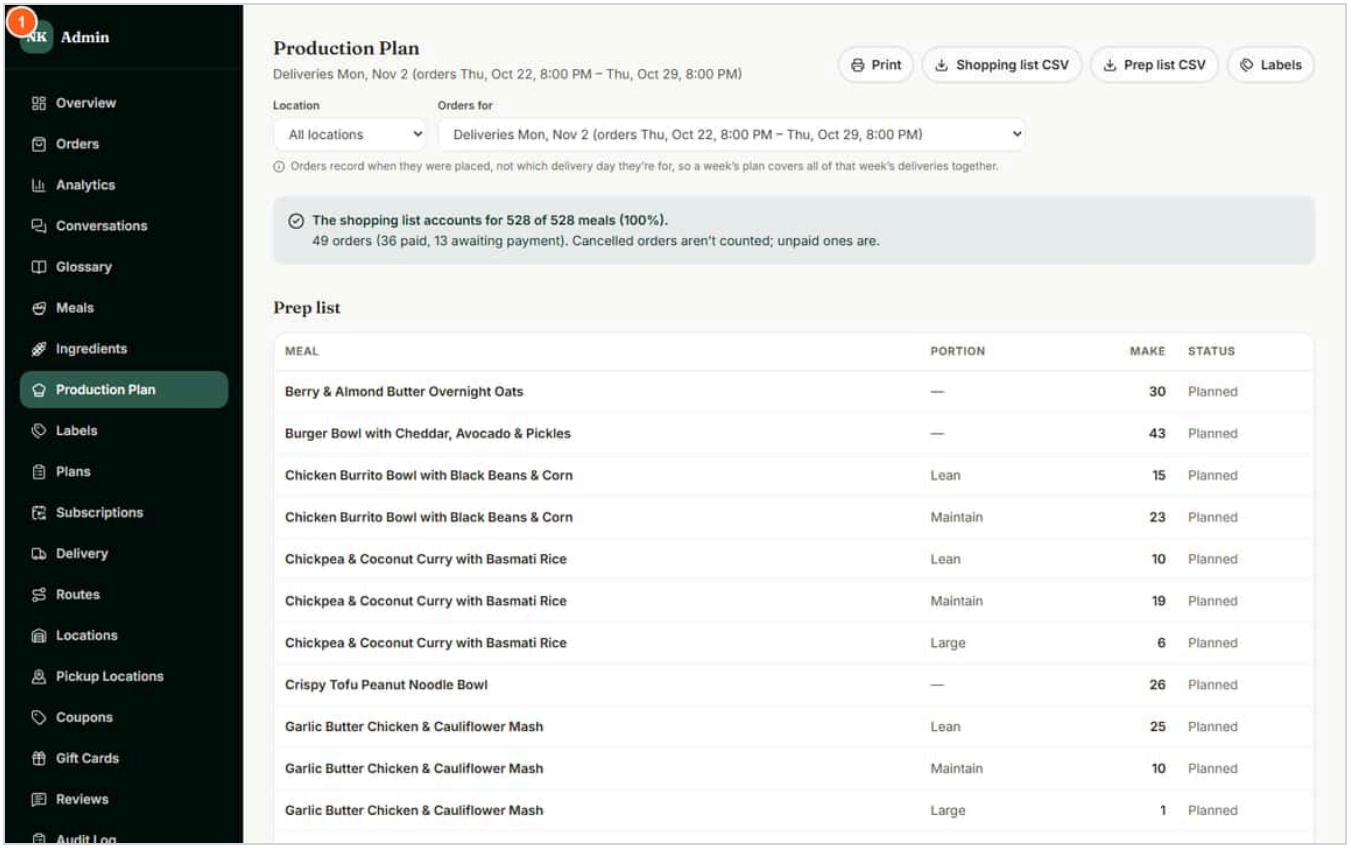
With one kitchen you see none of this. This page is from the demo's “Established” sample business (choose it in the brand panel), which has two.



1. A kitchen's zones and pickup spots
2. The meals it offers

One kitchen at a time

With two or more kitchens, the Production Plan, shopping lists, labels, routes and analytics each show one location or all of them.



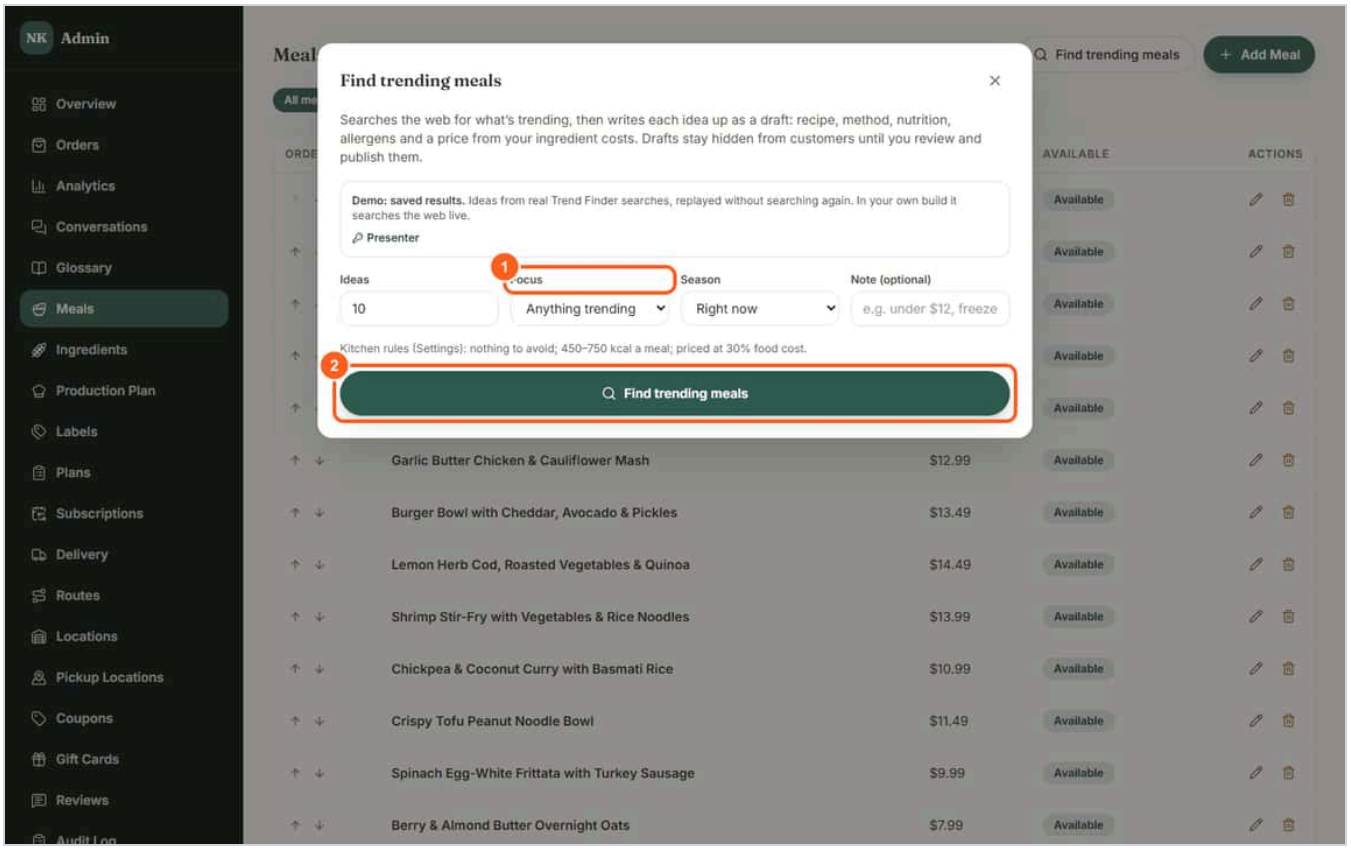
1 Choose a location

6. TREND FINDER, STEP BY STEP

Find trending meals

On the Meals page, click Find trending meals. Choose how many ideas, a focus (high-protein, vegan, comfort food…) and a season, then search.

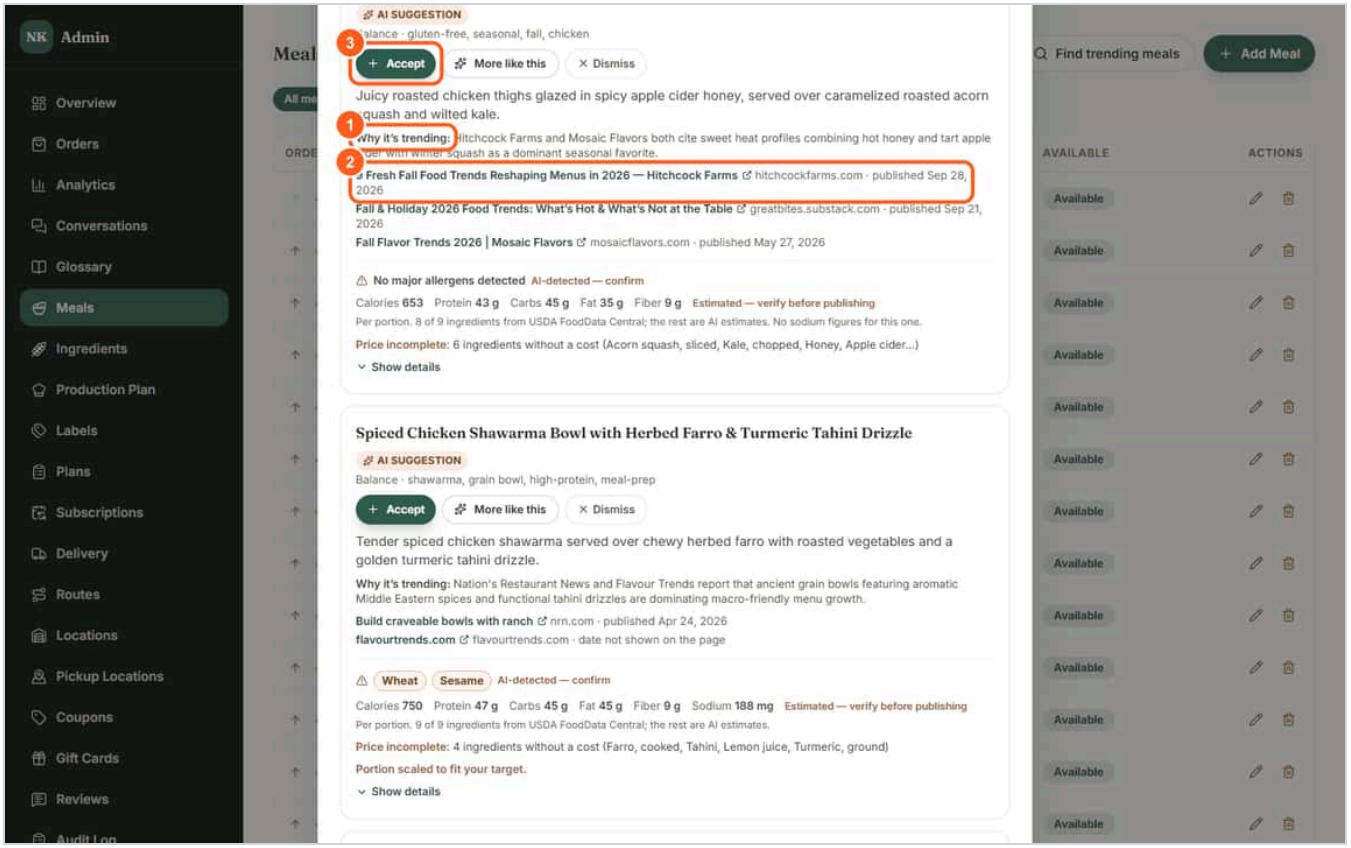
In the demo you see saved results from real searches. In your own system it searches the web live.



1. Choose a focus
2. Search

Read why it's trending, and its sources

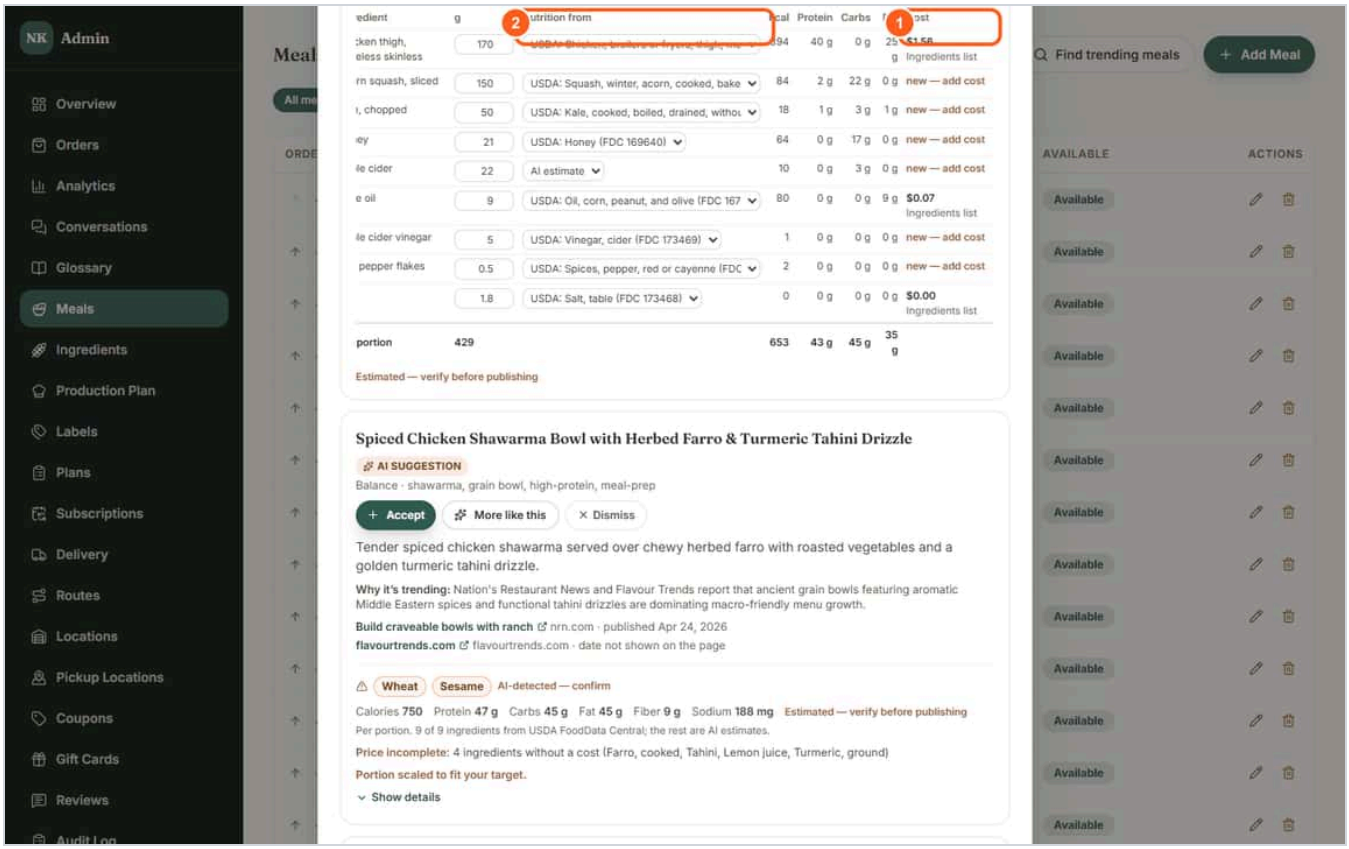
Each idea says why it's trending and links the articles that show it, with their publish dates. Only recent articles from at least two different publications count.



1. Why it's trending
2. Its sources and dates
3. Accept it as a draft

Ingredients, nutrition and costs

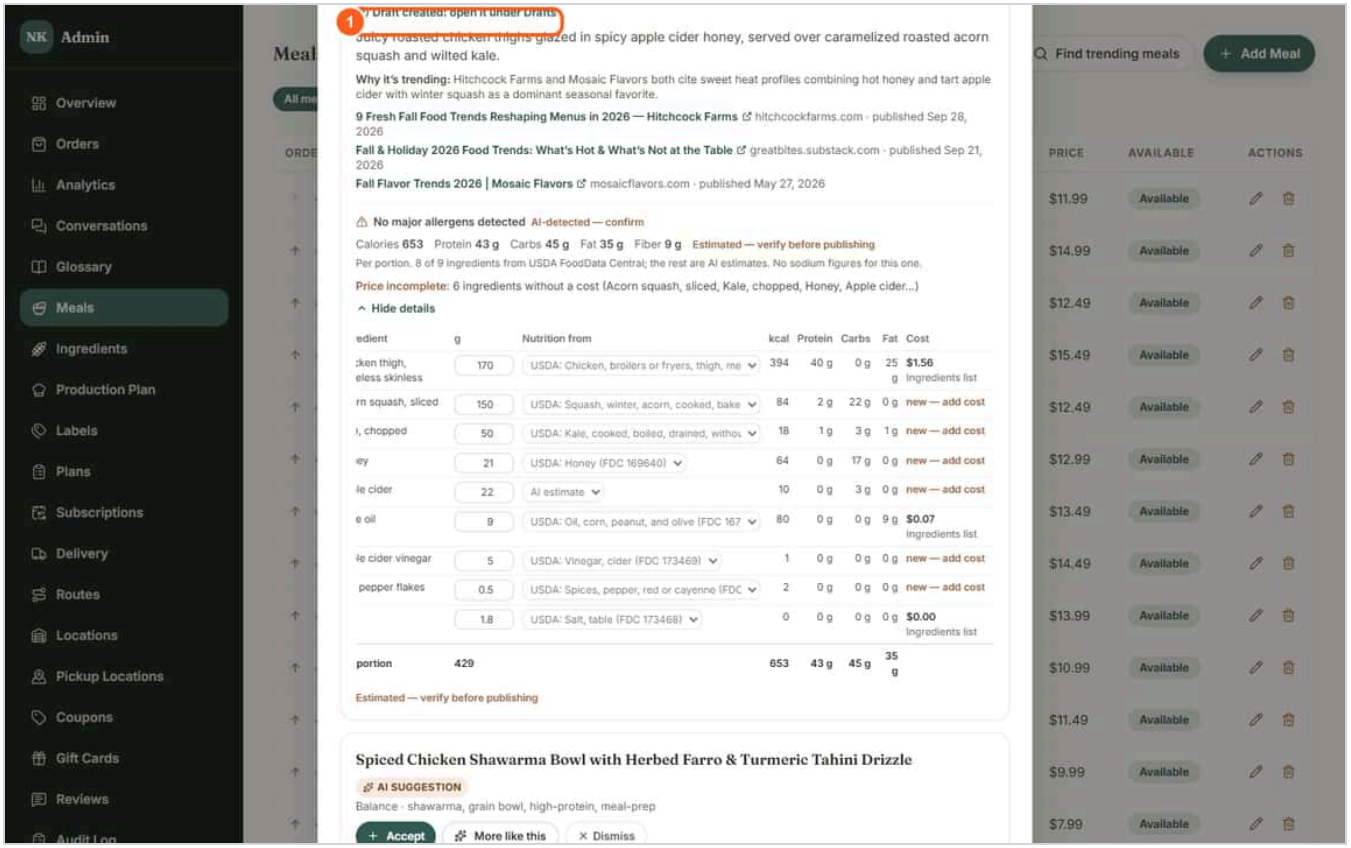
Show details lists every ingredient with its nutrition and cost. Costs come from your Ingredients list; for new ingredients, your own system estimates costs from your suppliers' online prices and public U.S. averages, and marks each one for you to confirm.



1. Cost of each ingredient
2. Where the nutrition comes from

Accept it: a hidden draft

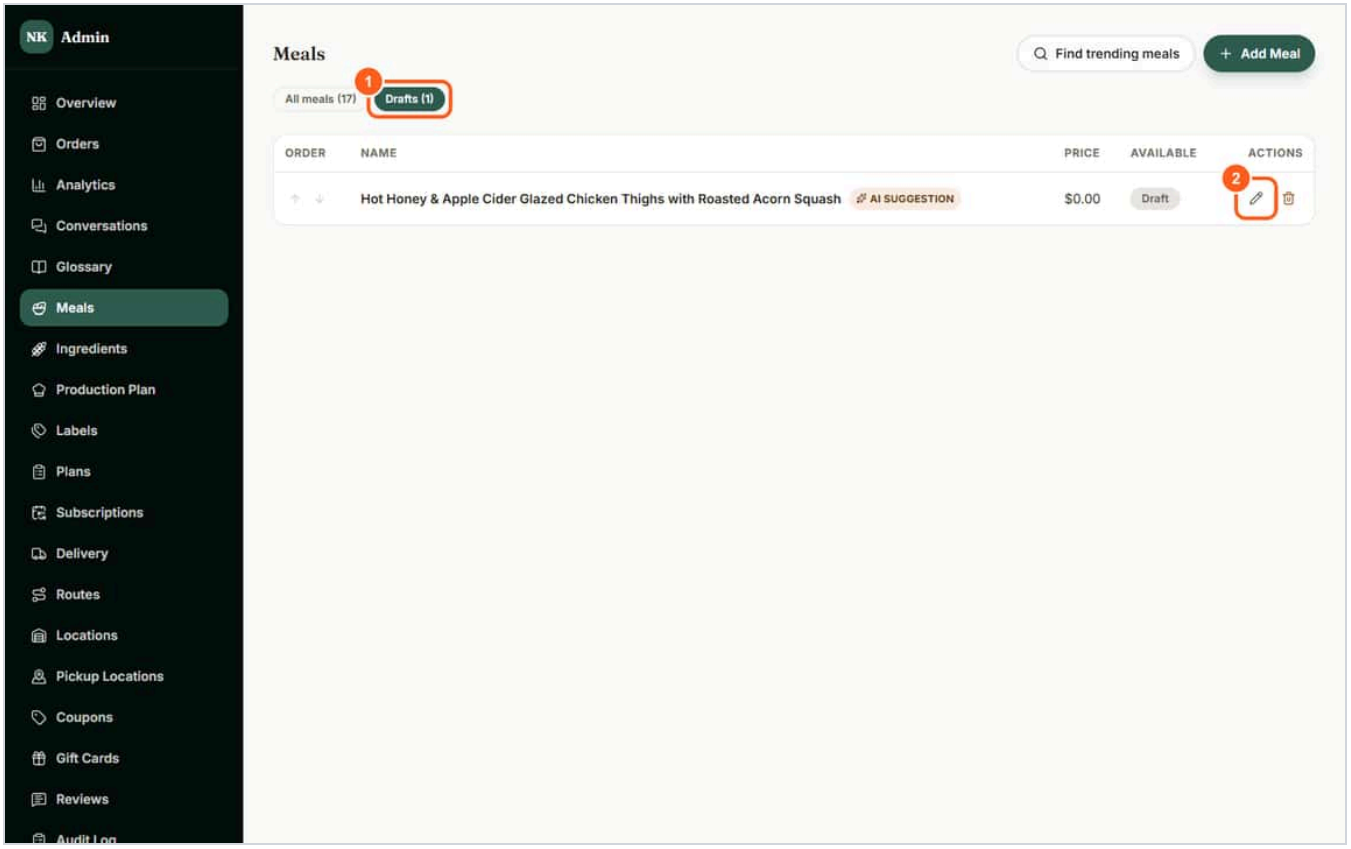
Accept turns the idea into a draft meal with its recipe, method, nutrition and price. Drafts stay hidden from customers until you publish them.



1 Draft created

Open the draft

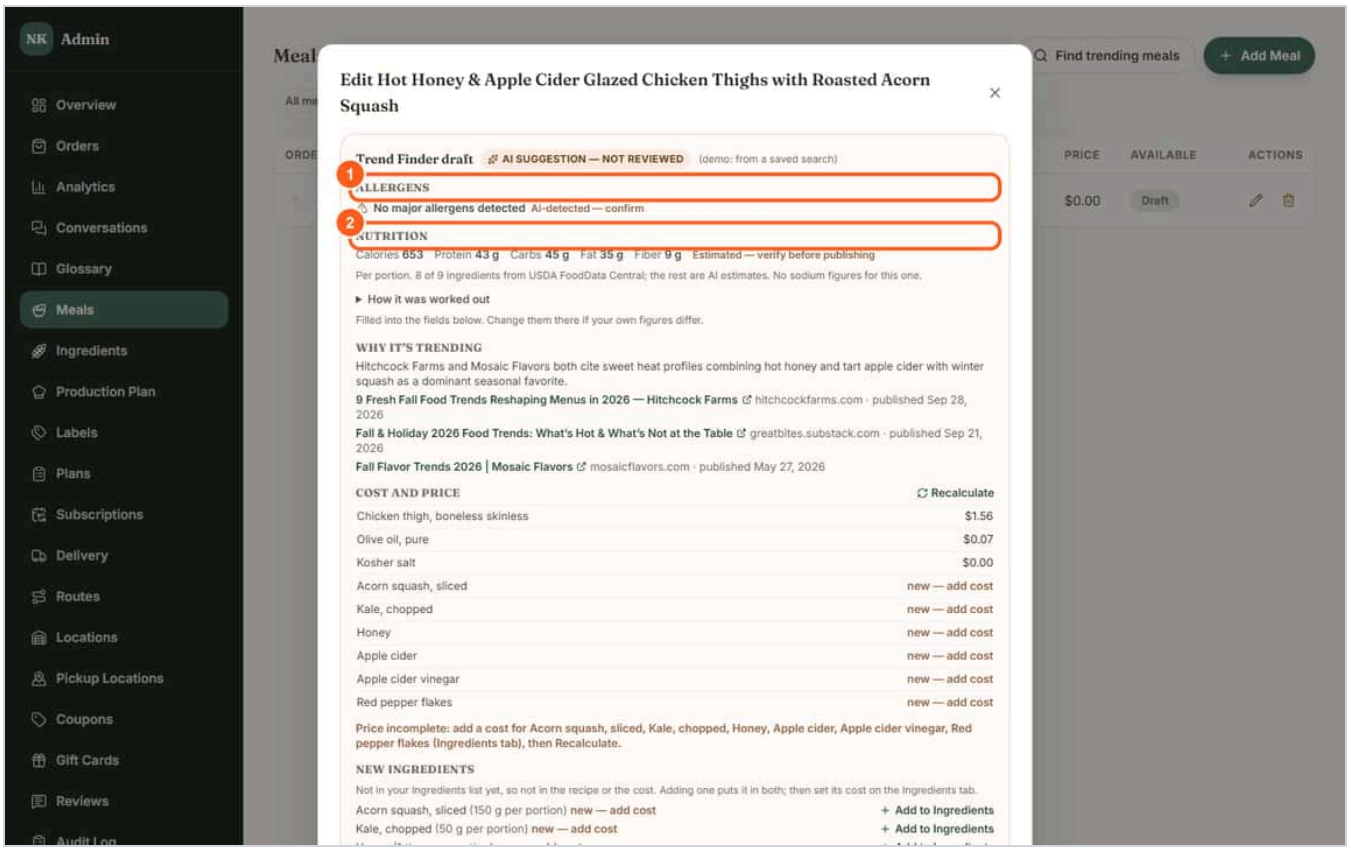
Your drafts are under Drafts on the Meals page. Click the pencil to review one.



1. Drafts
2. Review it

Review allergens, nutrition and portion

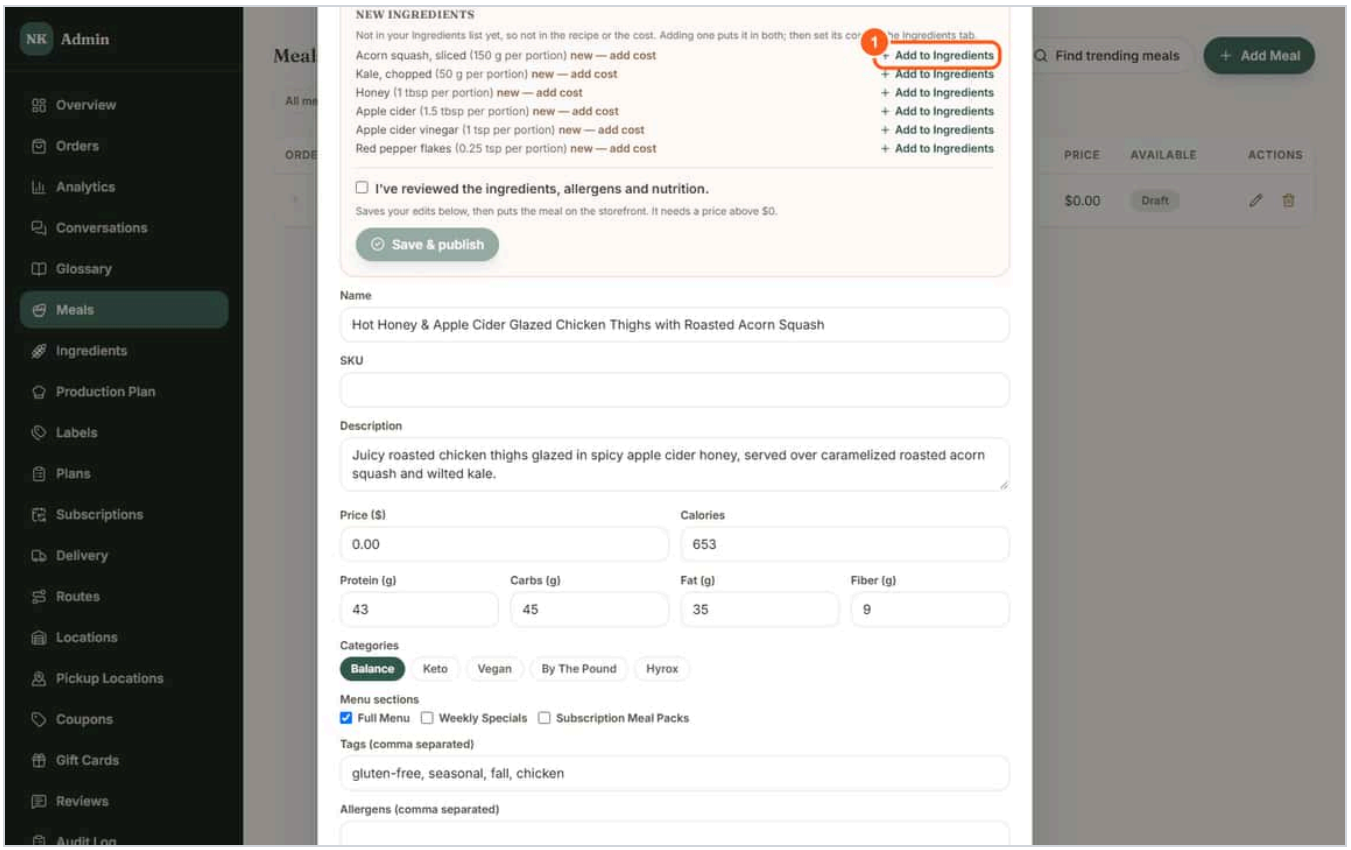
Allergens and nutrition are marked as estimates for you to check. If the portion was adjusted to your calorie target, it says so.



1. Allergens
2. Nutrition

Add new ingredients and pick suppliers

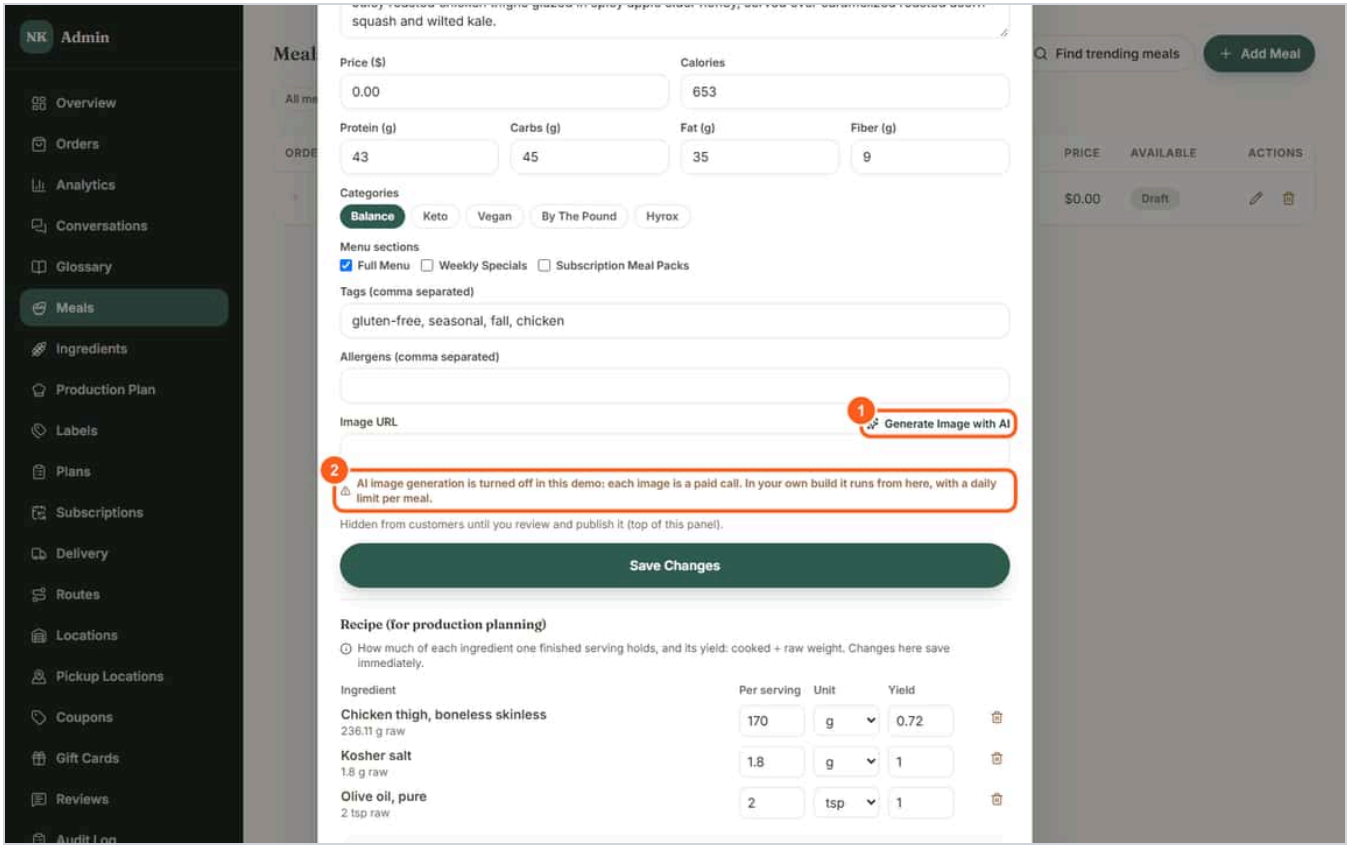
Ingredients you don't have yet are listed with Add to Ingredients. One click adds each to your list and the recipe; then pick its supplier and cost on the Ingredients page.



1 Add to your Ingredients

Generate a photo

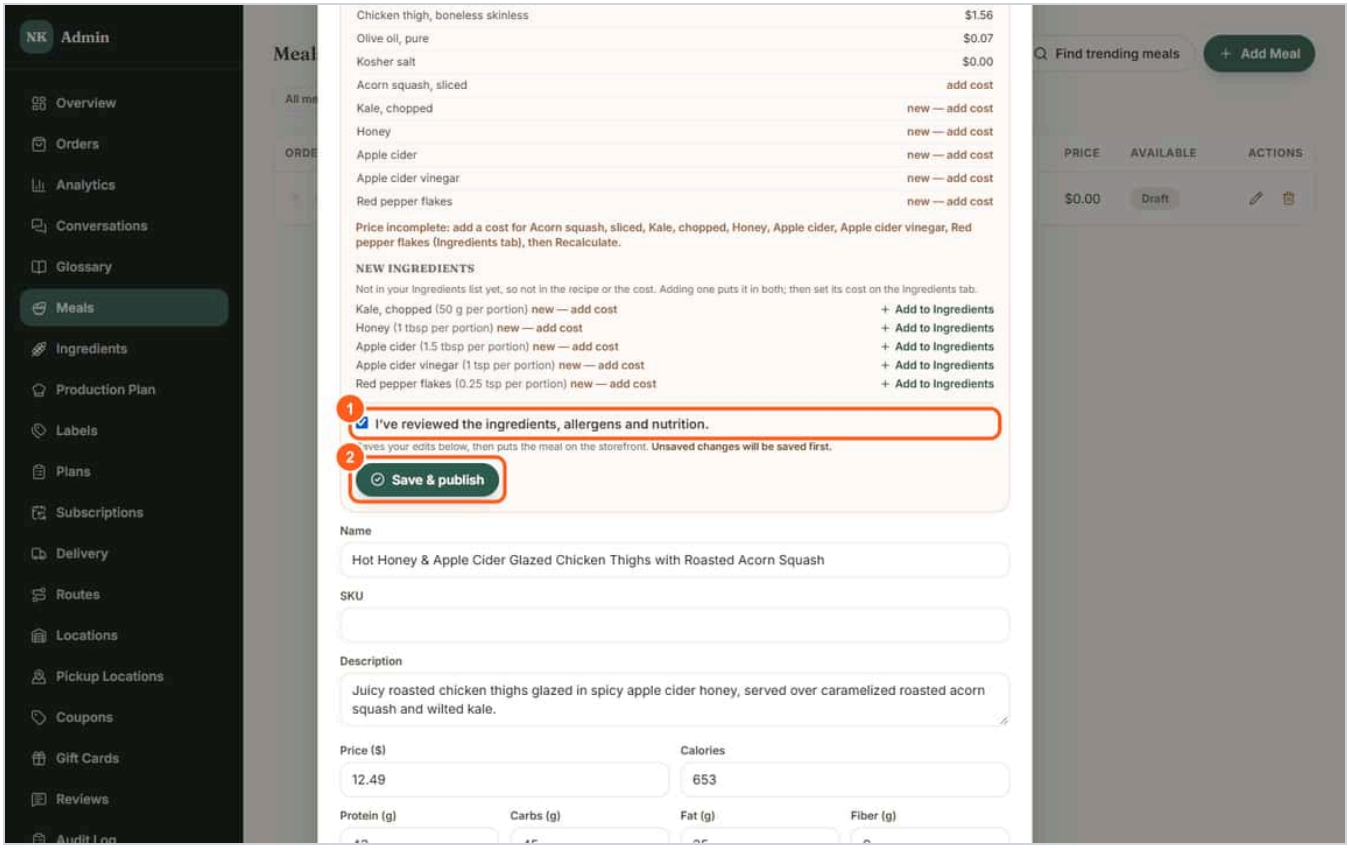
In your own system, Generate Image with AI makes a photo of the dish in your menu's style. In the public demo it's turned off, as the message says.



1. Generate Image with AI
2. Turned off in the demo

Save & publish

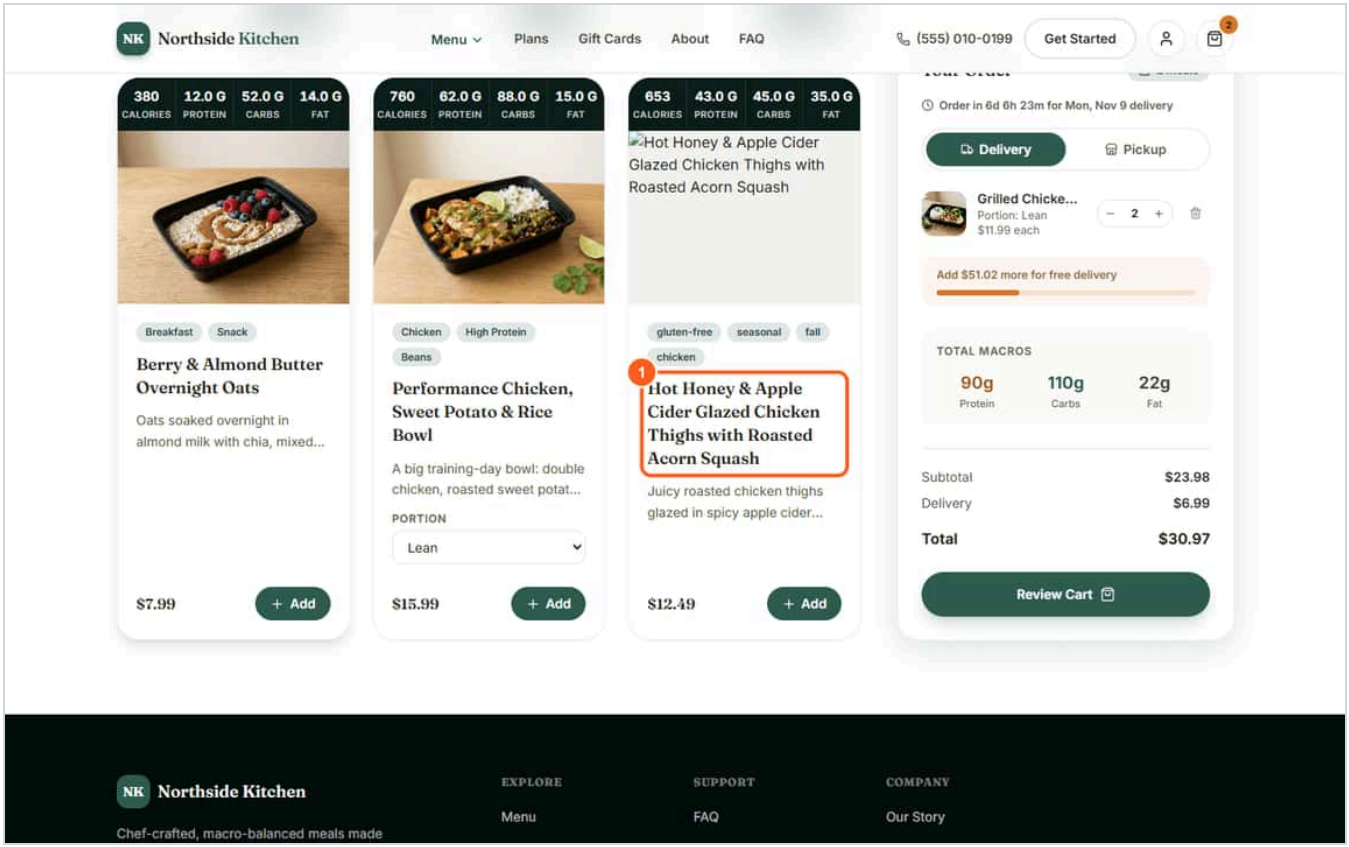
Set a price, tick that you've reviewed the ingredients, allergens and nutrition, and click Save & publish. Your edits are saved and the meal goes on the menu in one step.



1. Confirm you've reviewed it
2. Save & publish

See it on your storefront

Click View Storefront: the new meal is on the menu, ready to order.



1 Your new meal

7. BRINGING YOUR CUSTOMERS WITH YOU

We move your data for you

You don't start from zero. During setup, we move your existing customer and menu data for you: spreadsheets, Square, Wix and others.

If you sell on WooCommerce today, your menu can be imported straight from a WooCommerce product export. Nutrition and allergens that aren't in the export are flagged for you to fill in, never guessed.

Your customers keep ordering from you without interruption; we plan the switch-over date with you.

8. WHAT HAPPENS NEXT

What happens next

Book a free intro call. We'll talk about your menu, how you take orders today and what you'd like to change.

Your business stays yours: your data, your domain name and your payment account are in your name. You can take them with you at any time.

Chuck · CG Strategic

Chuck · chuck@cgstrategic.dev

(904) 822-8929

cgstrategic.dev

Book your call: [booking link coming soon]